

# DNA Sequencing and Data Analysis

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Lecture 9, June 4, 2026

# DNA Sequencing and Data Analysis

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## **The De-novo Shotgun Assembly Problem RNA-seq**

Thursday 18:30 to 21:00

C.108

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[amit.levon@post.runi.ac.il](mailto:amit.levon@post.runi.ac.il)

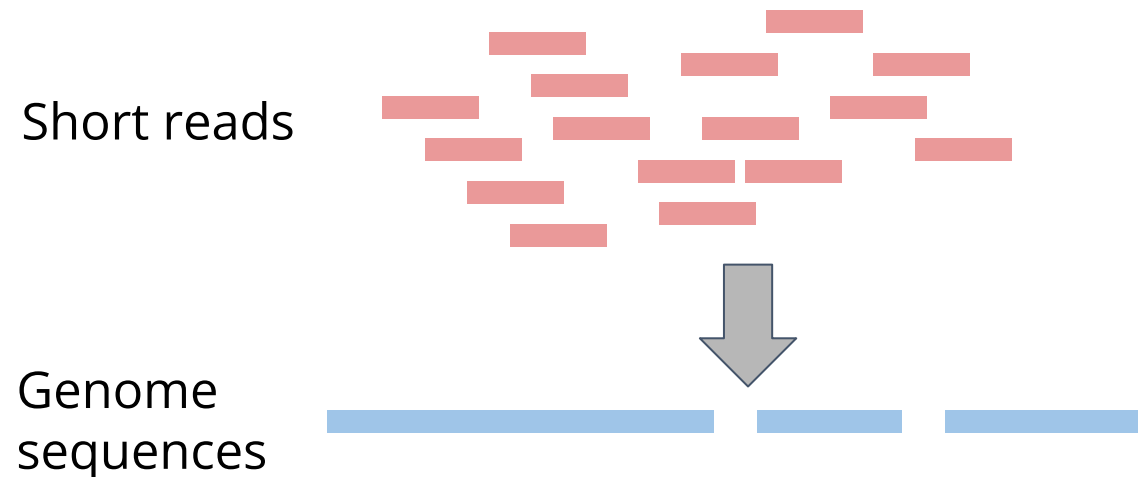
# What is De Novo Genome Assembly?

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Genome assembly - constructing long genomic sequences from shorter ones

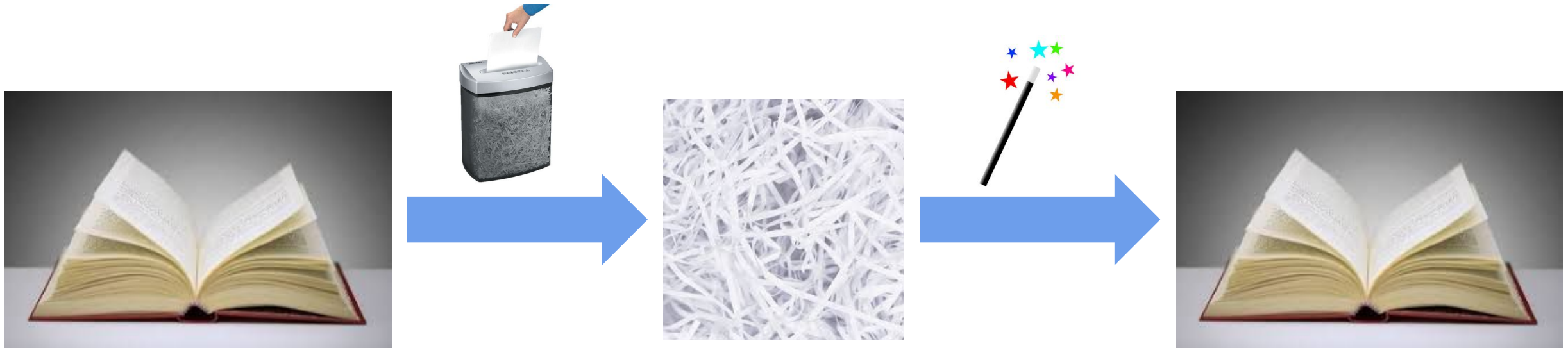
De novo = “from scratch”

In NGS context - short reads → whole genome, without any external reference



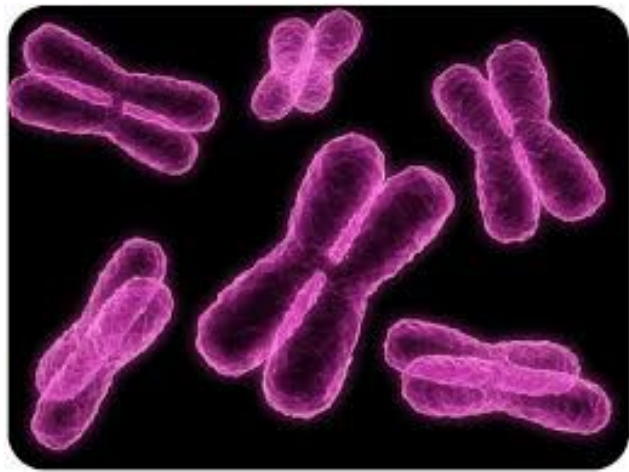
# The Assembly Problem

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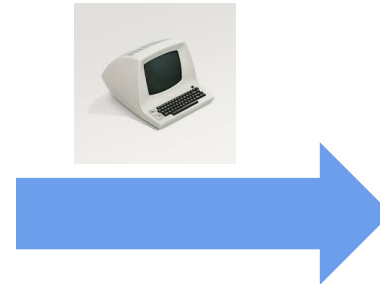


# The Assembly Problem

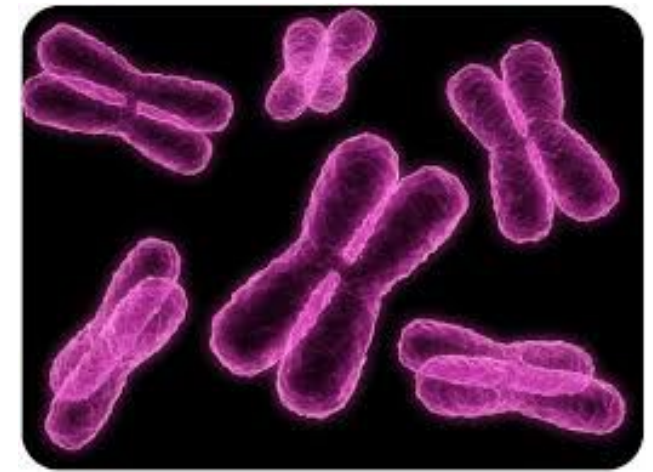
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Shotgun  
sequencing



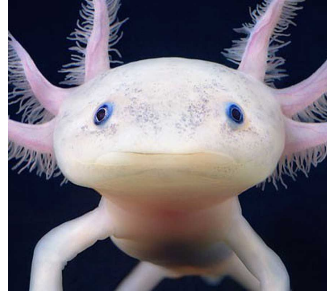
De novo  
assembly



# Why Do We Need De Novo Assembly?

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Completely new organism

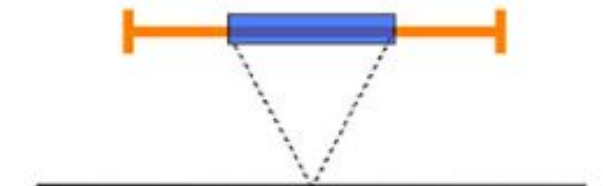
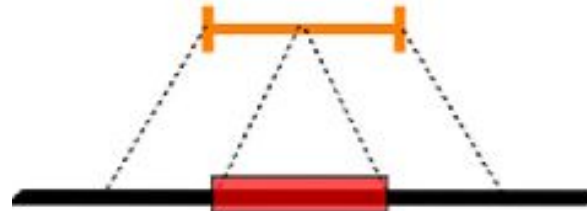


Existing reference is too different from what we are interested in



Cancer genomics

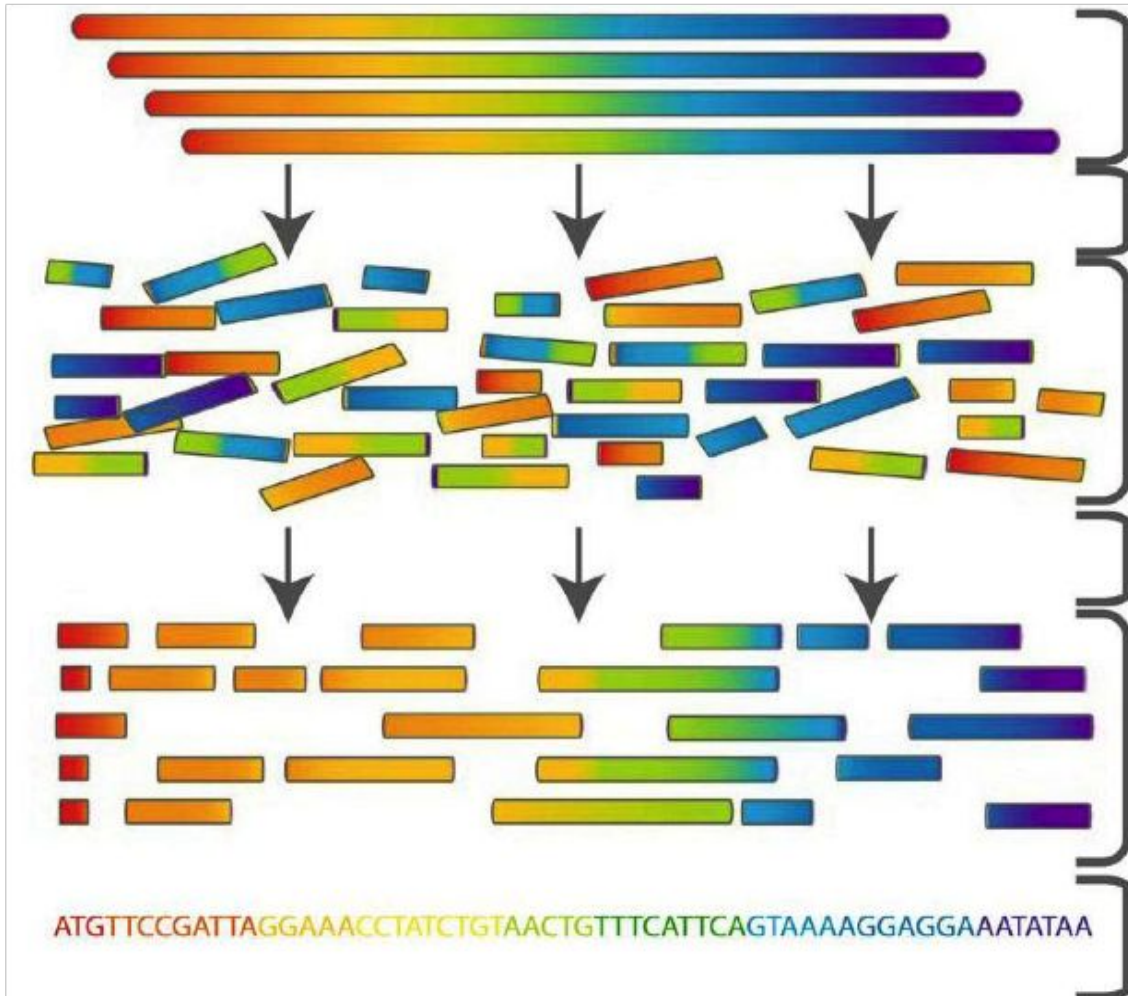
Identify large structural variation



Detect novel sequences not present in the reference

# Genome Assembly by Reads Overlap

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Genomic DNA

Fragmentation + Sequencing

Sequence reads

Assembly

Connection between reads  
found

Consensus sequence

# Coverage Definition

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Diagram illustrating sequence coverage. The sequences are aligned as follows:

```
          CTAGGCCCTCAATTTT
        CTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTT
      GGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTT
    CTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTT
  TATCTCGACTCTAGGCCCTCA
  TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC
TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG
GGCGTCTATATCTCG
GGCGTCTATATCT
GGCGTCTATATCT
GGCGTCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTT
```

Two vertical blue boxes highlight a region where five sequences overlap. The bottom sequence in this region is highlighted in red.

Coverage = 5



# Average Coverage

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CTAGGCCCTCAATTTT  
CTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTT  
GGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTT  
CTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTT  
TATCTCGACTCTAGGCCCTCA  
TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC  
TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG 177 bases  
GGCGTCTATATCTCG  
GGCGTCTATATCT  
GGCGTCTATATCT 35 bases  
GGCGTCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTTT

Average Coverage =  $177/35 \approx 5$ -fold (5x)

# Suffix Prefix Matching

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TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG

TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC

# Suffix Prefix Matching

---

TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG

TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC

# Suffix Prefix Matching

---

TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG  
GGCGTCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTTT  
TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC

If a suffix of read A is similar to a prefix of read  
then A and B might overlap in the genome

# Suffix Prefix Differences

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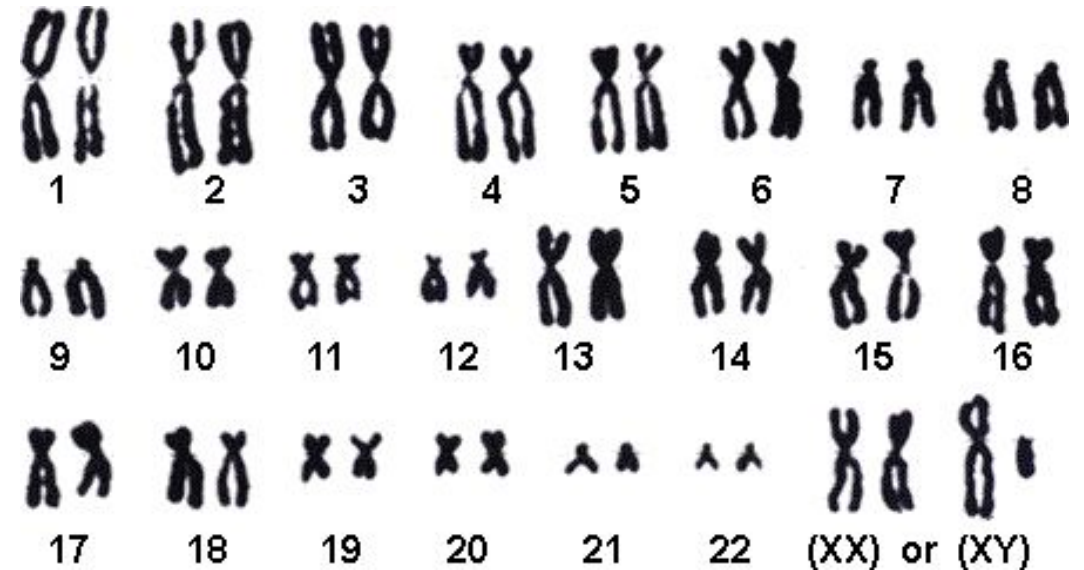
TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG

TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC



Why the differences?

1. Sequencing errors
2. Polyploidy



# High and Low Coverage

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CTAGGCCCTCAATTTT  
GGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTT  
CTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTT  
TATCTCGACTCTAGGCC  
TCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGG  
GGCGTCTATATCTCG  
GGCGTCTATATCT  
GGCGTCTATATCTCGGCTCTAGGCCCTCATTTTTT  
CTAGGCCCTCAATTTT  
TATCTCGACTCTAGGCCCTCA  
GGCGTCTATATCT

More coverage

Less coverage

More coverage leads to more and longer overlaps

# Overlap Consensus

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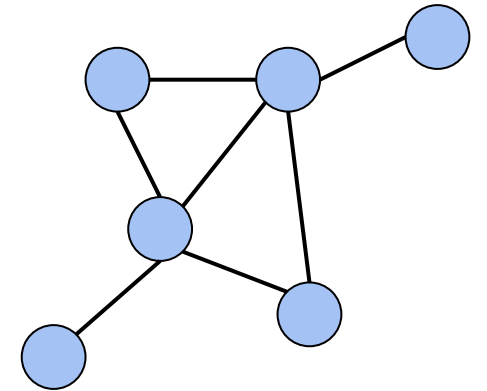
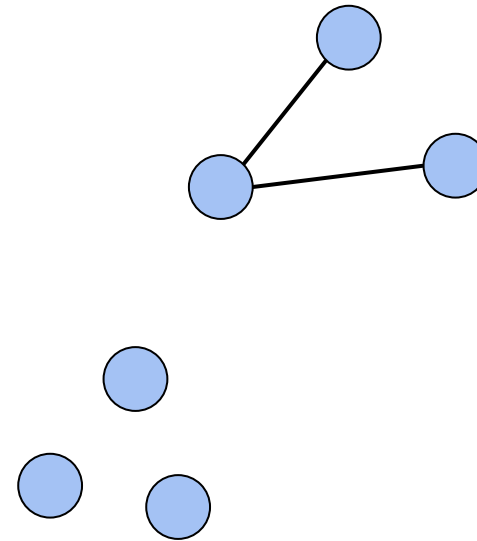
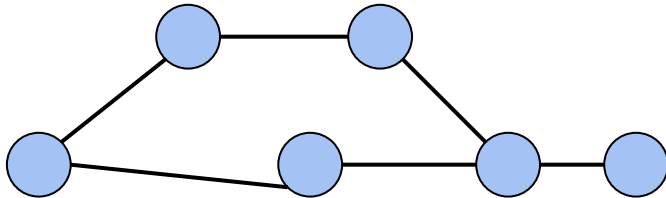
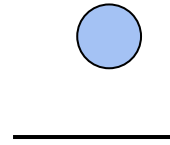
What is the best representation to the set of sequences?

# Graph

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A graph is a set of:

- Nodes (vertices)
- Edges - connecting two nodes

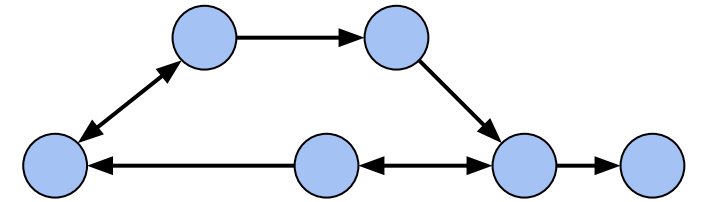
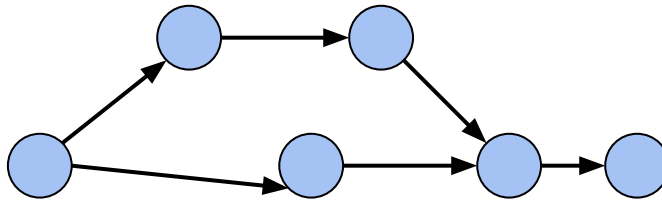
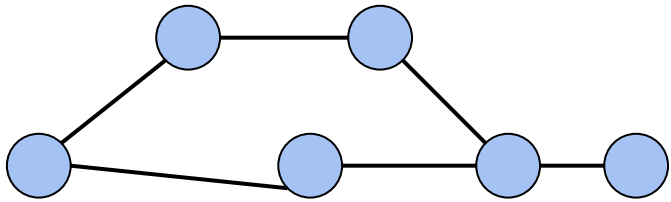




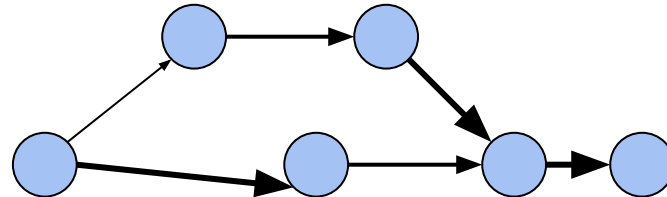
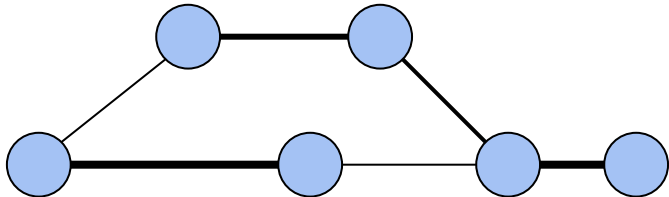
# Directed and Weighted Graphs

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Graphs can be **directed** or **non-directed**

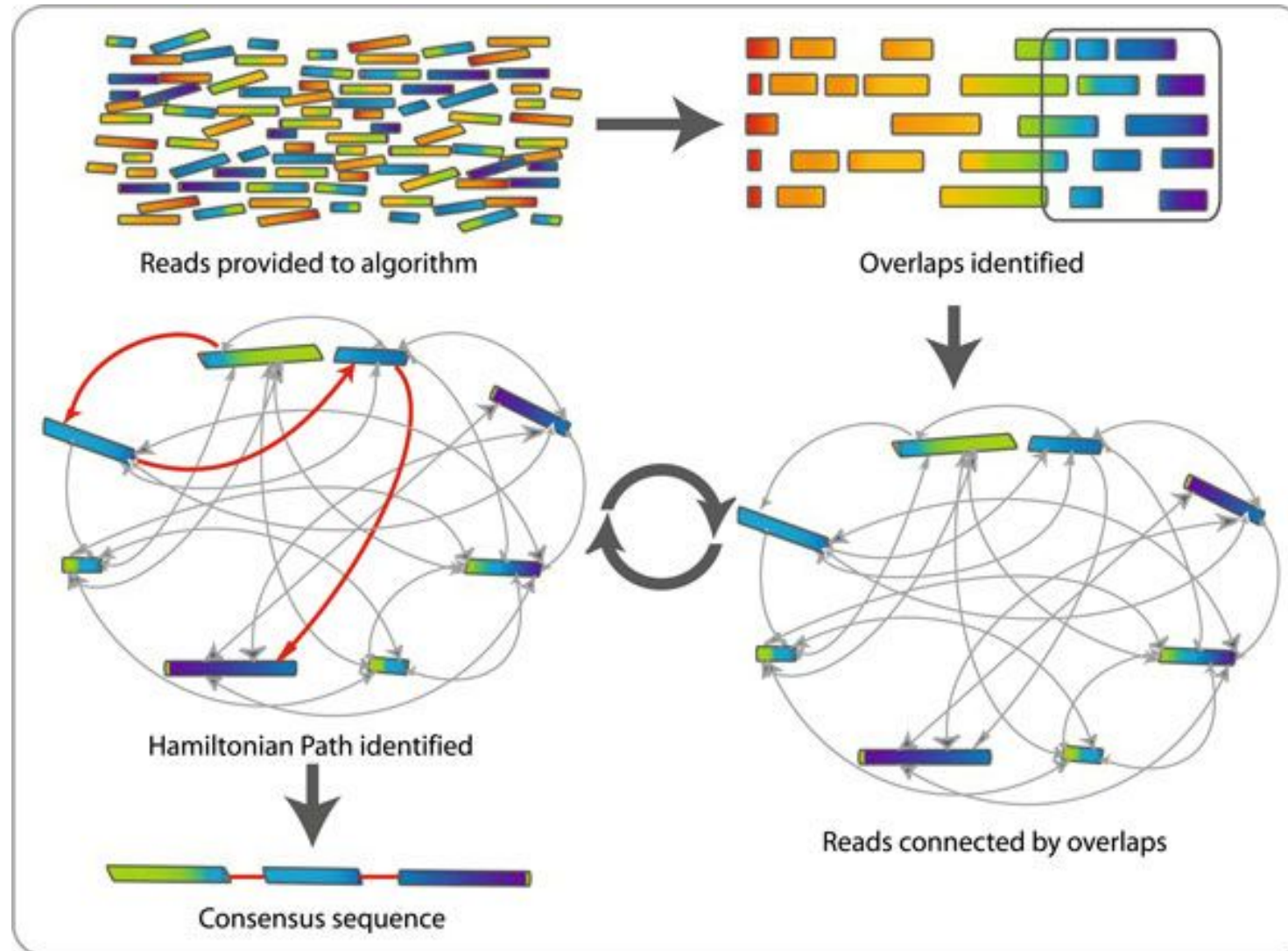


We can assign **weights** to edges



# Overlap–layout–consensus genome assembly algorithm

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# Overlap Consensus Graph

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Nodes: all 6-mers in **GTACGTACGAT**

Edges: overlaps of length  $> 3$

GTACGT

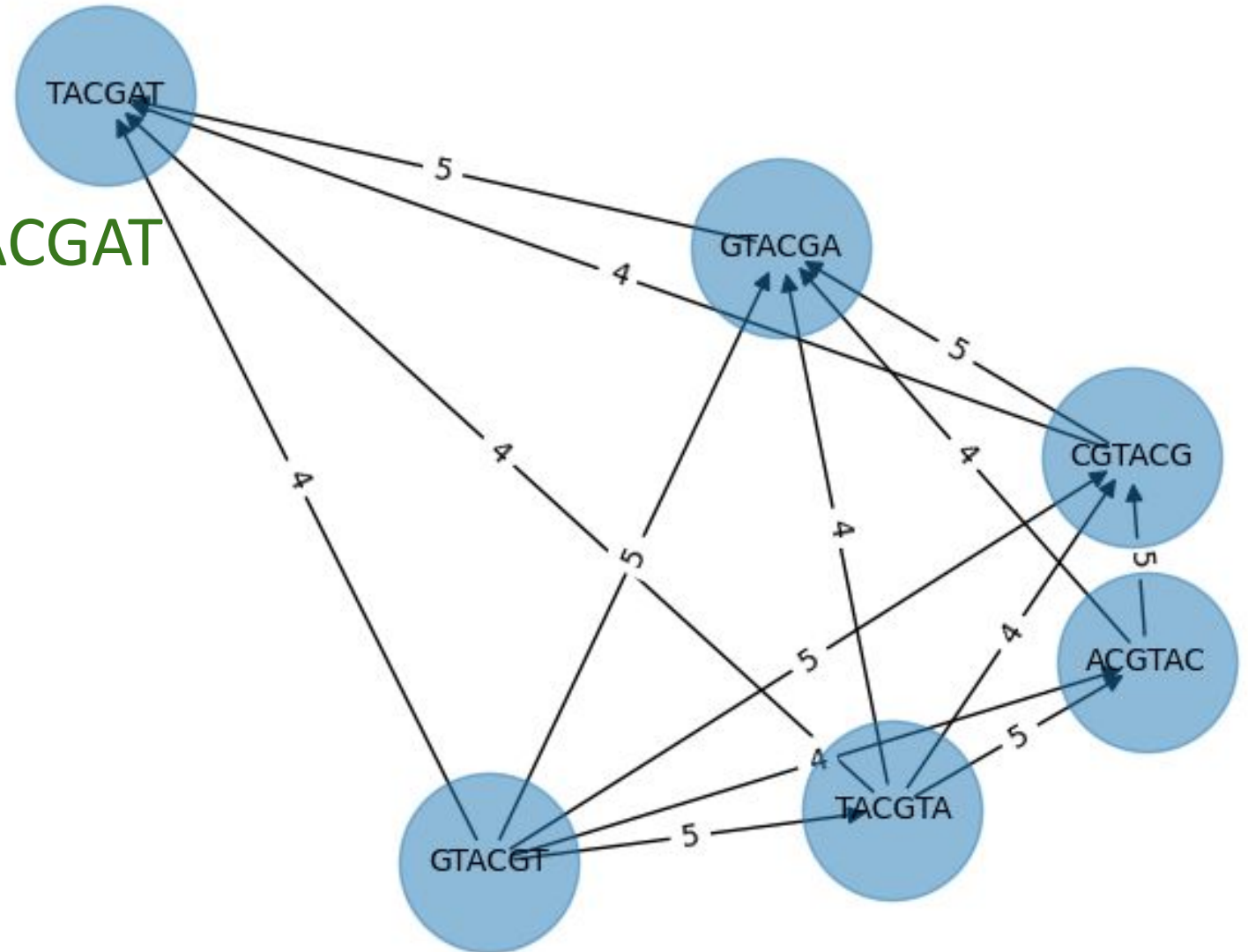
TACGTA

ACGTAC

CGTACG

GTACGA

TACGAT

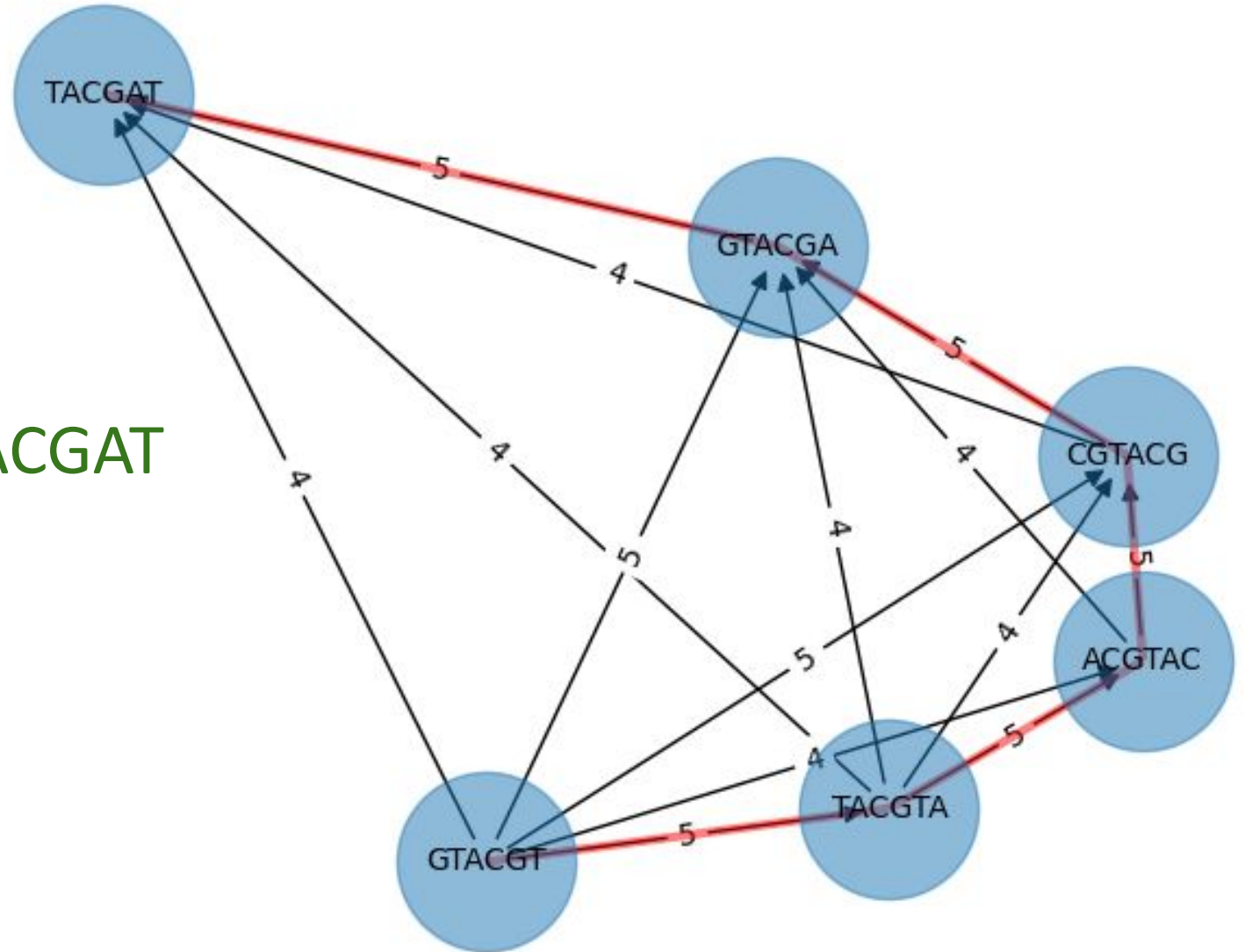


# Overlap Consensus Graph

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Nodes: all 6-mers in **GTACGTACGAT**

Edges: overlaps of length  $> 3$



# Shortest Common Superstring

The Shortest Common Superstring problem (SCS) aim to find the shortest possible string that contains every string in a given set as substrings

Example: BAA AAB BBA ABA ABB BBB AAA BAB

Concatenation: BAAABBBAABABBBAABAB

AAA

AAB

ABB

BBB

BBA

BAB

ABA

BAA

24

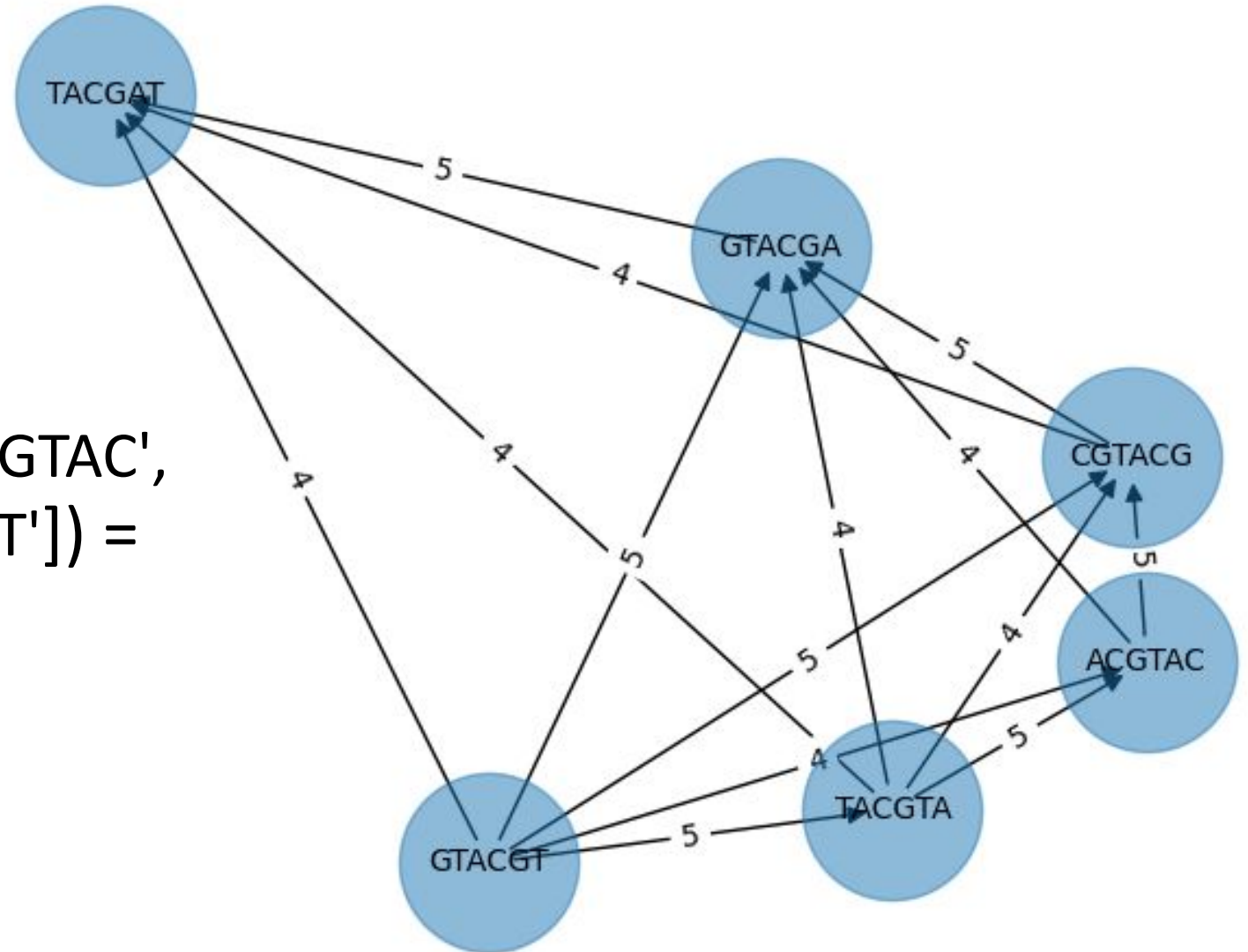
SCS: AAABBBABAA

10

# Shortest Common Superstring

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SCS(['GTACGT', 'TACGTA', 'ACGTAC',  
'CGTACG', 'GTACGA', 'TACGAT']) =  
**GTACGTACGAT**



# Shortest Common Superstring

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## Brute Force

Order 1: AAA AAB ABA ABB BAA BAB BBA BBB  
AAABABBAABABBABBB Superstring 1

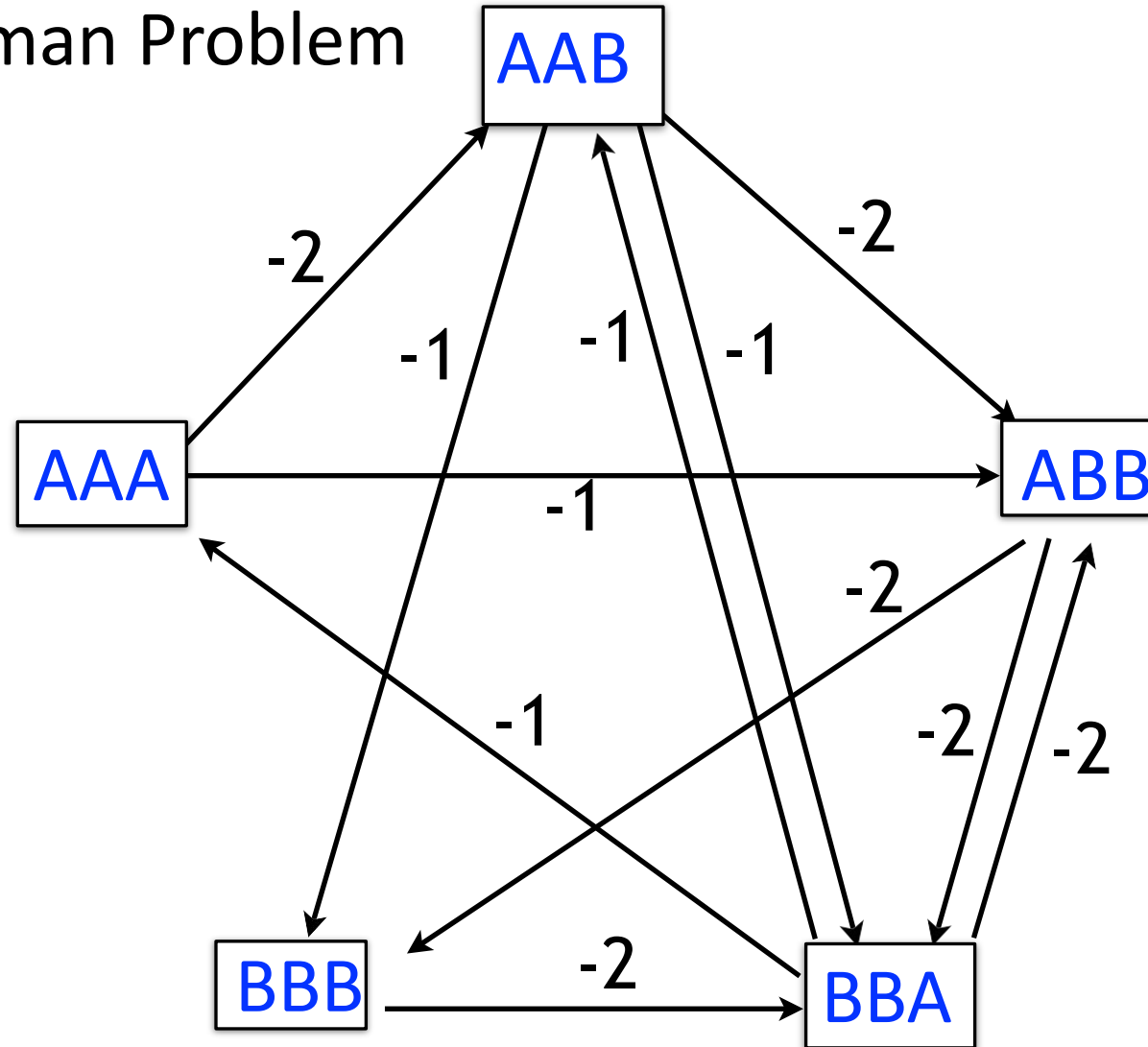
Order 2: AAA AAB ABA BAB ABB BBB BAA BBA  
AAABABBBBAABBA Superstring 2

$O(n!)$

# Shortest Common Superstring

## Traveling Salesman Problem

Modified overlap graph where each edge has cost = - (length of overlap)  
SCS corresponds to a path that visits every node once, minimizing total cost along path





# Shortest Common Superstring

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**NP-complete**

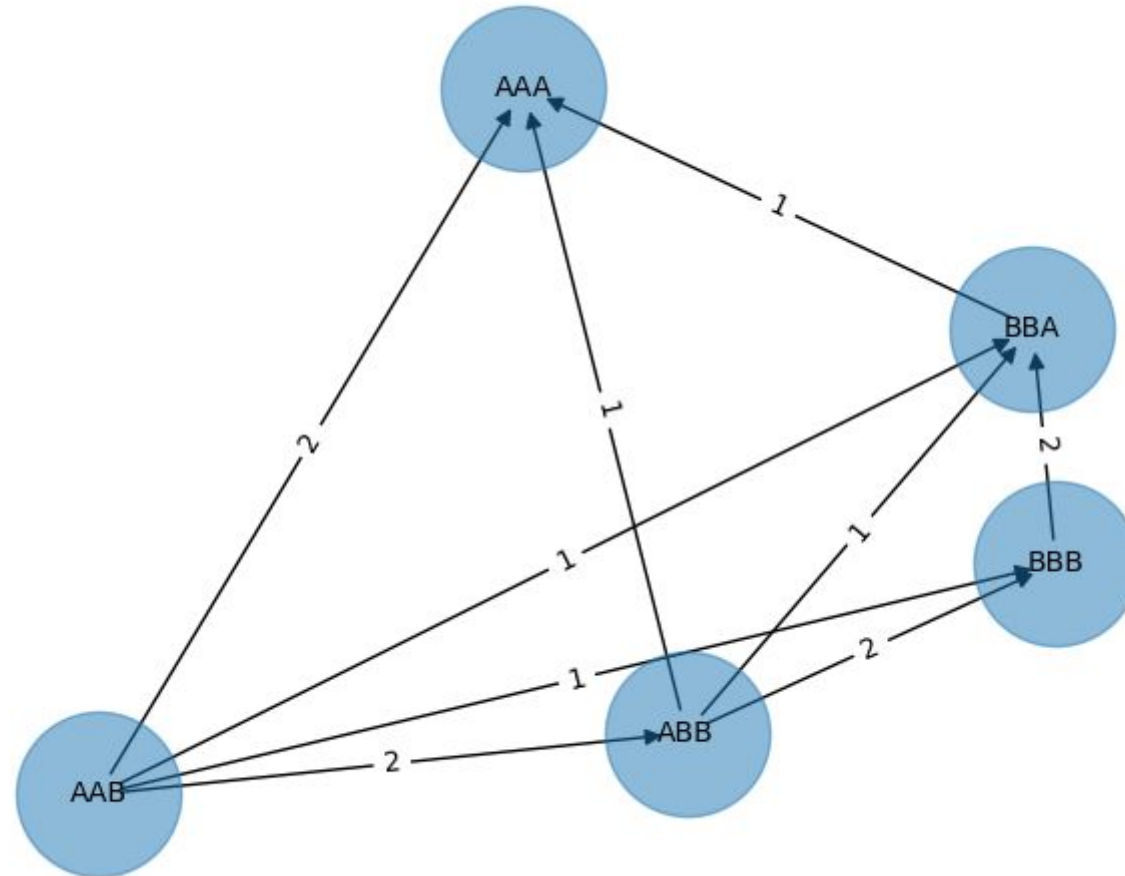
**No efficient solution algorithm has been found**

# Shortest Common Superstring

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Greedy

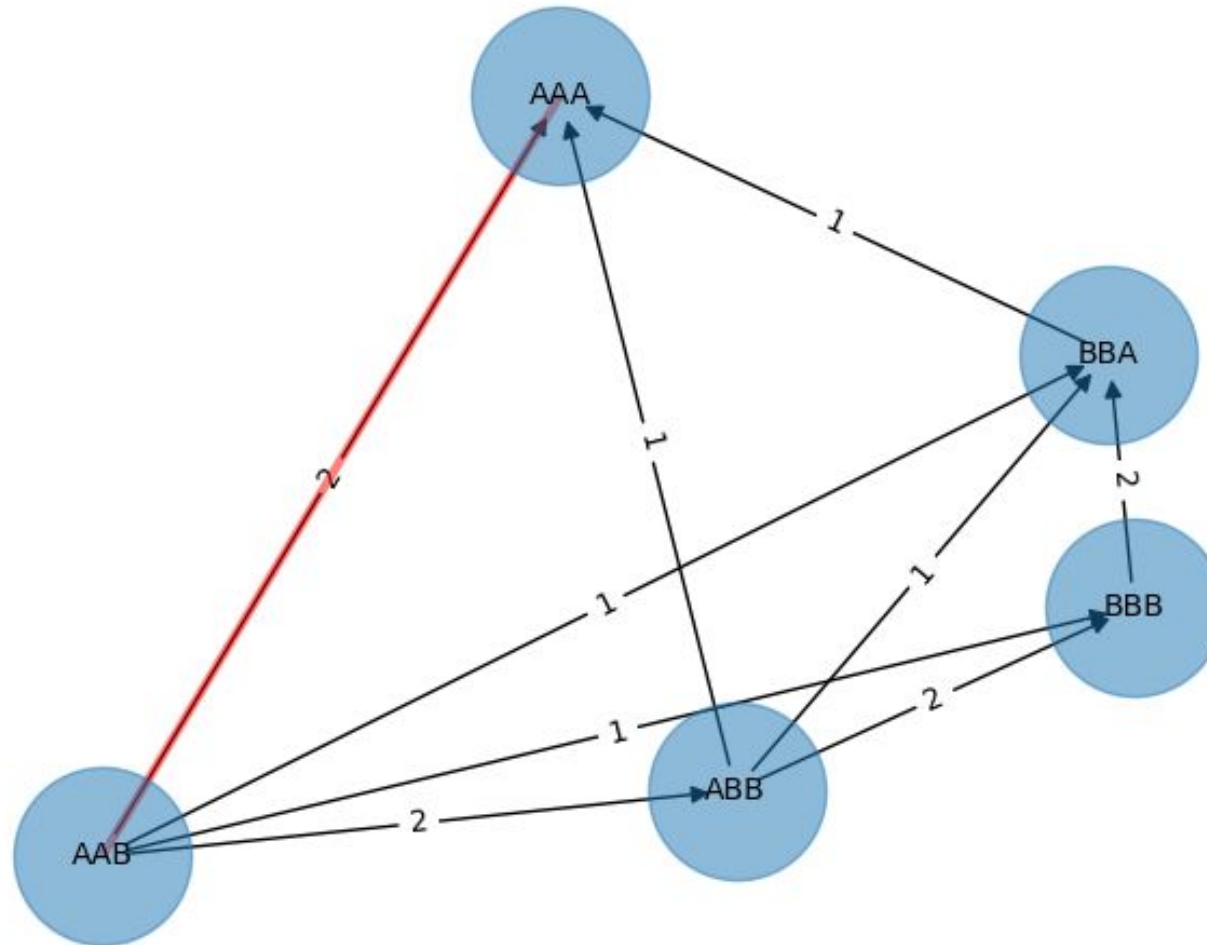
Example: BAA AAB BBA ABA ABB BBB AAA BAB



# Shortest Common Superstring

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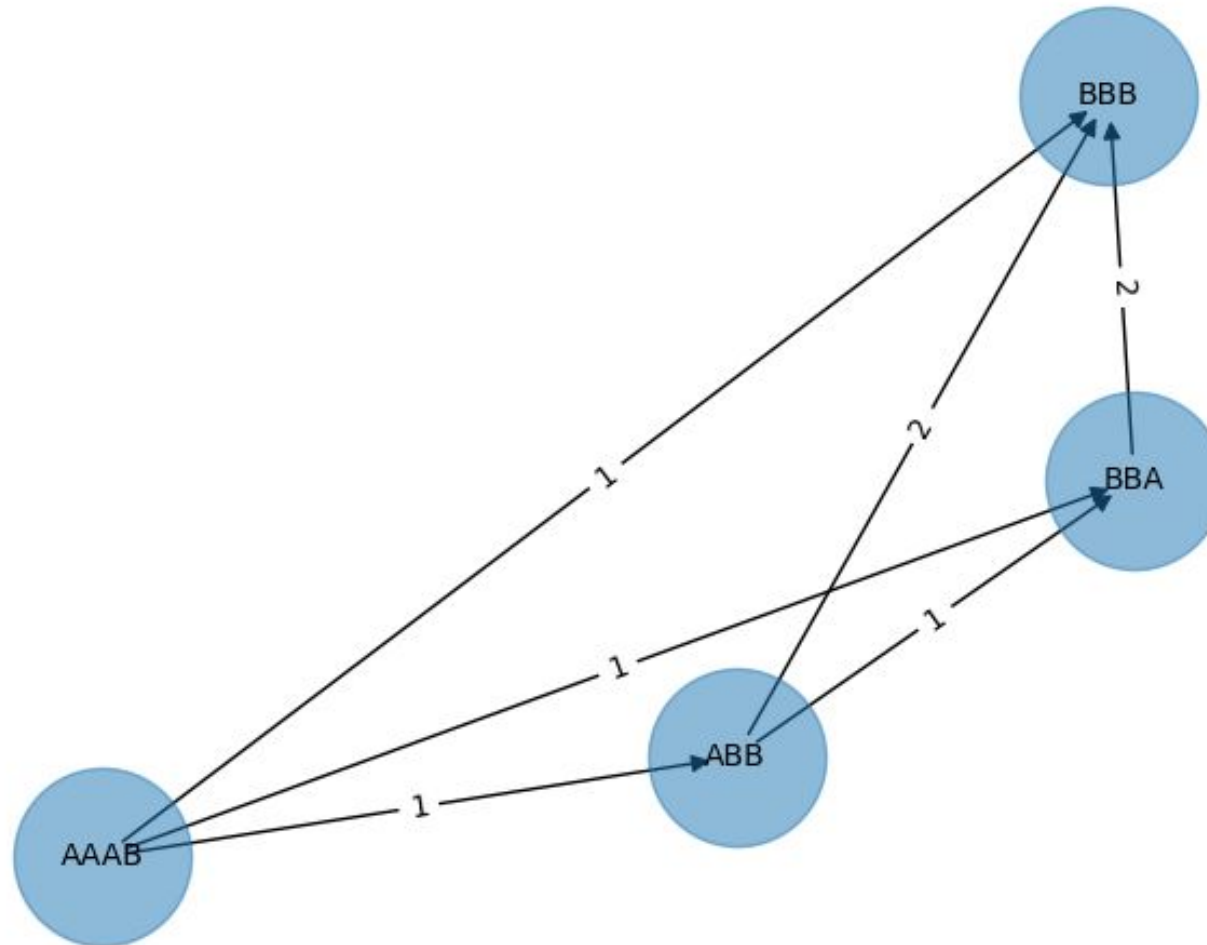
Greedy



# Shortest Common Superstring

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Greedy



# Shortest Common Superstring

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Greedy



Superstring, length 7

Alternative Shuffling



Superstring, length 9

Greedy answer isn't necessarily optimal

# Shortest Common Superstring

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## Greedy

Greedy algorithm is not guaranteed to choose overlaps yielding SCS

But greedy algorithm is a good approximation; i.e. the superstring yielded by the greedy algorithm won't be more than  $\sim 2.5$  times longer than true SCS

[Gusfield, Dan. "Algorithms on Strings, Trees, and Sequences - Computer Science and Computational Biology." \(1997\).](#)

# Shortest Common Superstring

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## Greedy

*a\_long\_long\_long\_time*  $l=6$

ng\_lon \_long\_ a\_long long\_l ong\_ti ong\_lo long\_t g\_long g\_time ng\_tim  
5 ng\_time ng\_lon long\_ a\_long long\_l ong\_ti ong\_lo long\_t g\_long  
5 ng\_time g\_long\_ ng\_lon a\_long long\_l ong\_ti ong\_lo long\_t  
5 ng\_time long\_ti g\_long\_ ng\_lon a\_long long\_l ong\_lo  
5 ng\_time ong\_lon long\_ti g\_long\_ a\_long long\_l  
5 ong\_lon long\_time g\_long\_ a\_long long\_l  
5 long\_lon long\_time g\_long\_ a\_long **Missing a \_long**  
5 long\_lon g\_long\_time a\_long  
5 long\_long\_time a\_long  
4 a\_long\_long\_time  
a\_long\_long\_time

# Shortest Common Superstring

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Repeats often foil assembly. They certainly foil SCS, with its “shortest” criterion!

Reads might be too short to “resolve” repetitive sequences. This is why sequencing vendors try to increase read length.

Algorithms that don’t pay attention to repeats (like our greedy SCS algorithm) might *collapse* them

a\_long\_long\_long\_time

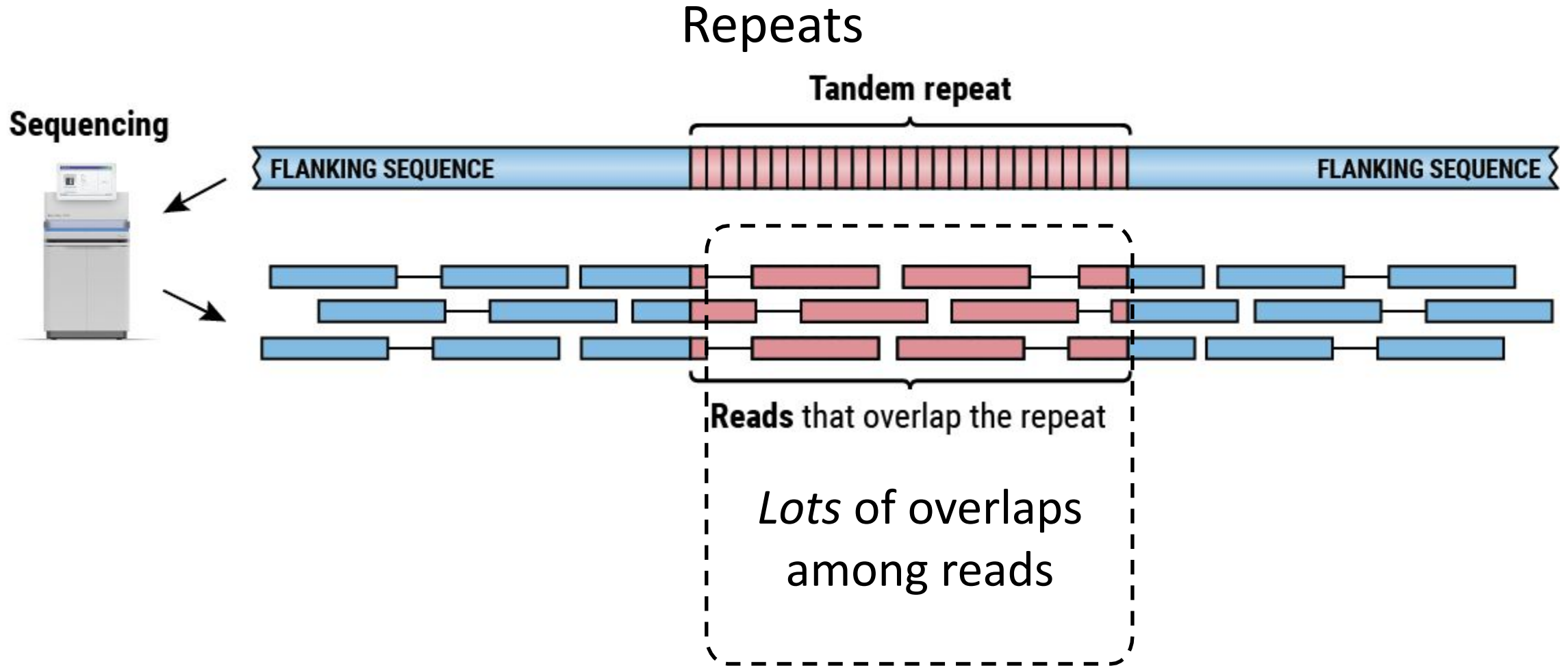
*collapse*

a\_long\_long\_time

The human genome is ~ 50% repetitive!



# Shortest Common Superstring



# Genome Assembly by Reads Overlap - Challenges

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Do we believe short overlaps?

How do we handle sequencing errors?

Computationally ineffective for large data sets

**Bottom line:** not good enough for large and complex genomes (e.g. human)

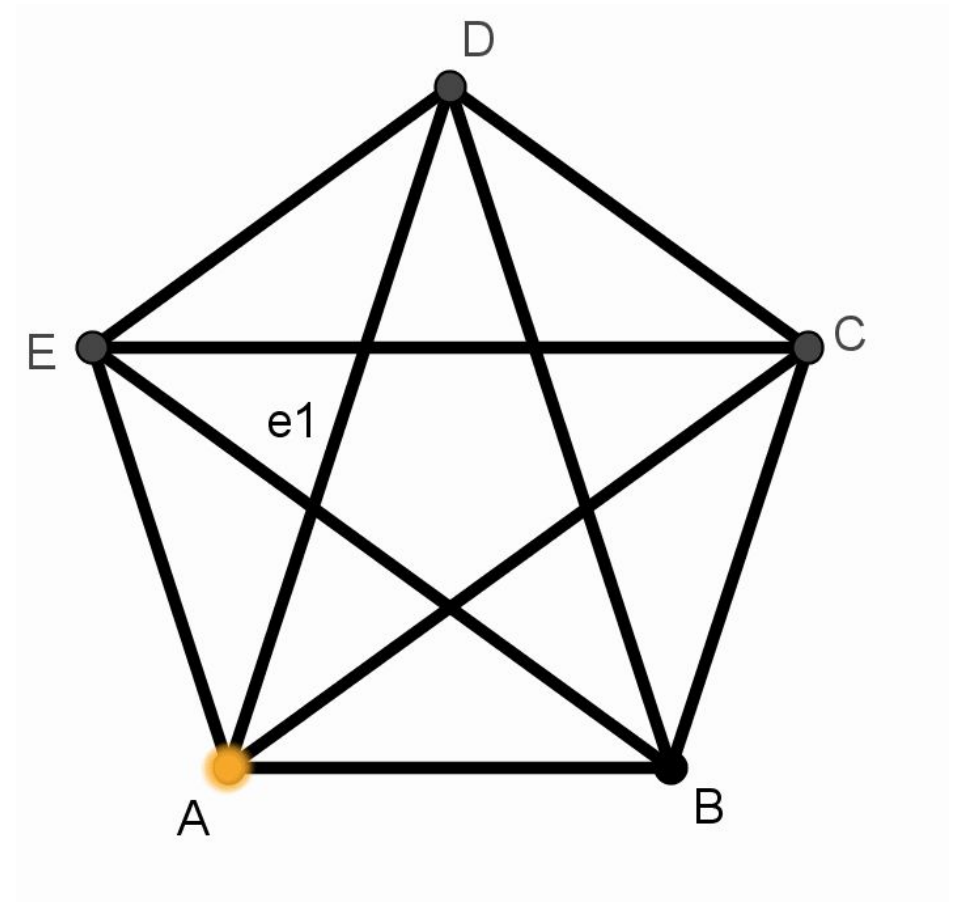
***We need something smarter!***

# The Eulerian path

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A path in a graph that visits every **edge** exactly once

- Must visit **all** edges
- Can't visit an edge twice
- Can visit a node more than once



# K-mers

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AGATCCAGCGAGGTCGCTATCCGTTAATTG

## 5-mers

AGATC

GATCC

ATCCA

...

AATTG

# K-mers

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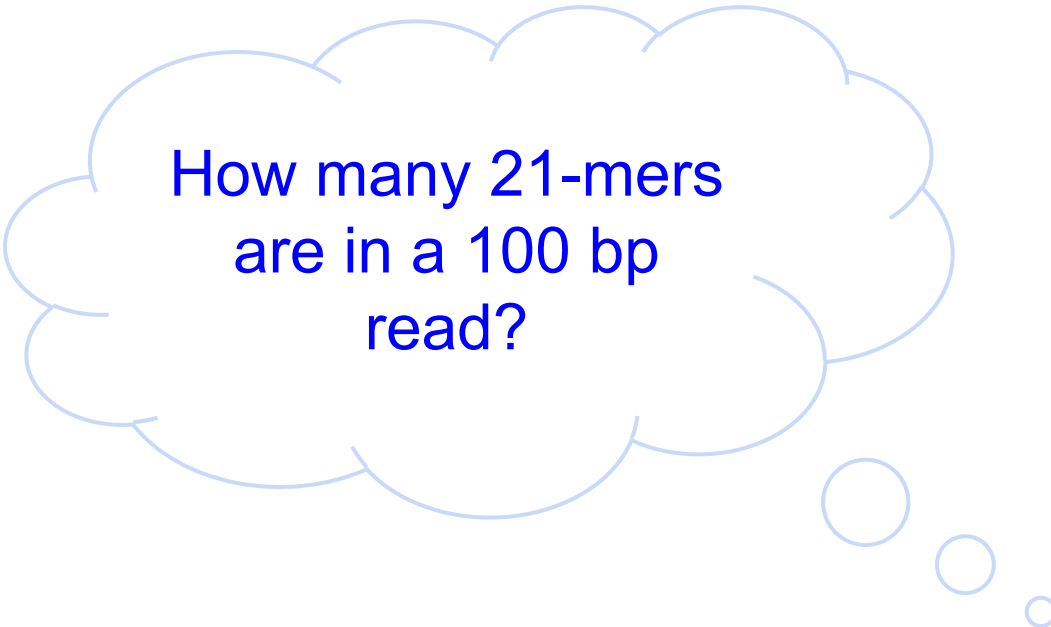
AGATCCAGCGAGGTCGCTATCCGTTAATTG

## 5-mers

AGATC  
GATCC  
ATCCA  
...  
AATTG

## 7-mers

AGATCCA  
GATCCAG  
ATCCAGC  
...  
TTAATTG



How many 21-mers  
are in a 100 bp  
read?

# De Bruijn Graph

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Genome (G=30): AGATCCAGCGAGGTCGCTATCCGTTAATTG

Reads (L=10): AGATCCAGCG

AGCGAGGTCG

GCTATCCGTT

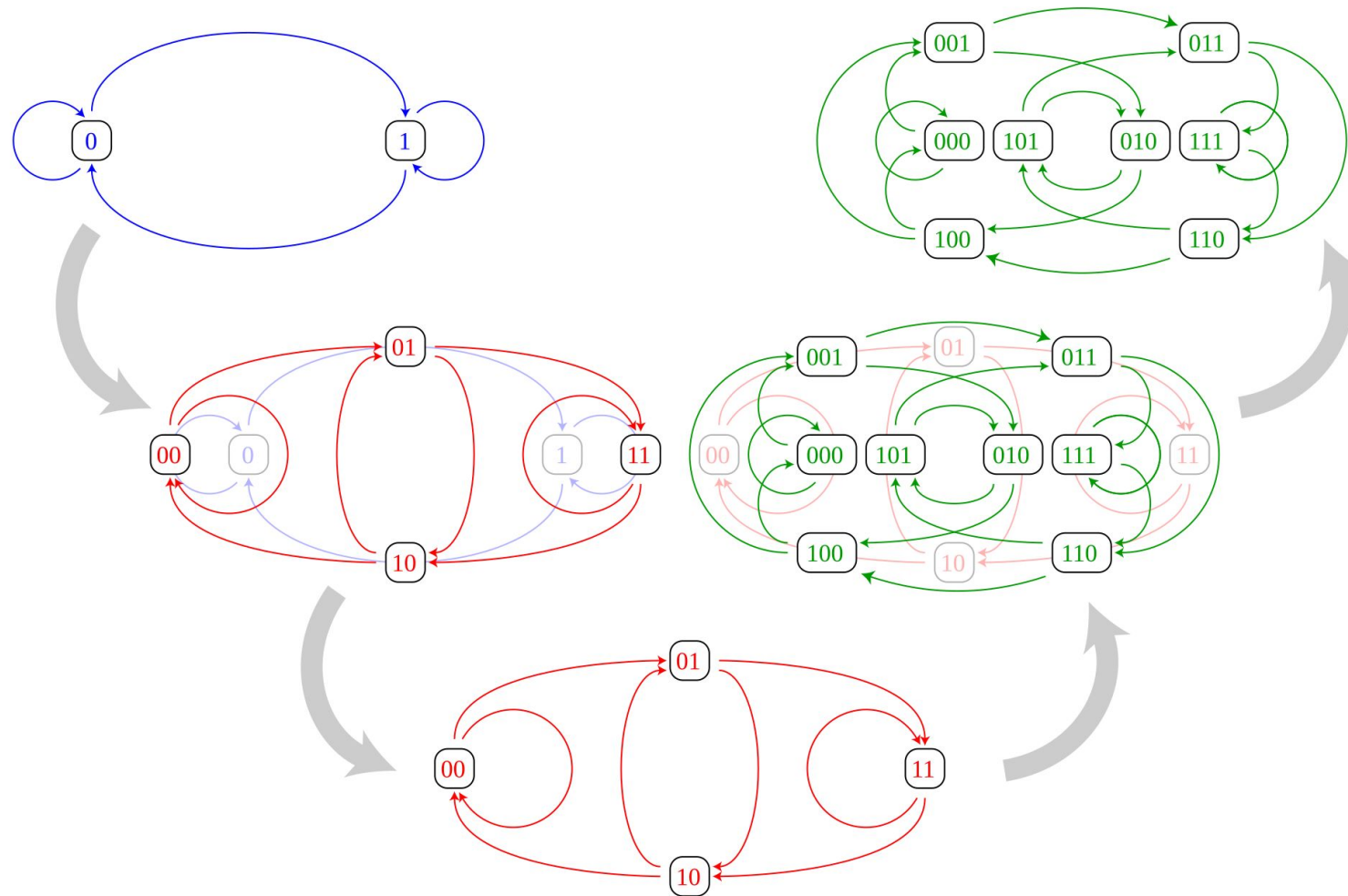
CCGTTAATTG

Break into k-mers (k=4):

AGATCCAGCG → AGAT GATC ATCC TCCA CCAG CAGC AGCG  
AGCGAGGTCG → AGCG GCGA CGAG GAGG AGGT GGTC GTCG

...

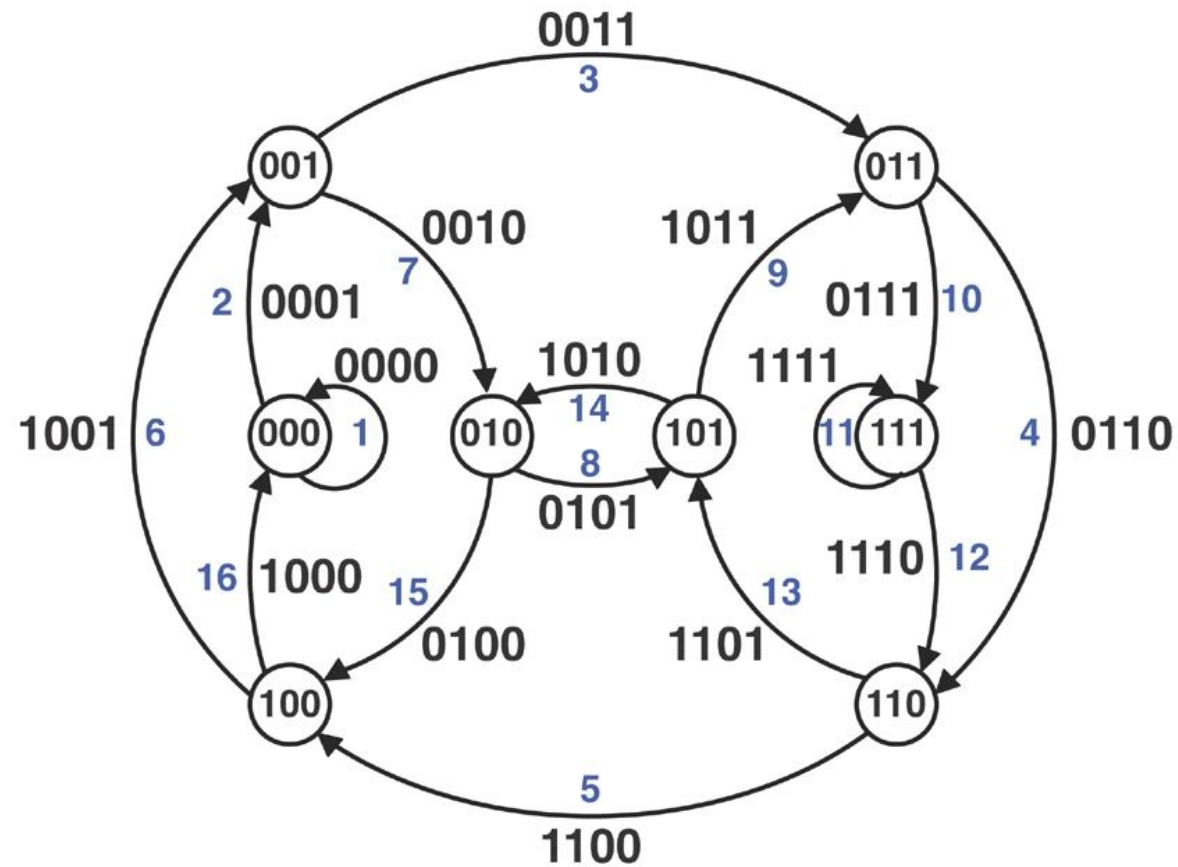
# De Bruijn Graph



[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/De\\_Bruijn\\_graph#](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/De_Bruijn_graph#)

# De Bruijn Graph

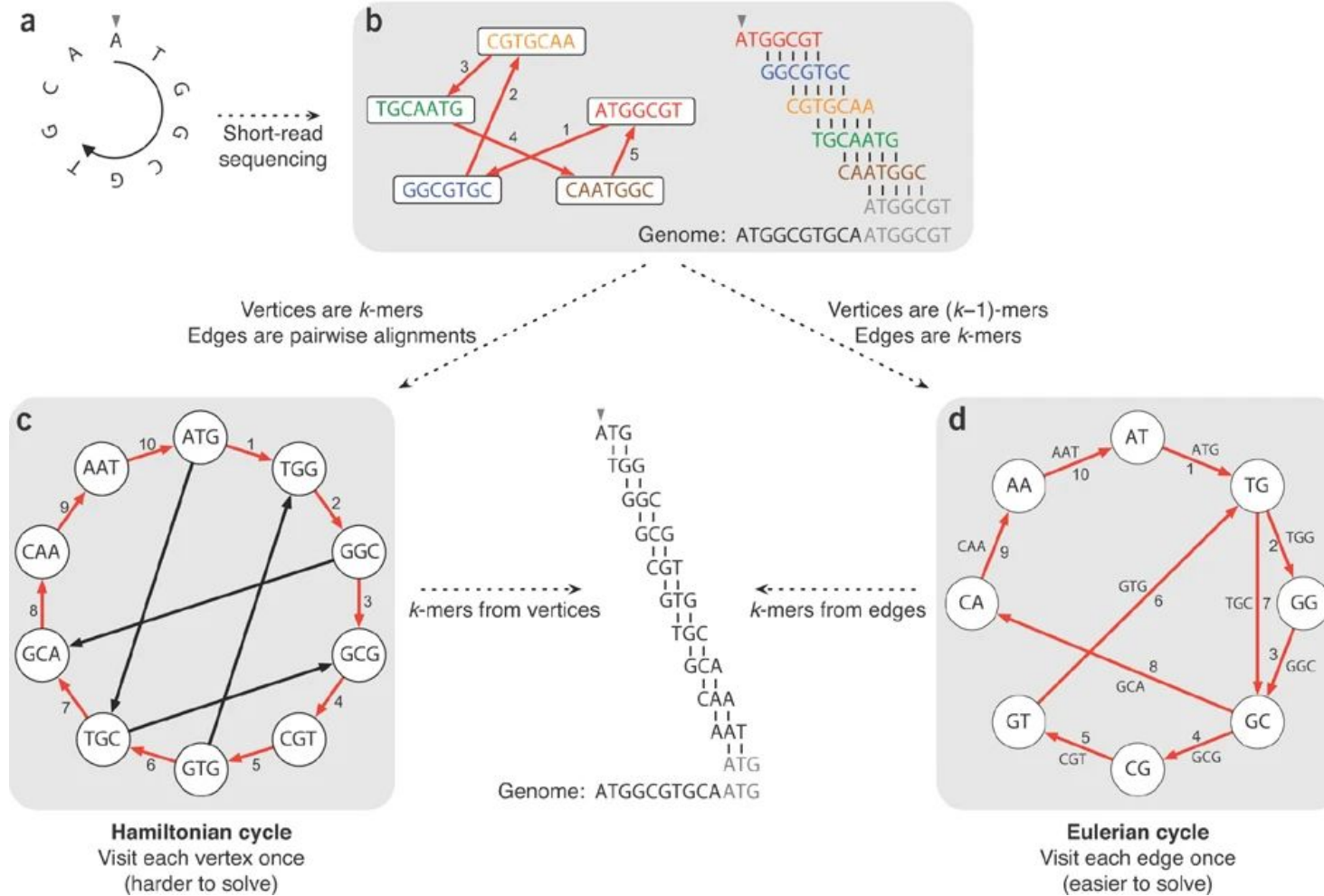
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<https://www.nature.com/articles/nbt.2023>



# De Bruijn Graph

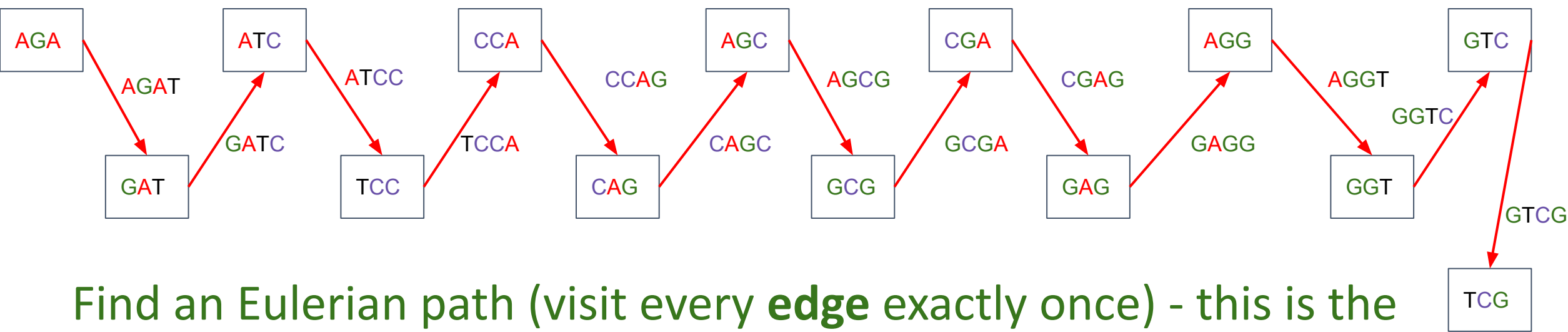


<https://www.nature.com/articles/nbt.2023>

Create graph nodes - each **unique prefix and suffix** of length k-1 of k-mers



Add directed edge between node x and node y if k-mer exists with prefix x and suffix y



Find an Eulerian path (visit every **edge** exactly once) - this is the assembly!

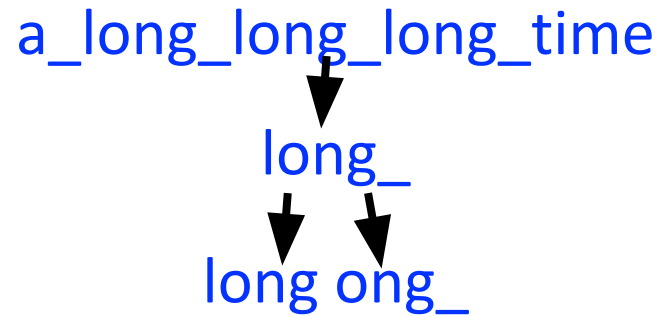
# De Bruijn Graph

A procedure for making a De Bruijn graph for a genome

Assume perfect sequencing where each length-k substring is sequenced exactly once with no errors

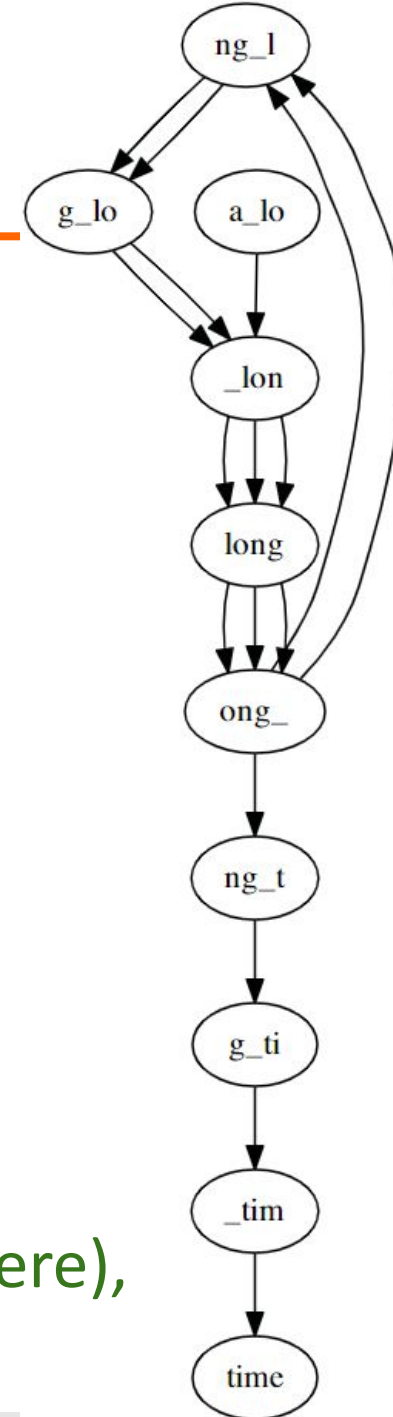
Pick a substring length k: 5

Start with each read:



Take each k mer and split into left and right k-1 mers

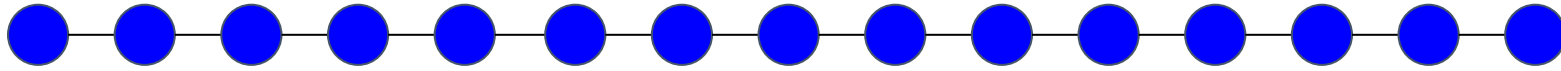
Add k-1 mers as nodes to De Bruijn graph (if not already there), add edge from left k-1 mer to right k-1 mer



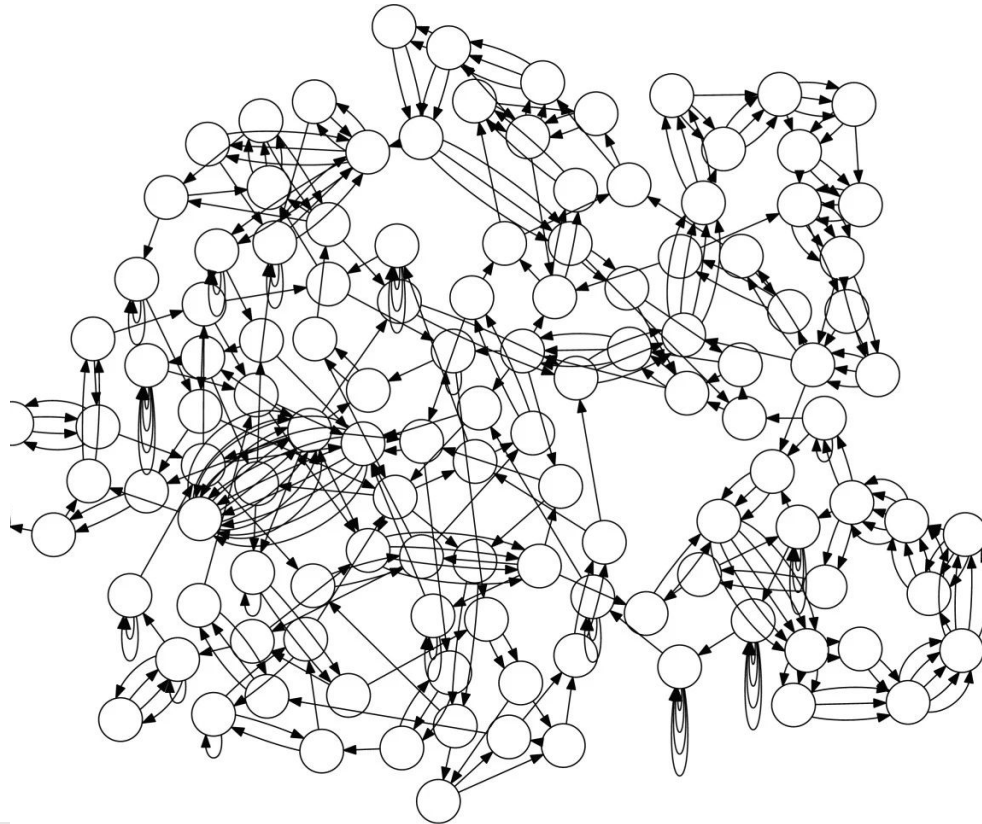
# De Bruijn Graph

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Ideally, we want our graph to look like this:



But in practice:

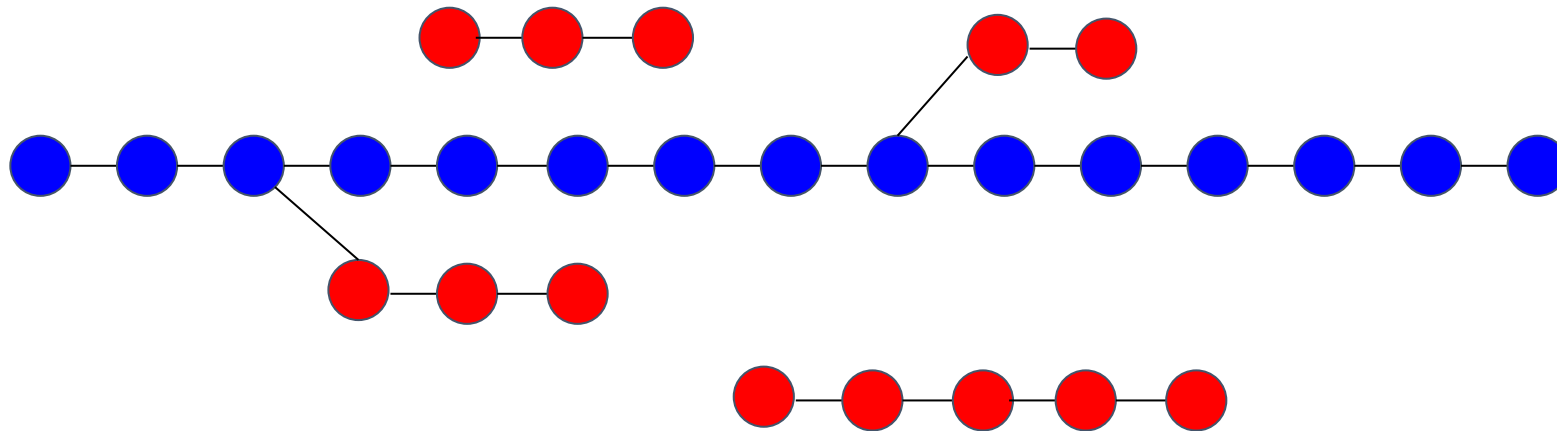


# De Bruijn Graph

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## Sequencing errors

- Side branches
- Disconnected bits

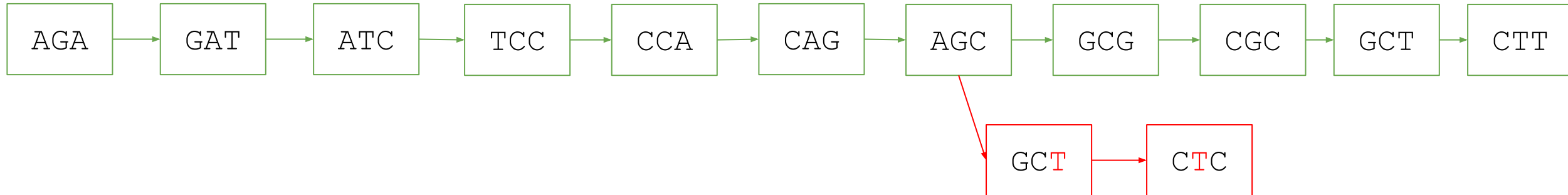


# De Bruijn Graph

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## Sequencing errors

AGATCCAGCG      → AGAT GATC ATCC TCCA CCAG CAGC AGCG  
GATCCAGC**T**C      → GATC ATCC TCCA CCAG CAGC AGC**T** GCT**T**C  
TCCAGCGCTT      → TCCA CCAG CAGC AGCG GCGC CGCT GCTT



# De Bruijn Graph

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## Genomic Repeats

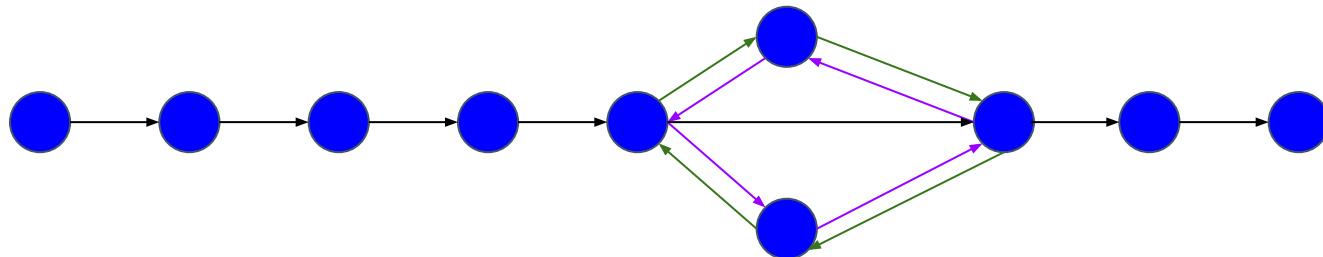
- Tandem duplication



- Interspersed duplications



- Might create ambiguity - multiple possible eulerian paths



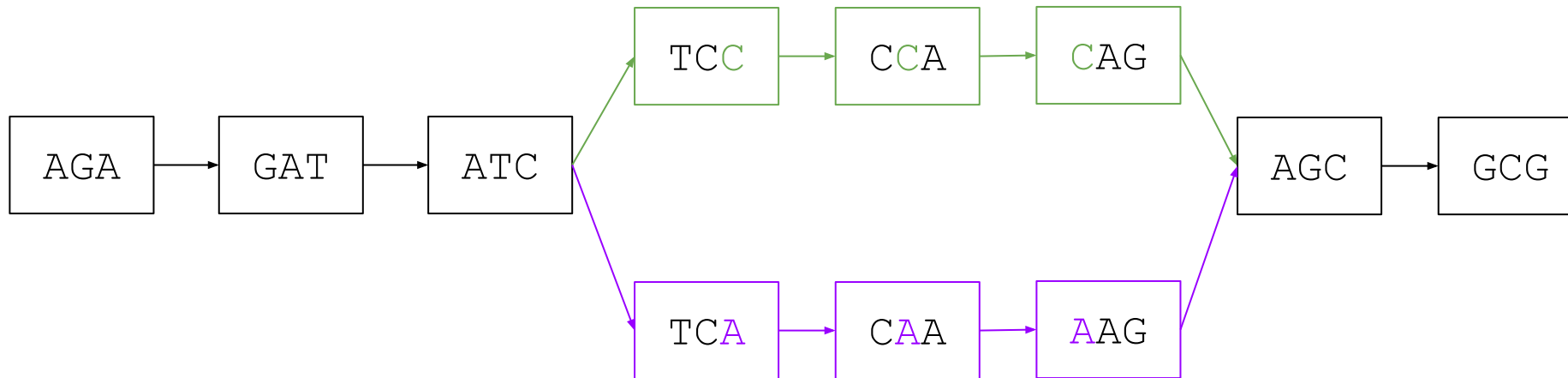
# De Bruijn Graph

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## Heterozygosity

- Creates “bubbles” in the graph

Maternal AGATC**C**AGCG → AGAT GATC ATC**C** TC**C**A CCAG **C**AGC AGCG  
Paternal AGATC**A**AGCG → AGAT GATC ATC**A** TC**A**A CA**A**AG **A**AGC AGCG





# De Bruijn Graph

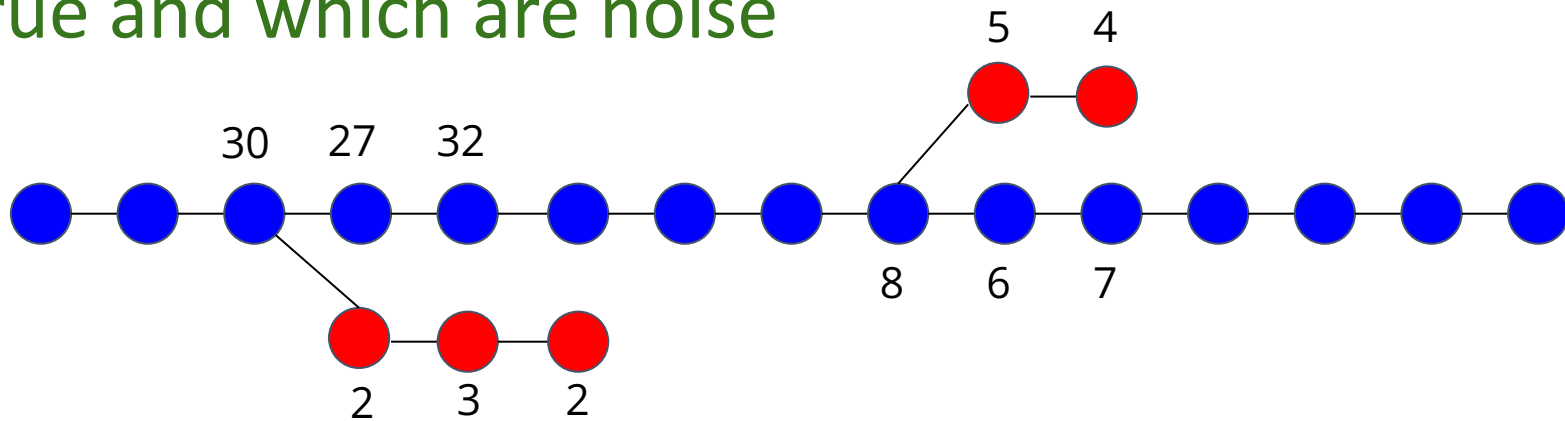
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Uneven sequencing depth

Very low depth (e.g. low complexity regions) can fragment the graph:



Uneven depth can make it hard to determine which branches are true and which are noise



# Error Correction

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Extract all k-mers from all reads

Count how many times each k-mer was observed

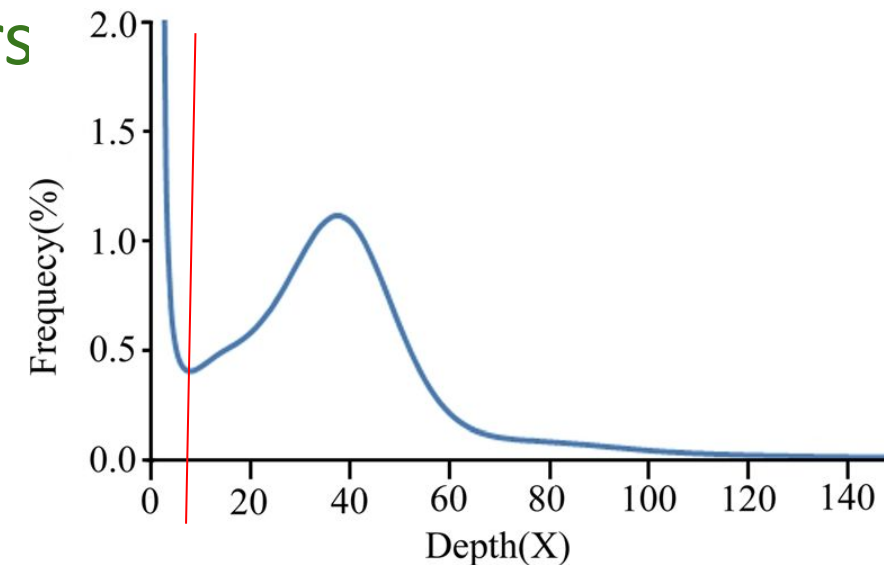
Label rare k-mers as error k-mers

Find reads from which error k-mers came

Discard or correct the reads with error k-mers

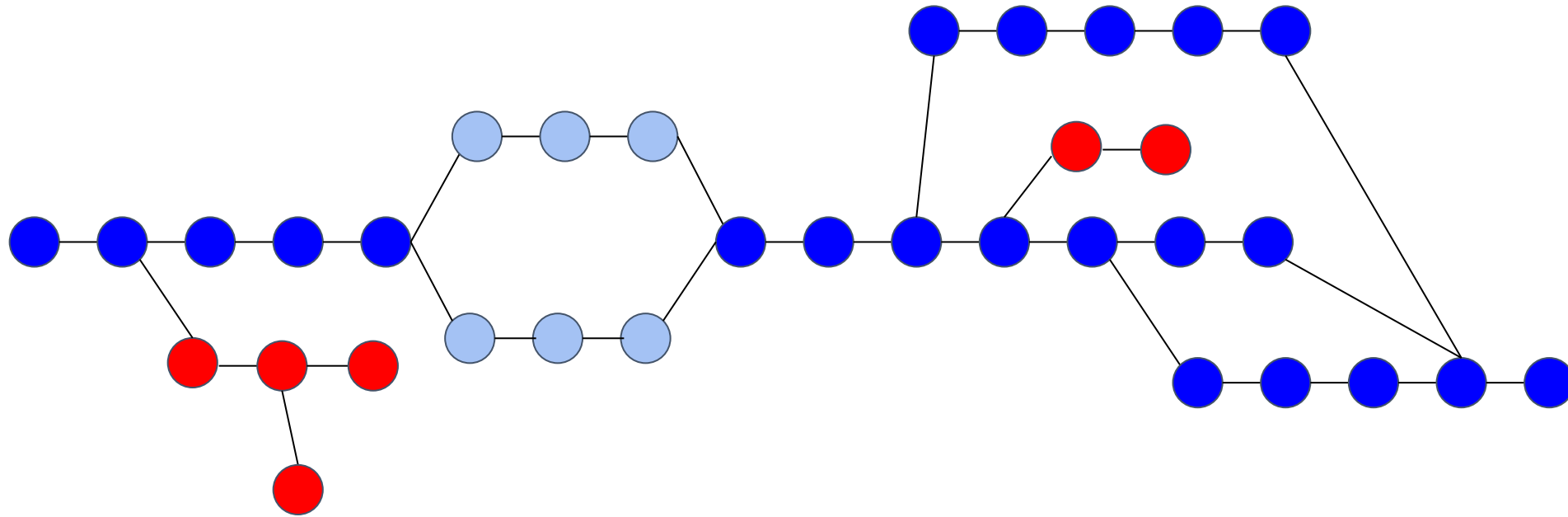
Count(GGATAGGCACCAGTTAT) = 30

Count(GGATAGG**T**ACCAGTTAT) = 1



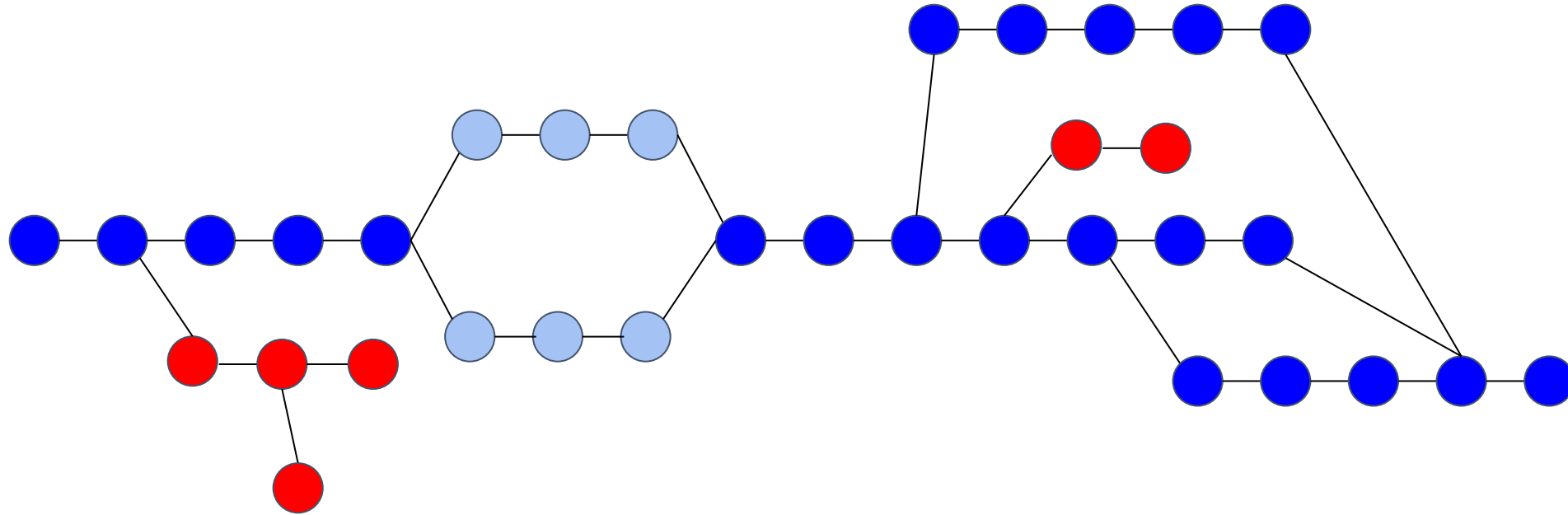
# Build De Bruijn Graph

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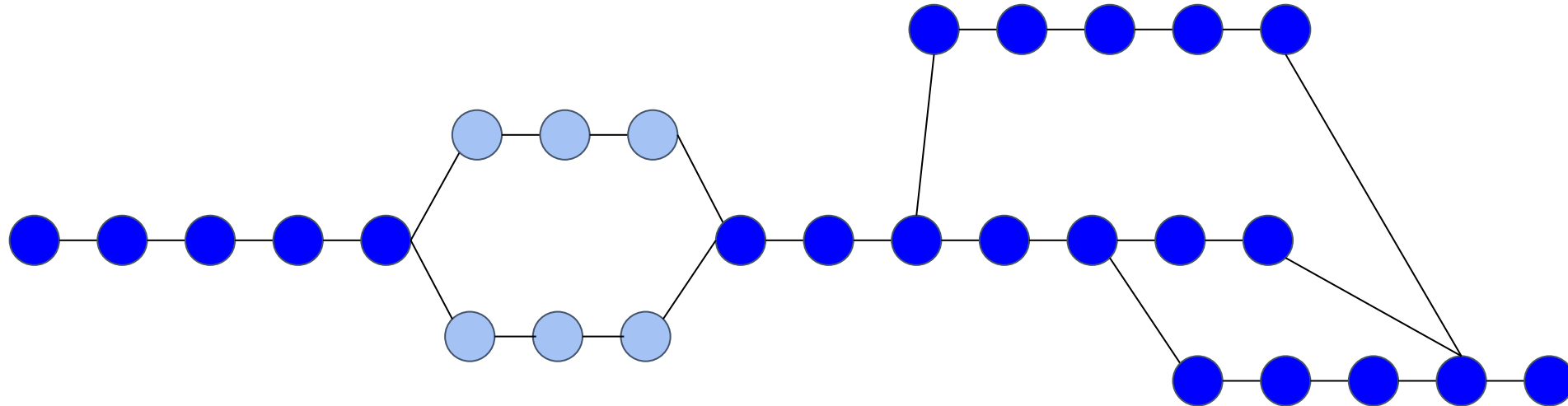
# Prune Error Branches

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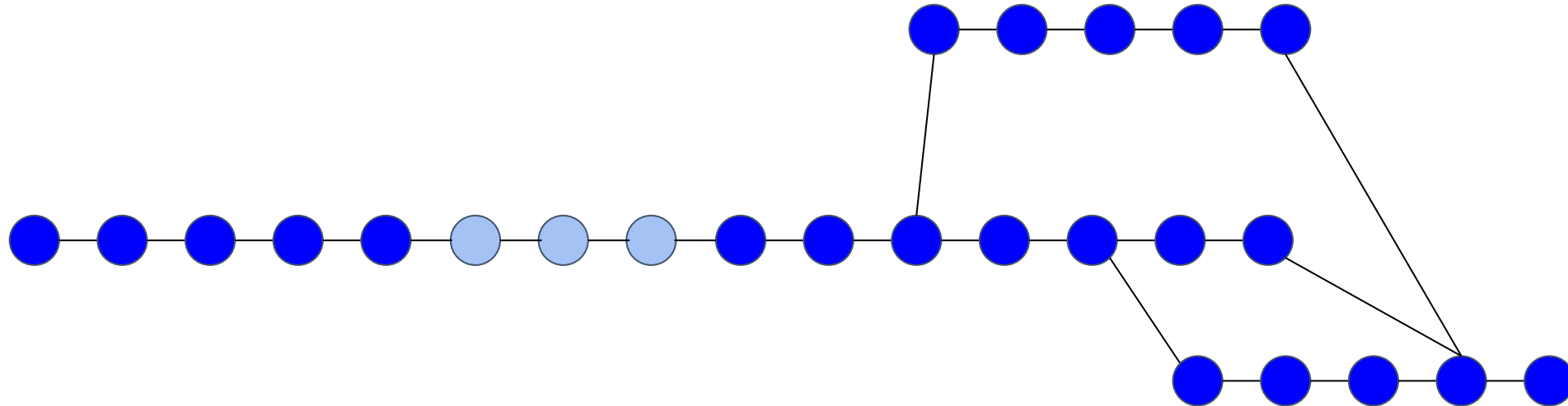
# Resolve Bubbles

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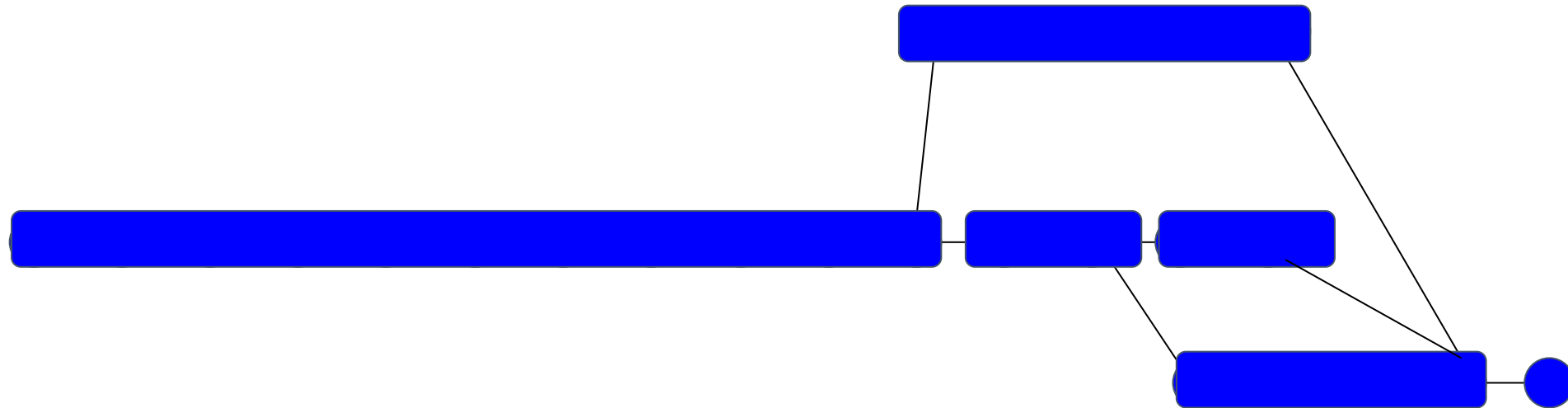
# Resolve Bubbles

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# Create Contigs

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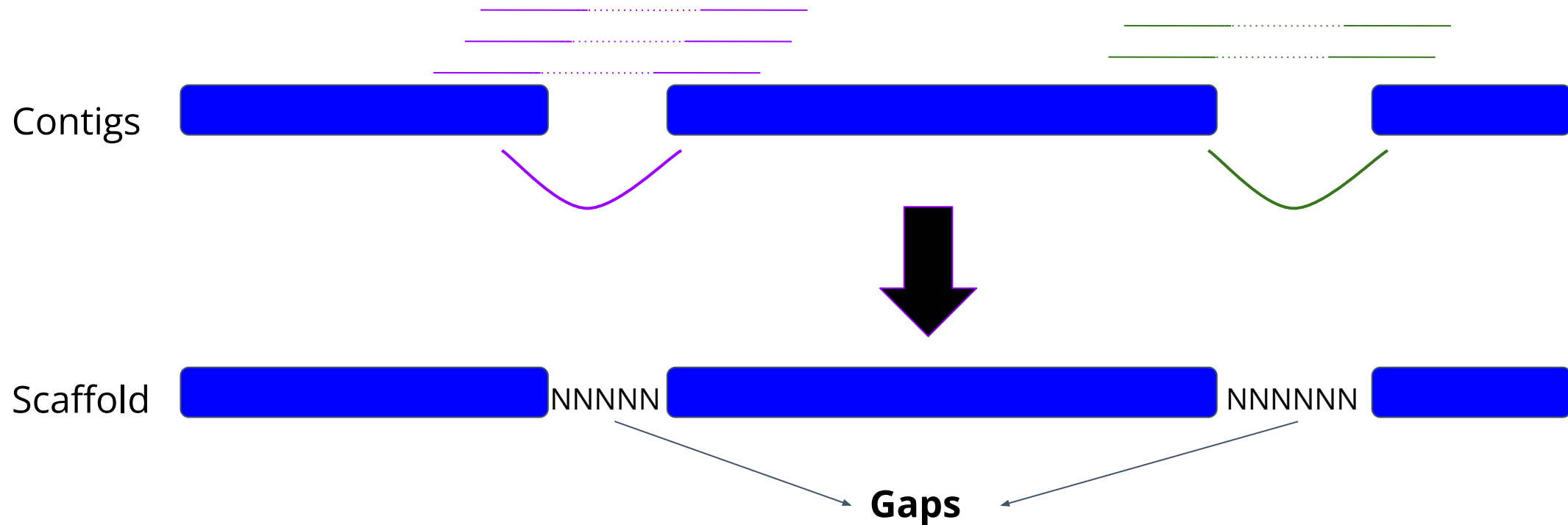


# Scaffolding

## Mate Pair Sequencing

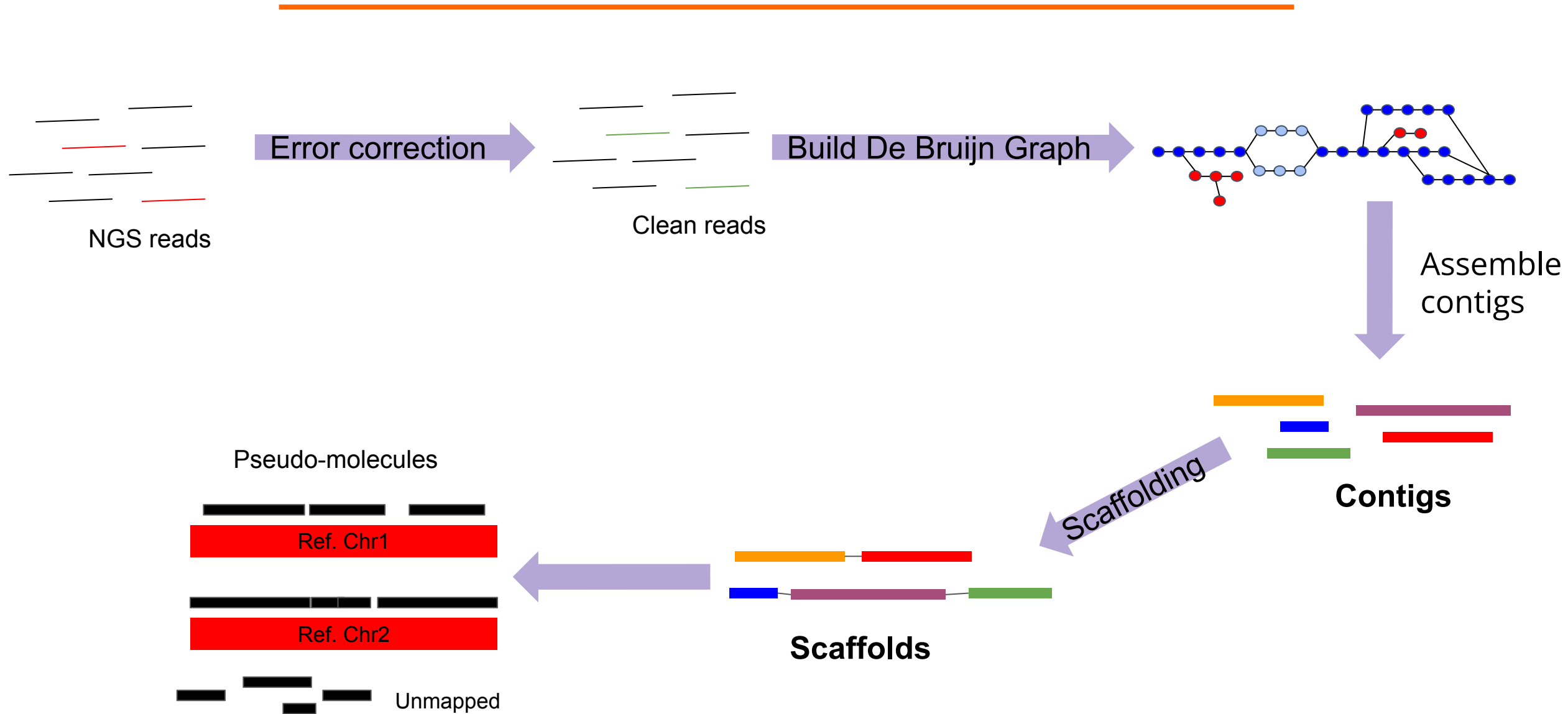
Use paired end information

Look for evidence of two contigs linked together





# Workflow



# De Bruijn Graph

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Currently the most popular assembly method

Many software tools use variants of the method

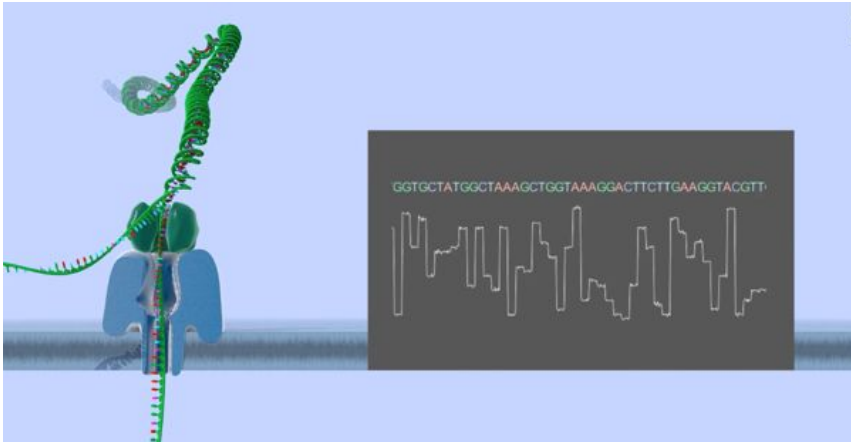
- SPAdes
- SOAPdenovo
- AbySS
- MEGAHIT



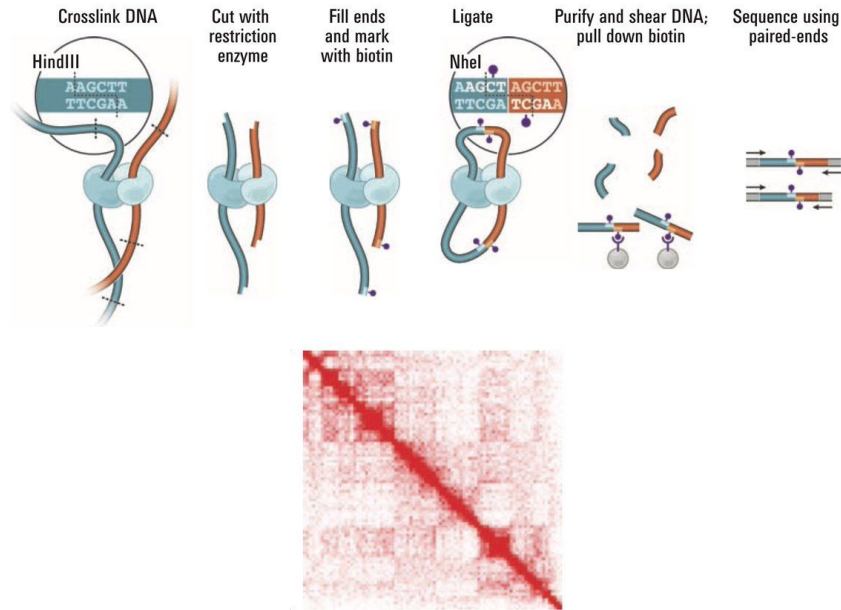
SPAdes

# Emerging Technologies for Genome Assemblies

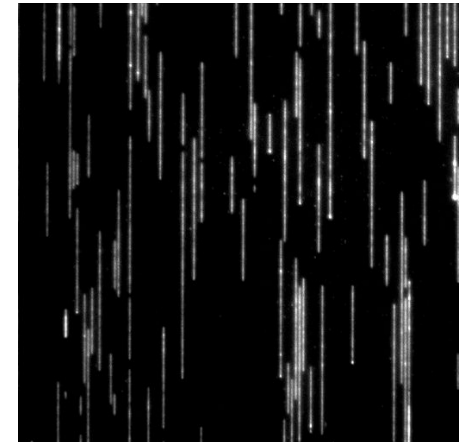
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Long reads



Hi-C



Optical mapping

# Long and Linked Reads in Genome Assembly

Many modern assemblers can work with 3<sup>rd</sup> generation reads

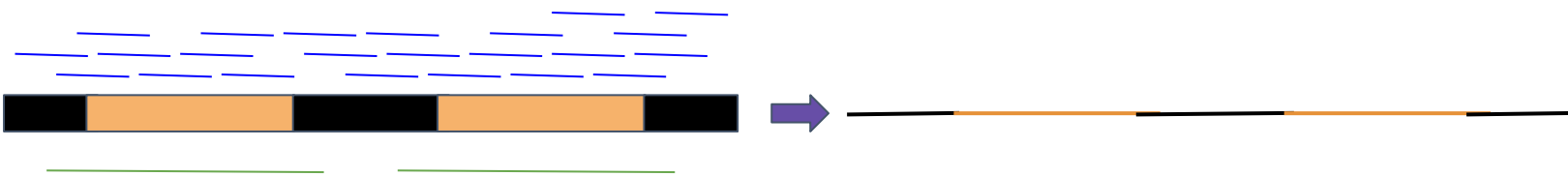
- Falcon - PacBio reads
- Canu, SPAdes - PacBio and ONT reads
- Supernova - 10X reads

Most assemblers take a “hybrid” approach - long + short reads

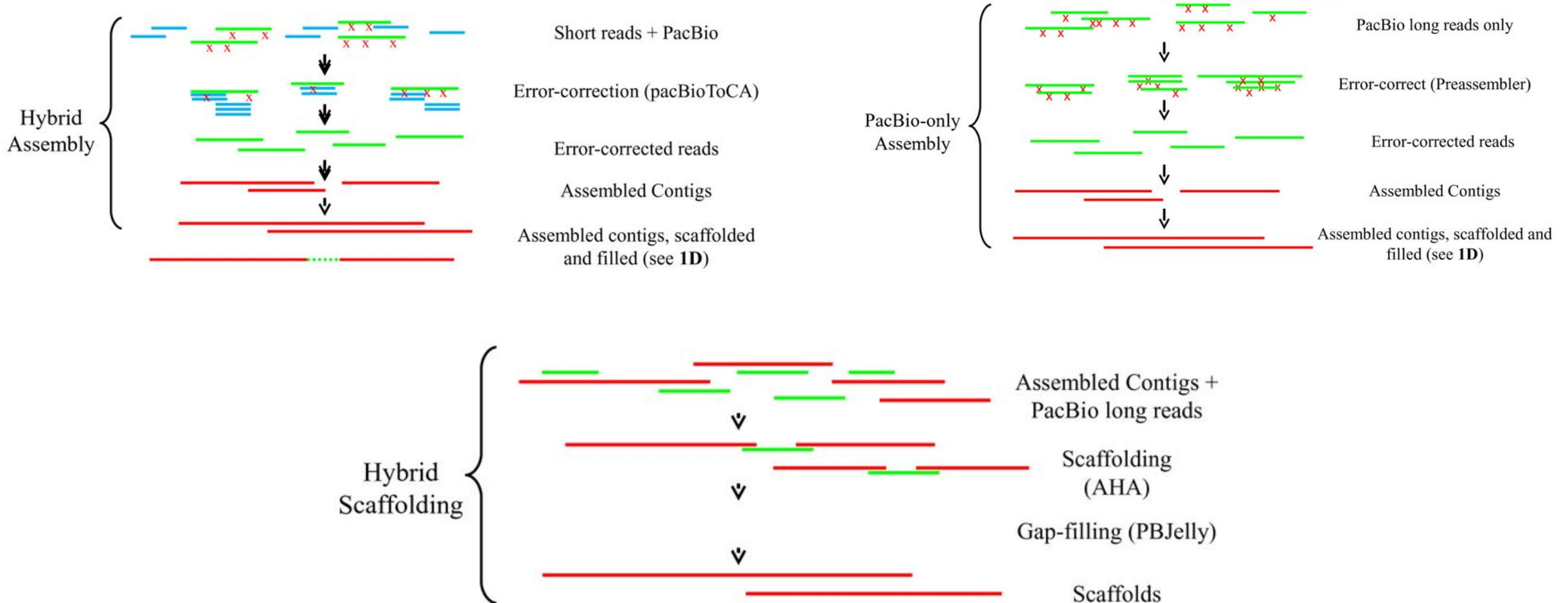
Long/linked reads can help link contigs by bridging over difficult regions



Long reads can help solve long repeats



# Different Assembly Strategies



# Haplotype Phasing

---

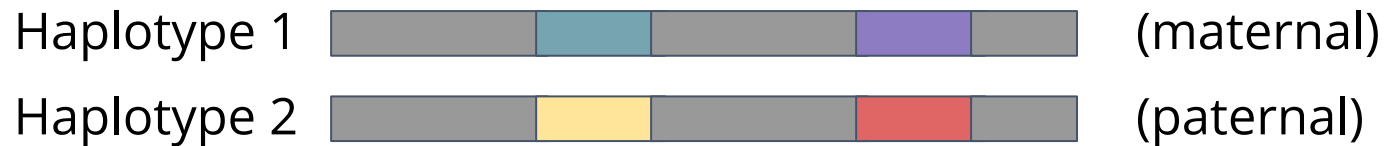
Many interesting eukaryote genomes are diploid or polyploid

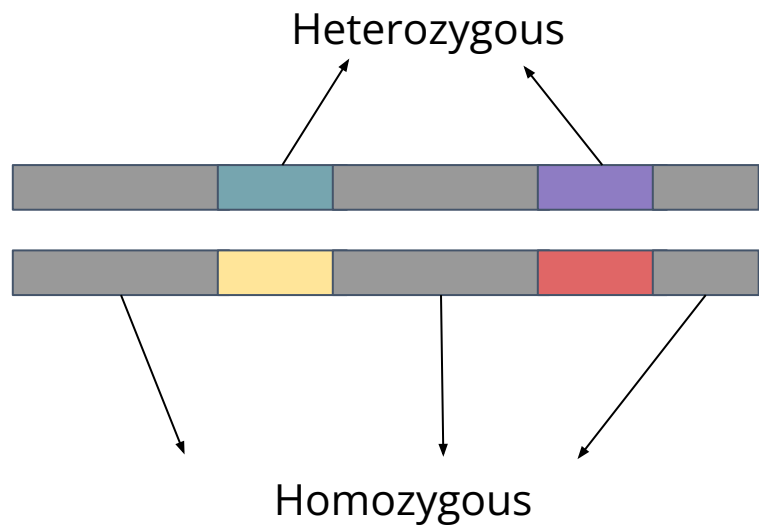
Still, most assemblies are haploid

Heterozygosity is “squished” into consensus sequences

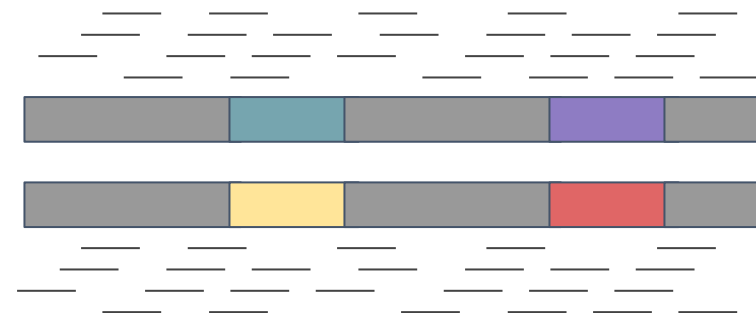
A **haplotype** is a group of alleles arising from the same molecule

Splitting an assembly into haplotypes is called **phasing**

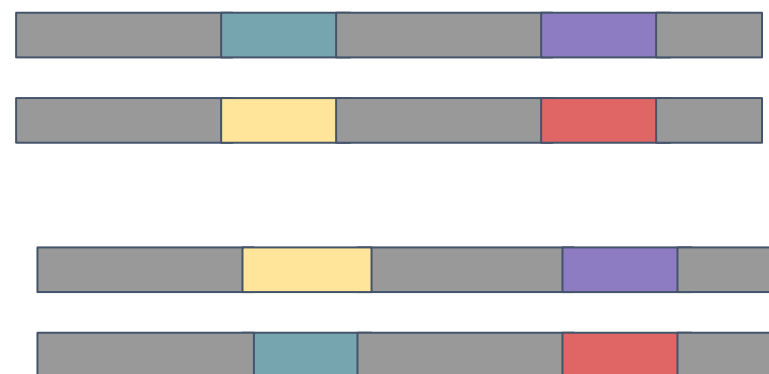
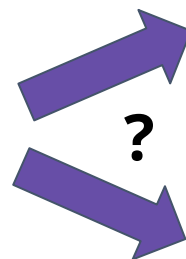
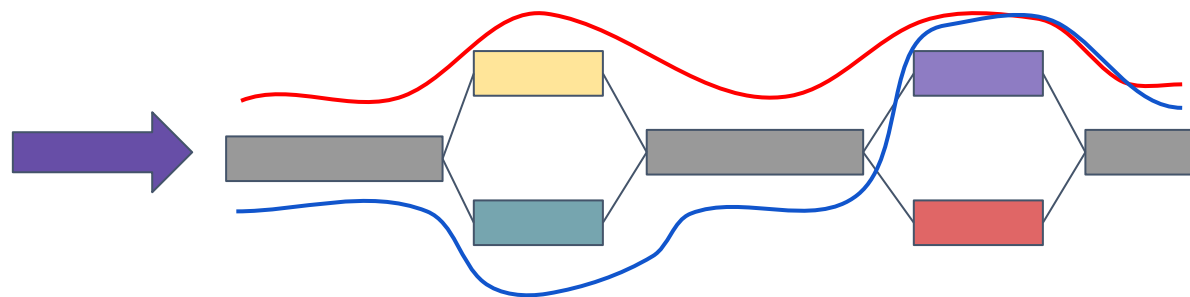
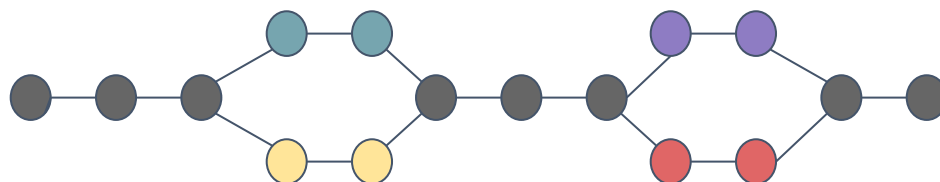




Short read sequencing



De Bruijn graph



# DNA Sequencing and Data Analysis

---

**RNA-Seq**



# Lesson Goals

---

Understand some common RNA-seq uses and protocols

Be familiar with the basic workflow of gene expression data analysis

- Specifically differential gene expression analysis

Know how to map RNA-seq reads to a reference genome using STAR

Perform Differential Gene Expression (DGE) analysis

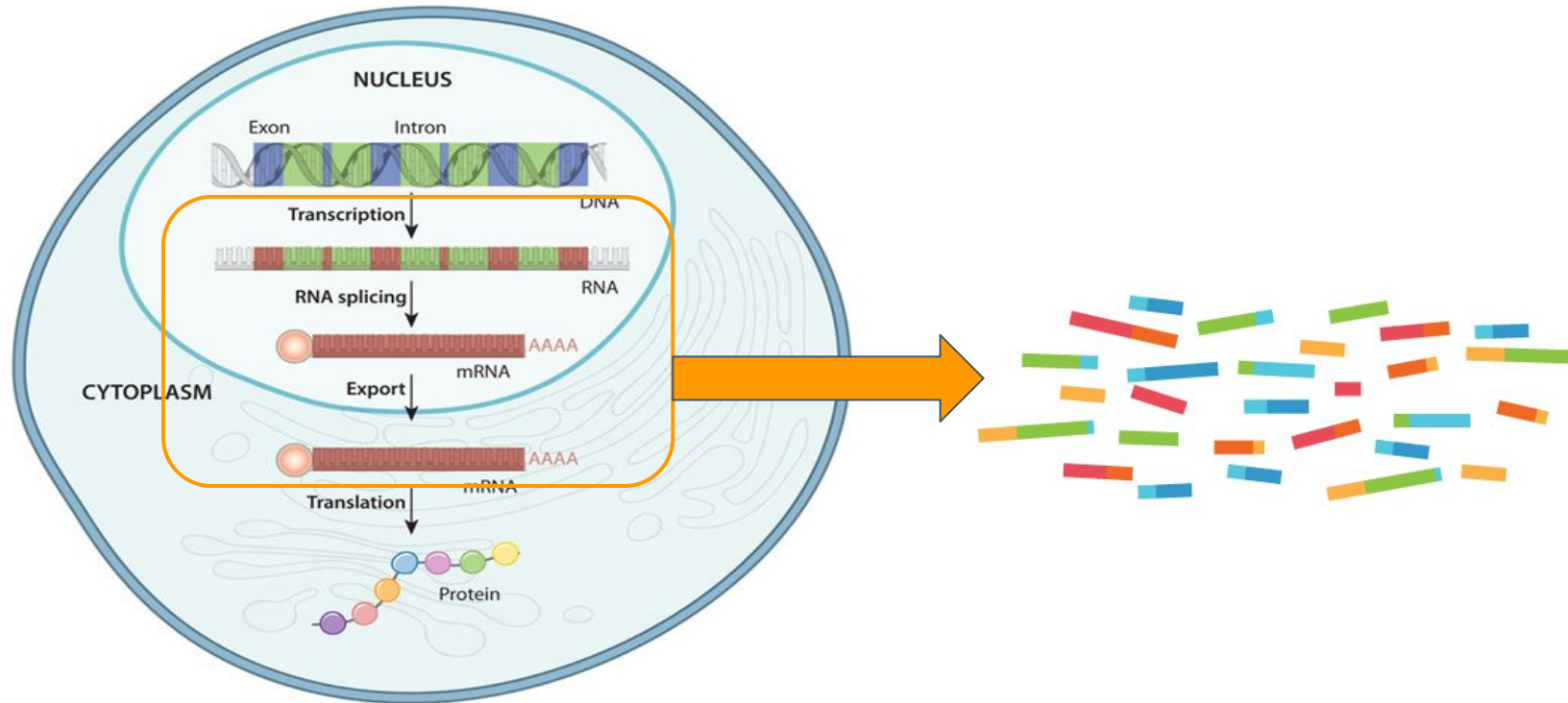
# What is RNA-Sequencing?

---

Sequencing of RNA using NGS technology

Allows assessment of presence and quantity of RNA in a sample

Take a snapshot of expression in a sample



# Why Study the Transcriptome?

---

*The full range of messenger RNA molecules expressed by an organism*

Indication of cell physiology

Dynamic - responds to the environment

- Changes over time
- Responds to external stimuli
- Controls cellular processes

Reduced representation of the genome

- Smaller = cheaper
- Only the “functional” parts of the genome

# Types of Expression Analysis

---

Expression quantification

Differential gene expression

Assemble whole transcriptomes

Detect new transcripts

Detect splicing variants

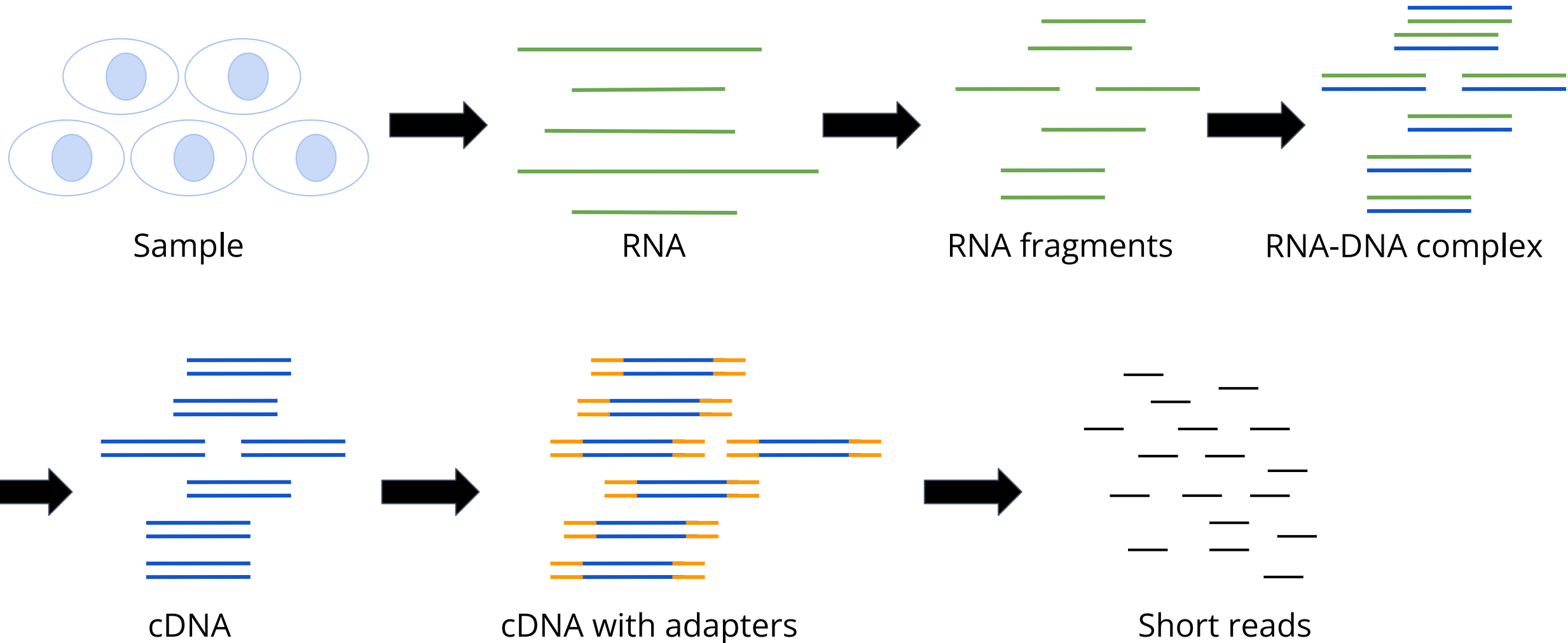
Detect allele-specific expression

Gene co-expression

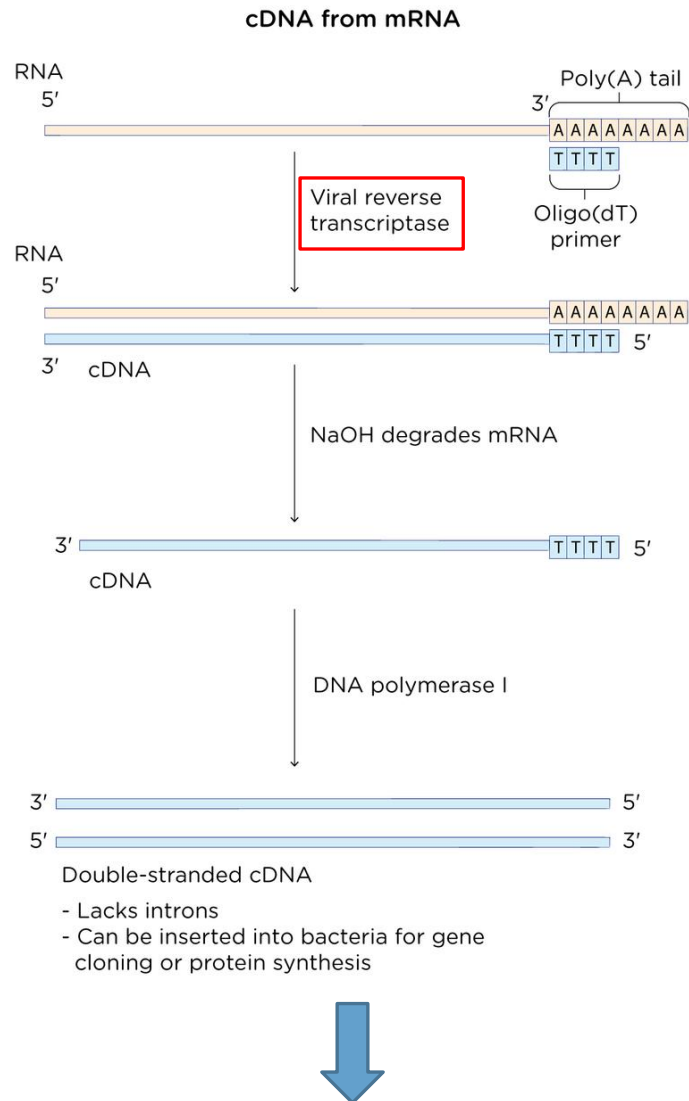
Single-cell analysis

# RNA-Seq Basic Protocol

---



# cDNA



**And continue as before!**

**RNA is unstable and can easily degrade, while cDNA is stable and easier to work with!**

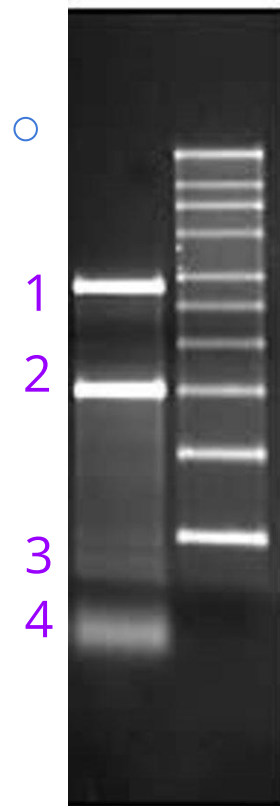
## cDNA (complementary DNA) Libraries:

- Collections of only the coding regions of an organism's genes.
- The genes being expressed at a certain time point.
- Help in studying gene expression, understanding disease mechanisms, and can be used in drug discovery.
- Help to study alternative splicing, mutations, and gene fusion events in cancer studies.
- Insertion into a vector, and transformation into bacteria for amplification.

# Total RNA

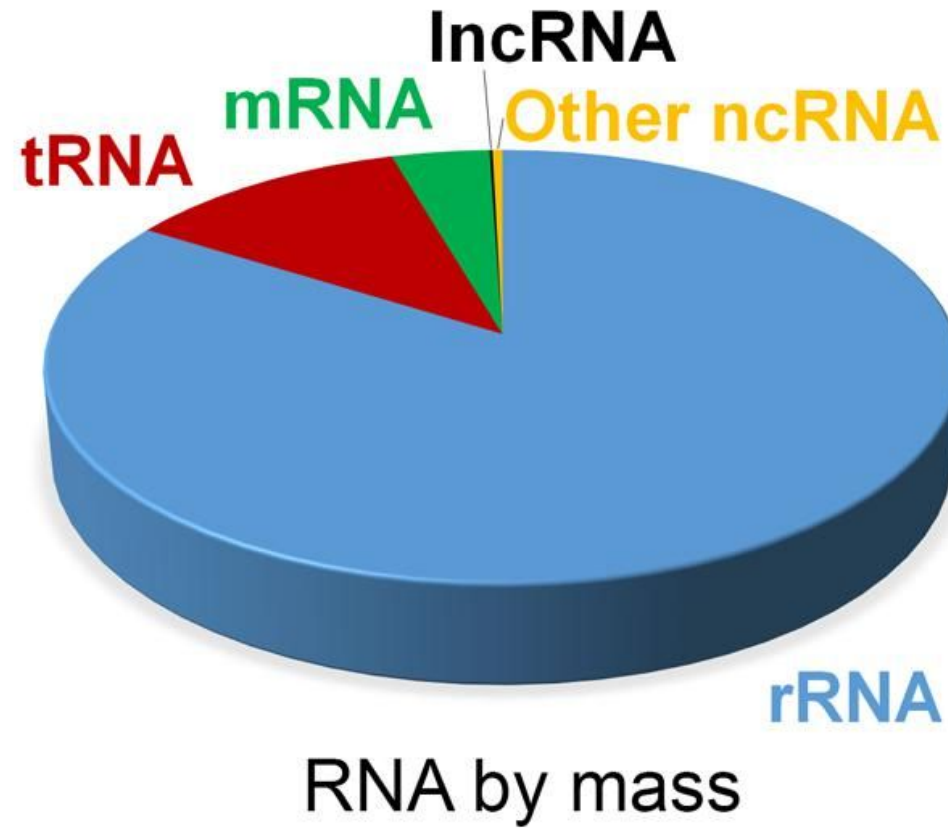
---

Which band contains  
the mRNA?



# Total RNA (Mammalian)

---

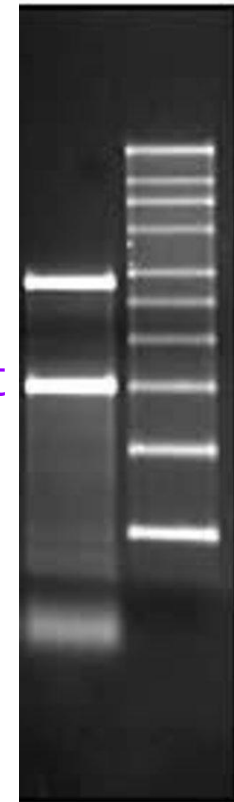


rRNA large subunit

rRNA small subunit

mRNA

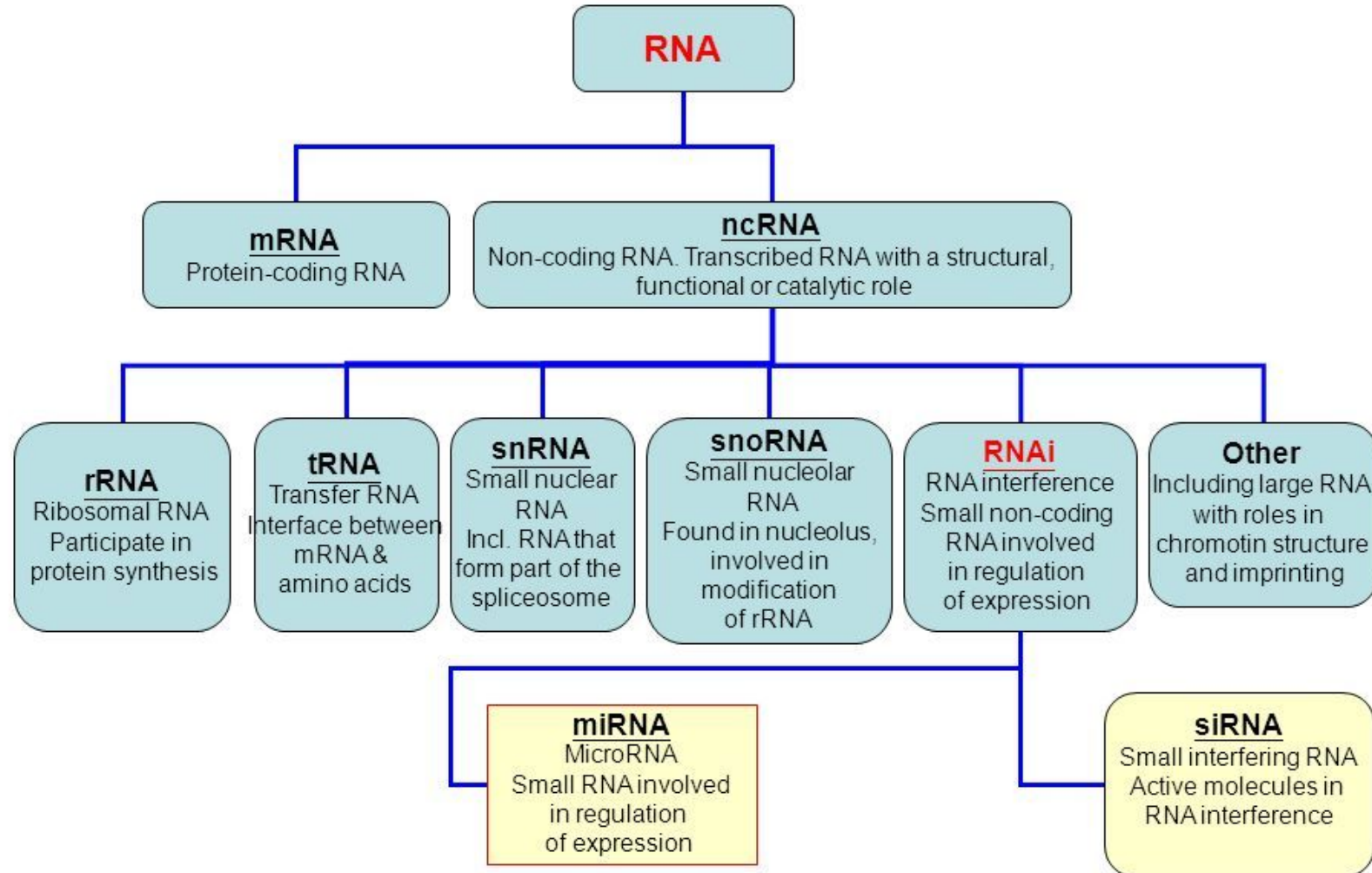
tRNA





# RNA

## Type of RNA molecules



# Enrichment for Mature RNA

---

## **Poly-A selection method**

- use a poly-dT baits to bind mRNAs and discard the rest
- Removes rRNA, tRNA and others
- Enriches for mature mRNA (containing poly-A tail)
- Not all mRNAs have poly-A tails
  - Histones mRNA in Metazoans
  - Mitochondrial mRNA

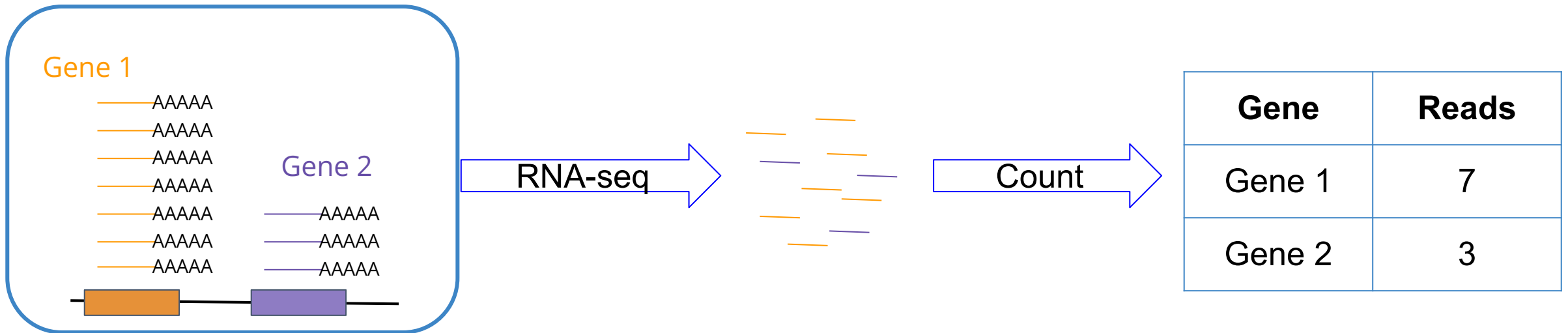
## **rRNA depletion method**

- Use baits designed specifically for rRNA
- Does not remove tRNA
- Only option in bacteria (no poly-A tail)
- Only option when extracting small RNAs

# Expression Levels

---

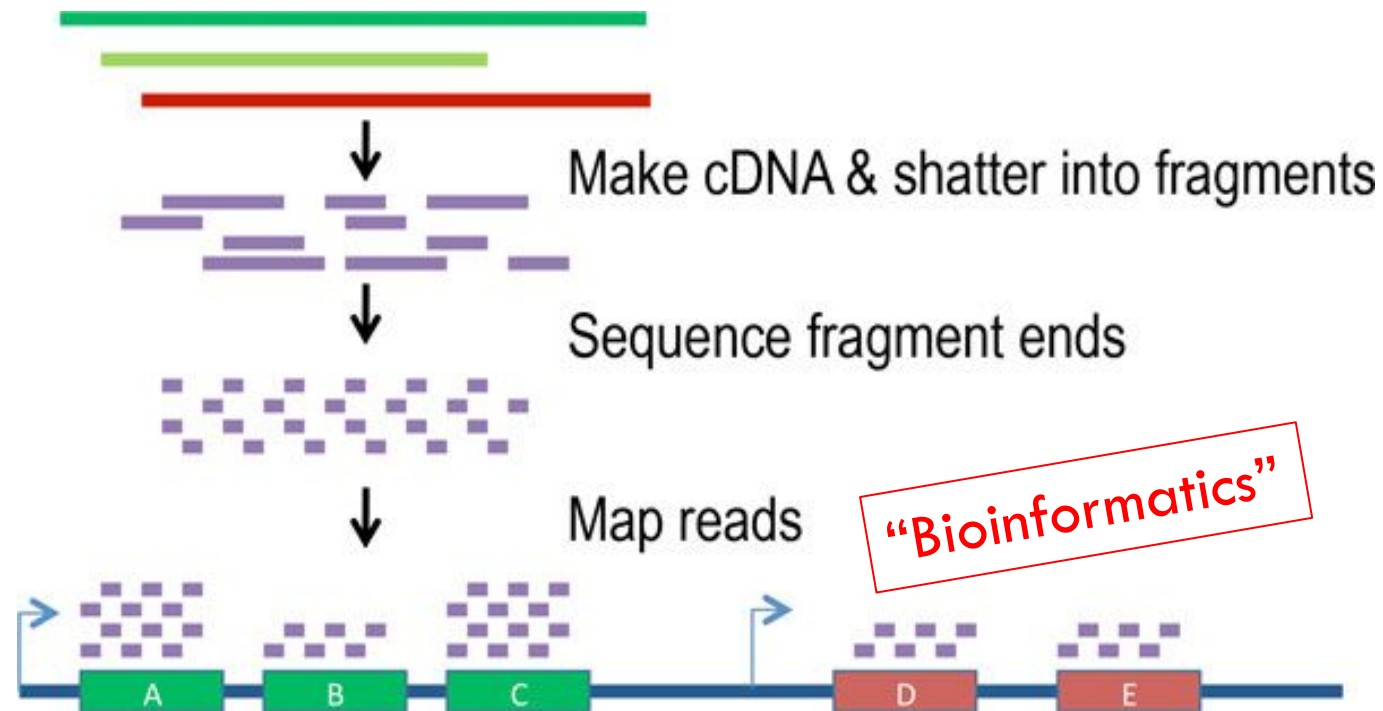
Higher expression → more transcripts → more RNA-seq reads



# Summary

---

Reveal the presence and quantity of RNA in a biological sample at a given moment  
(mostly mRNA)



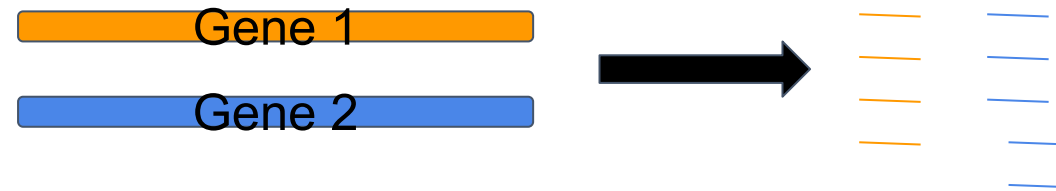
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tlf6wYJrwKY>

# Are Read Counts a Good Measure?

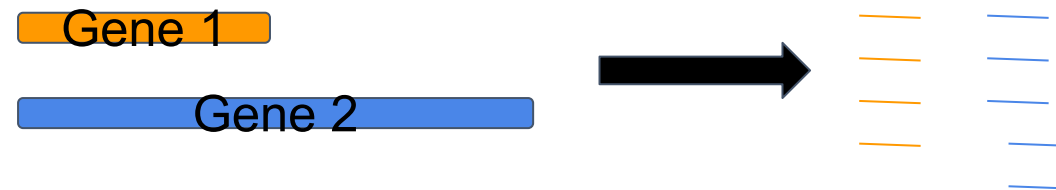
---

Variable length of transcript of interest

Experiment 1



Experiment 2



# Are Read Counts a Good Measure?

---

## Variable length of other transcripts

Experiment 1



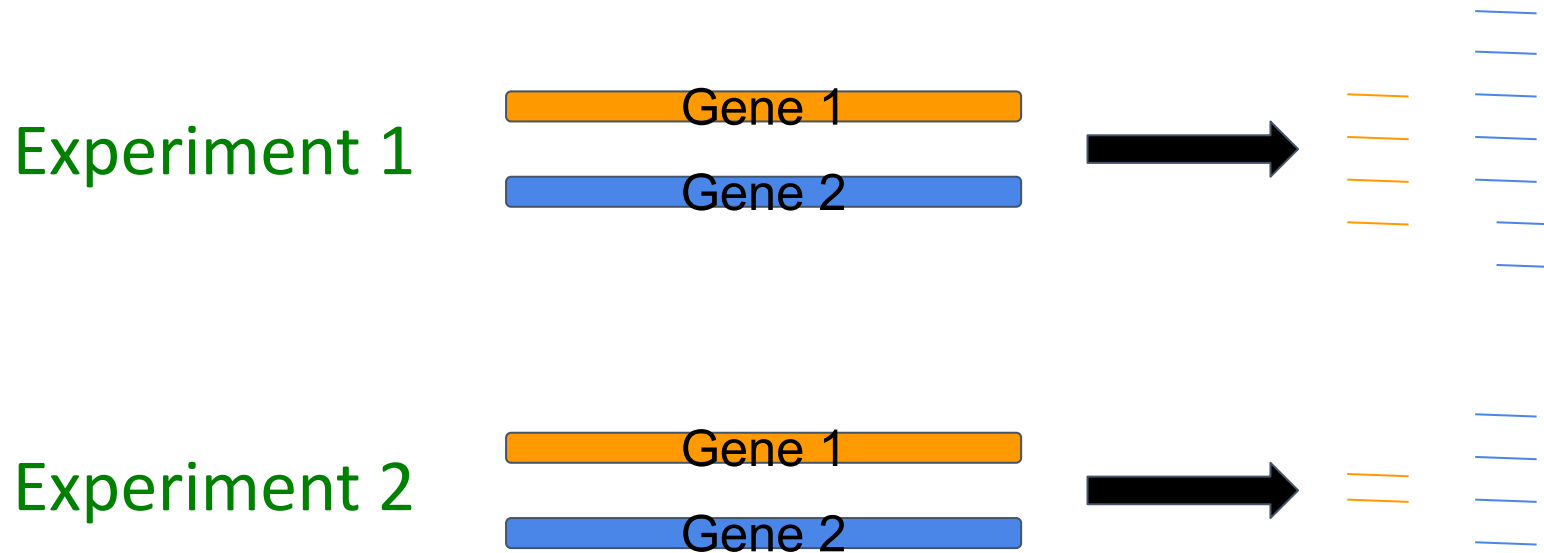
Experiment 2



# Are Read Counts a Good Measure?

---

## Variable number of reads between experiments



# Read Count Normalization

---

Normalize for transcript length

**RPK** - reads per kilobase (of transcript)

$$RPK_i = 10^3 \cdot \frac{n_i}{l_i}$$

Normalize for sequencing depth

**RPKM** - reads per kilobase (of transcript) per million (reads)

$$RPKM_i = 10^9 \cdot \frac{n_i}{l_i \cdot \sum_j n_j}$$



# Read Count Normalization

---

## Experiment 1 - total reads: 100,000

| Gene  | Transcript length | Reads | RPK | RPKM |
|-------|-------------------|-------|-----|------|
| Gene1 | 500               | 10    | 20  | 200  |
| Gene2 | 1000              | 20    | 20  | 200  |

## Experiment 2 - total reads: 1,000,000

| Gene  | Transcript length | Reads | RPK | RPKM |
|-------|-------------------|-------|-----|------|
| Gene1 | 500               | 10    | 20  | 20   |
| Gene2 | 1000              | 50    | 50  | 50   |

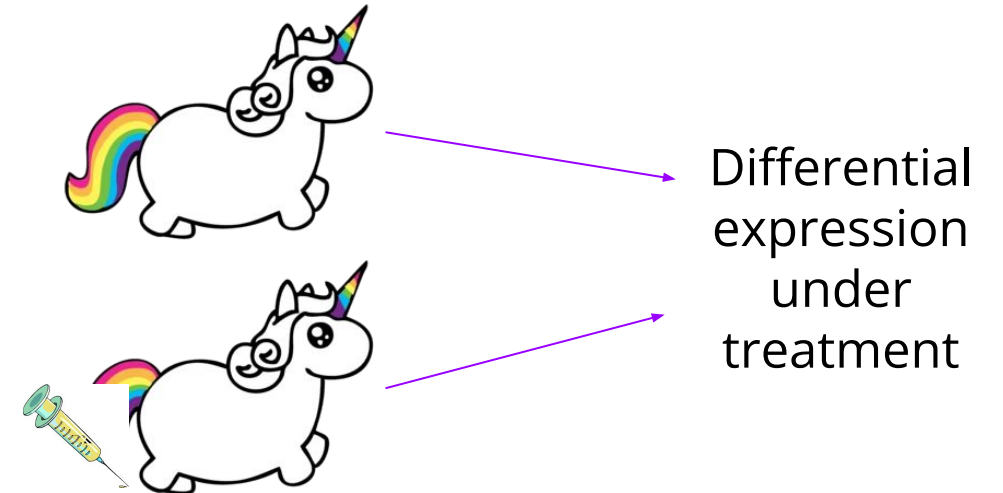
# Differential Gene Expression (DGE)

---

Compare gene expression levels across all genes between two (or more) samples

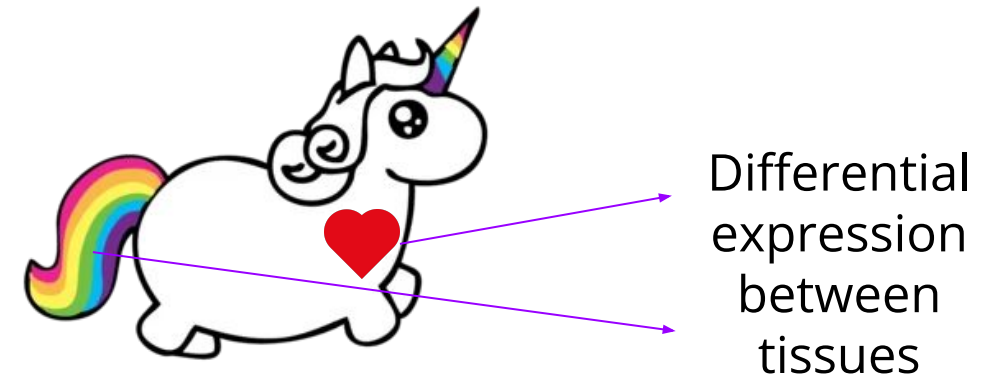
## Samples of the same cell type

- Different physiological conditions
- Different environmental conditions
  - Growth medium
  - Treatment

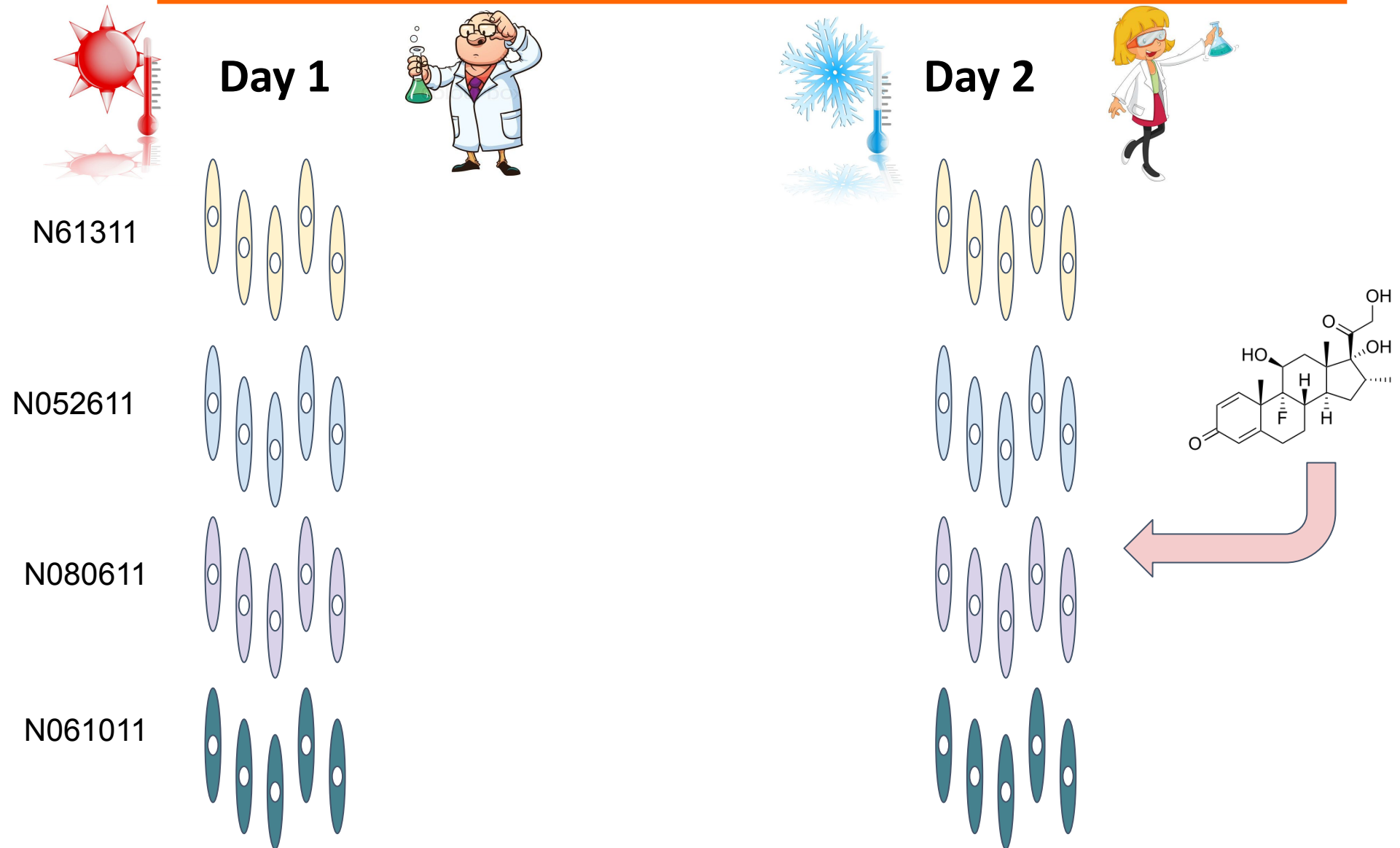


## Samples of different cell types

- Different tissues
- WT vs. mutant
- Different strains
- Normal vs. tumor



# Experiment



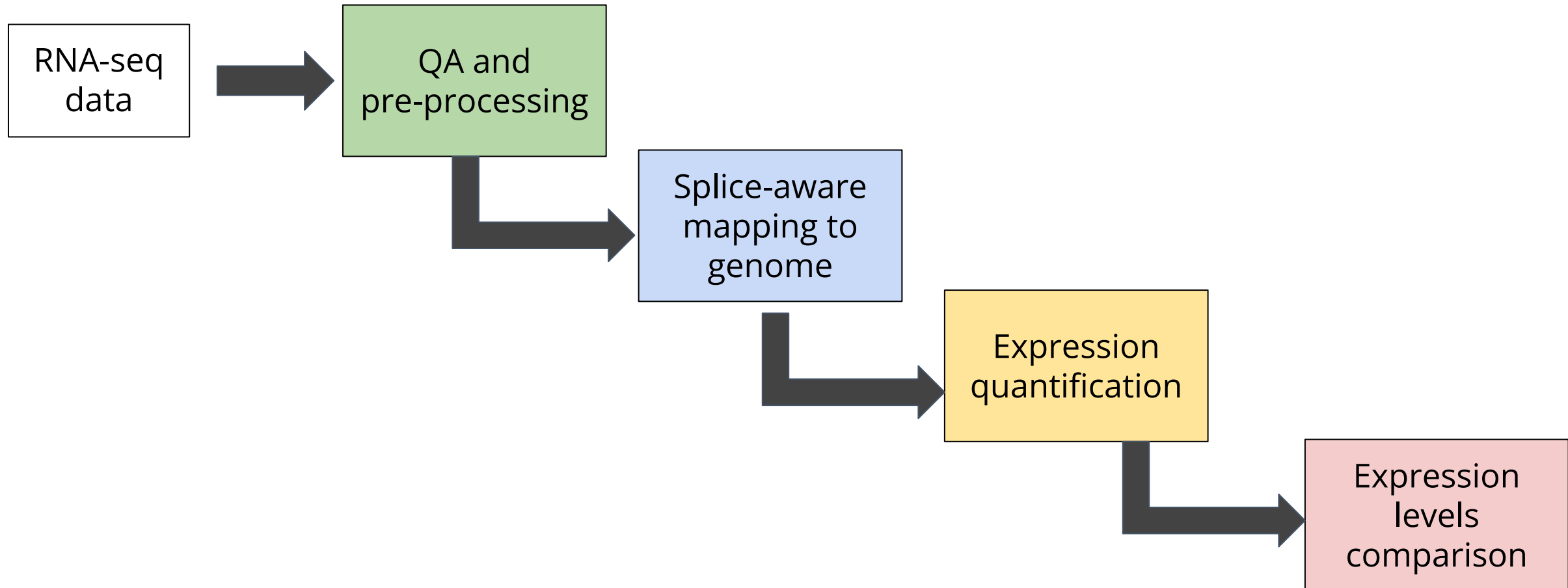
# Experiment

---

| Sample     | Cell line | Dex       | Batch |
|------------|-----------|-----------|-------|
| SRR1039508 | N61311    | Untreated | 1     |
| SRR1039509 | N61311    | Treated   | 1     |
| SRR1039512 | N052611   | Untreated | 1     |
| SRR1039513 | N052611   | Treated   | 1     |
| SRR1039516 | N080611   | Untreated | 2     |
| SRR1039517 | N080611   | Treated   | 2     |
| SRR1039520 | N061011   | Untreated | 2     |
| SRR1039521 | N061011   | Treated   | 2     |

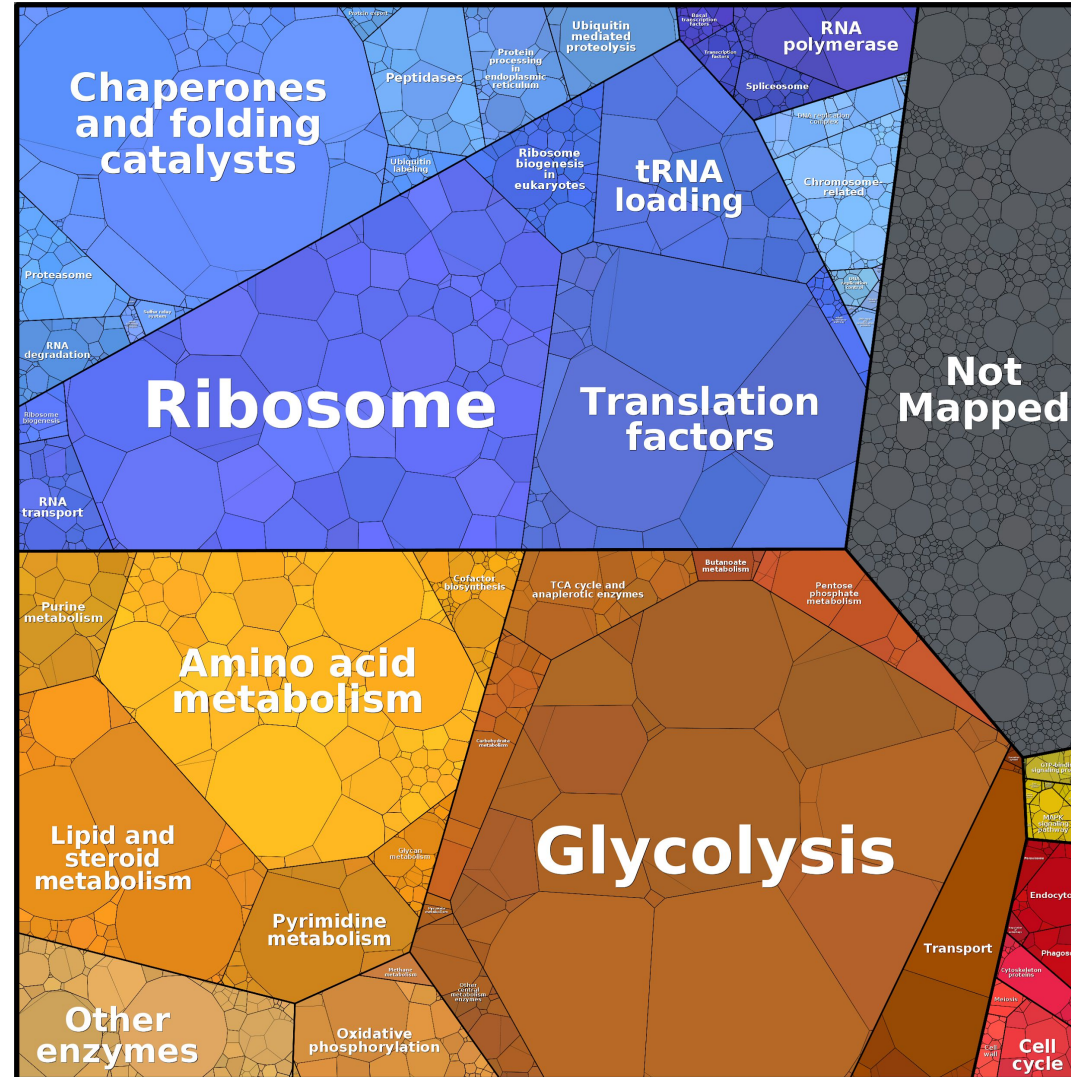
# DGE Workflow

---



# Exploring Expression Levels Data

Expression levels  
differ in orders of  
magnitude  
between genes

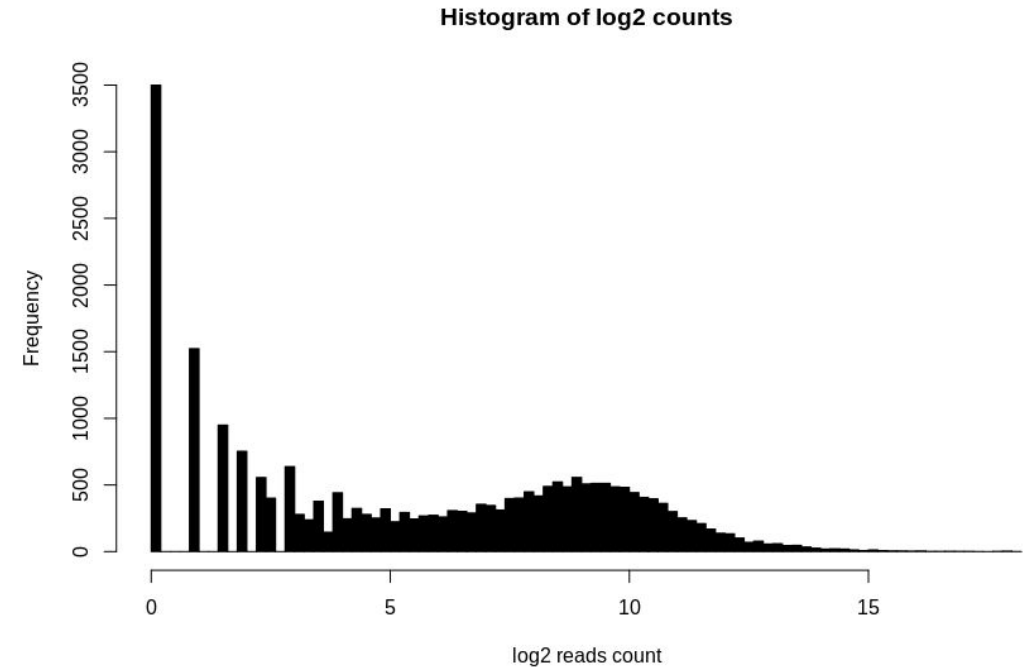
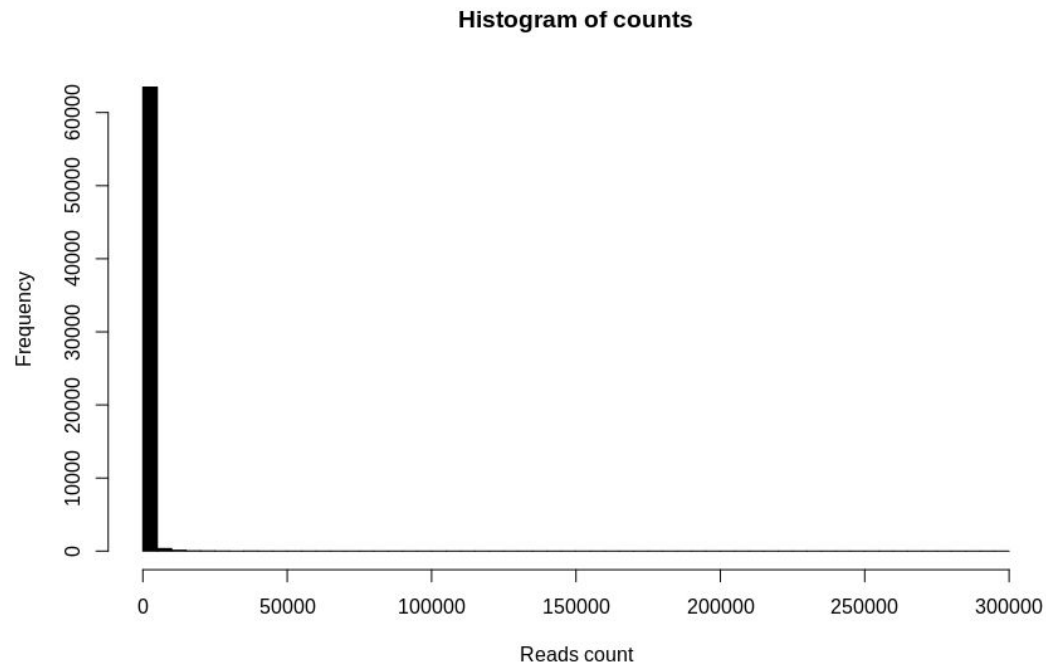


Liebermeister W., Noor E., Flamholz A., Davidi D., Bernhardt J., and Milo R. (2014), Visual account of protein investment in cellular functions. PNAS 111 (23), 8488-8493.

# Log Transformation

---

We usually apply a  $\log_2$  transformation to read counts  
Makes it easier to explore the data



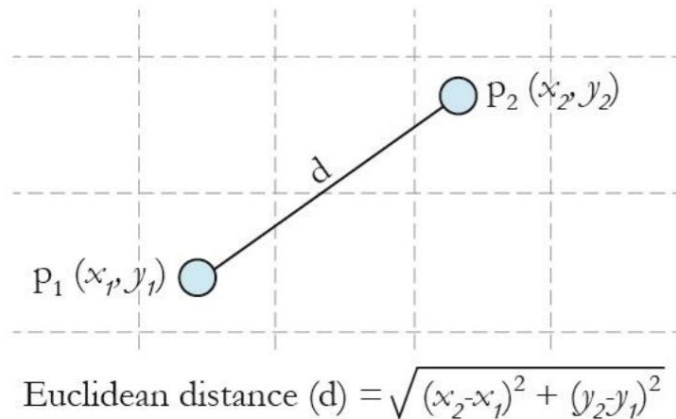
# QA Expression Quantification

Which samples are overall similar/different from one another?

Does it match our expectations, given the experimental design?

We can use Euclidean distances:

**In 2 dimensions**



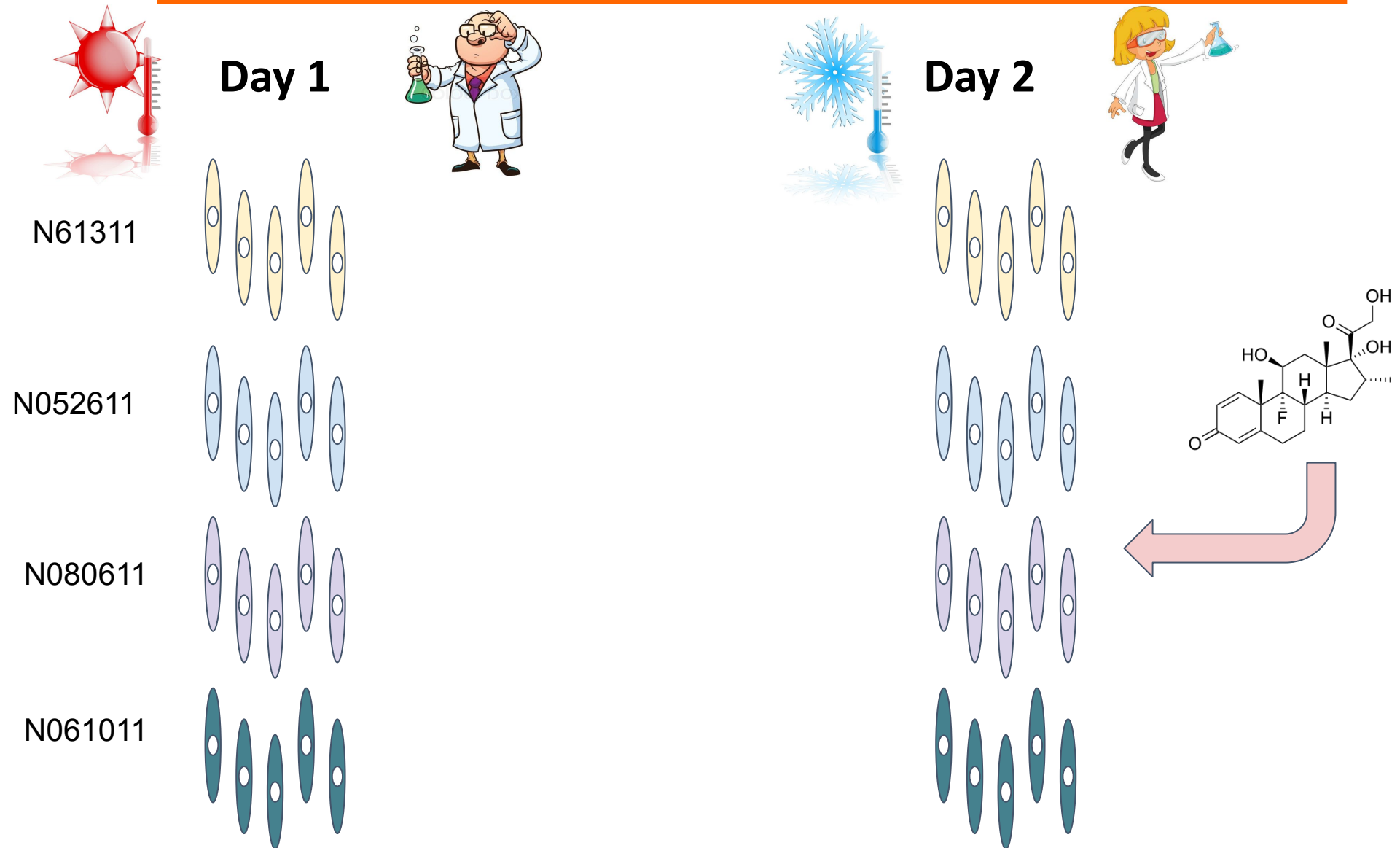
**In n dimensions**

|        | sample<br>1 | sample2  |
|--------|-------------|----------|
| gene1  | $m_{11}$    | $m_{12}$ |
| gene2  | $m_{21}$    | $m_{22}$ |
| ...    | ...         | ...      |
| gene n | $m_{n1}$    | $m_{n2}$ |

$$d = \sqrt{(m_{12} - m_{11})^2 + (m_{22} - m_{21})^2 + \dots + (m_{n2} - m_{n1})^2}$$

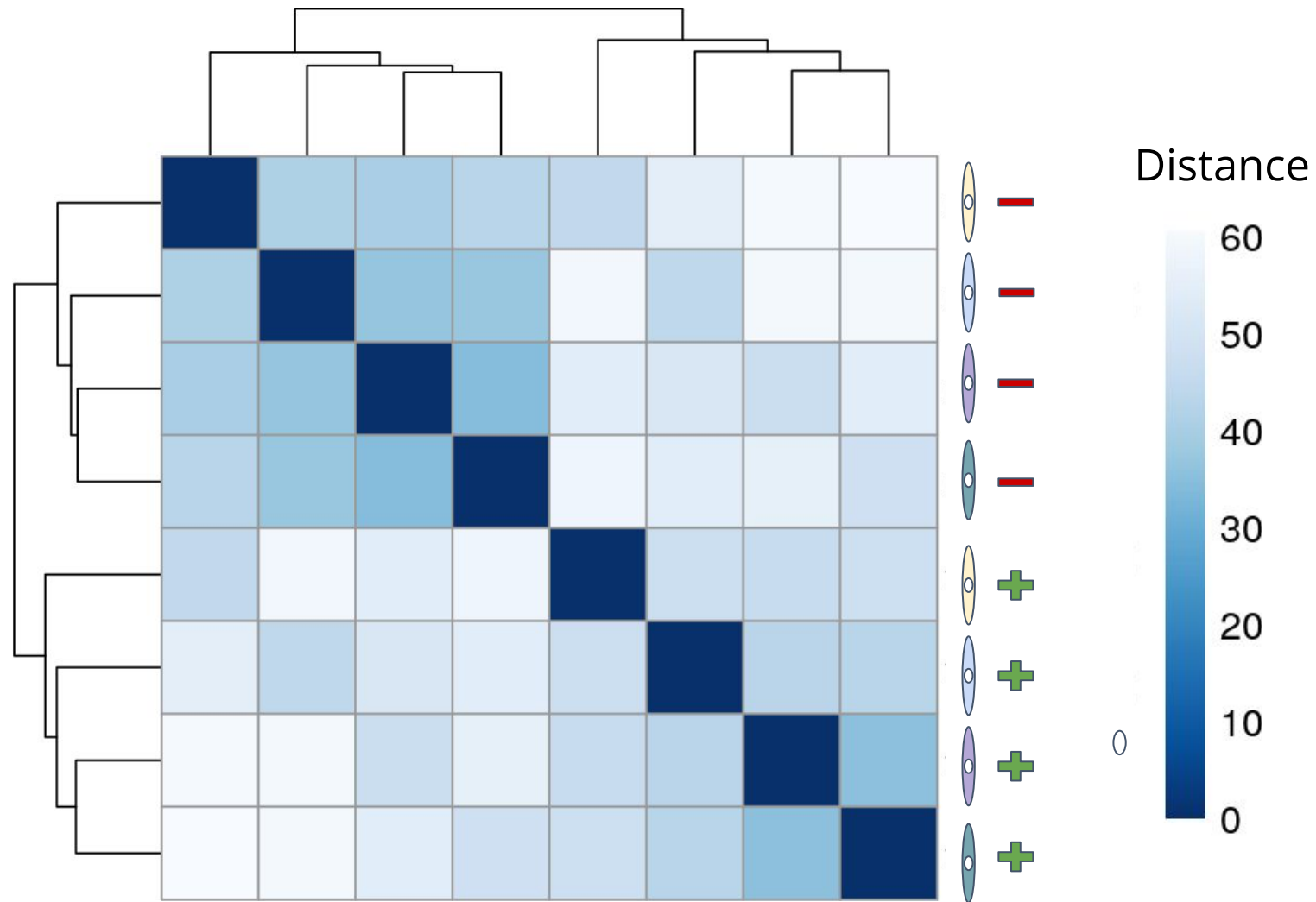


# Experiment



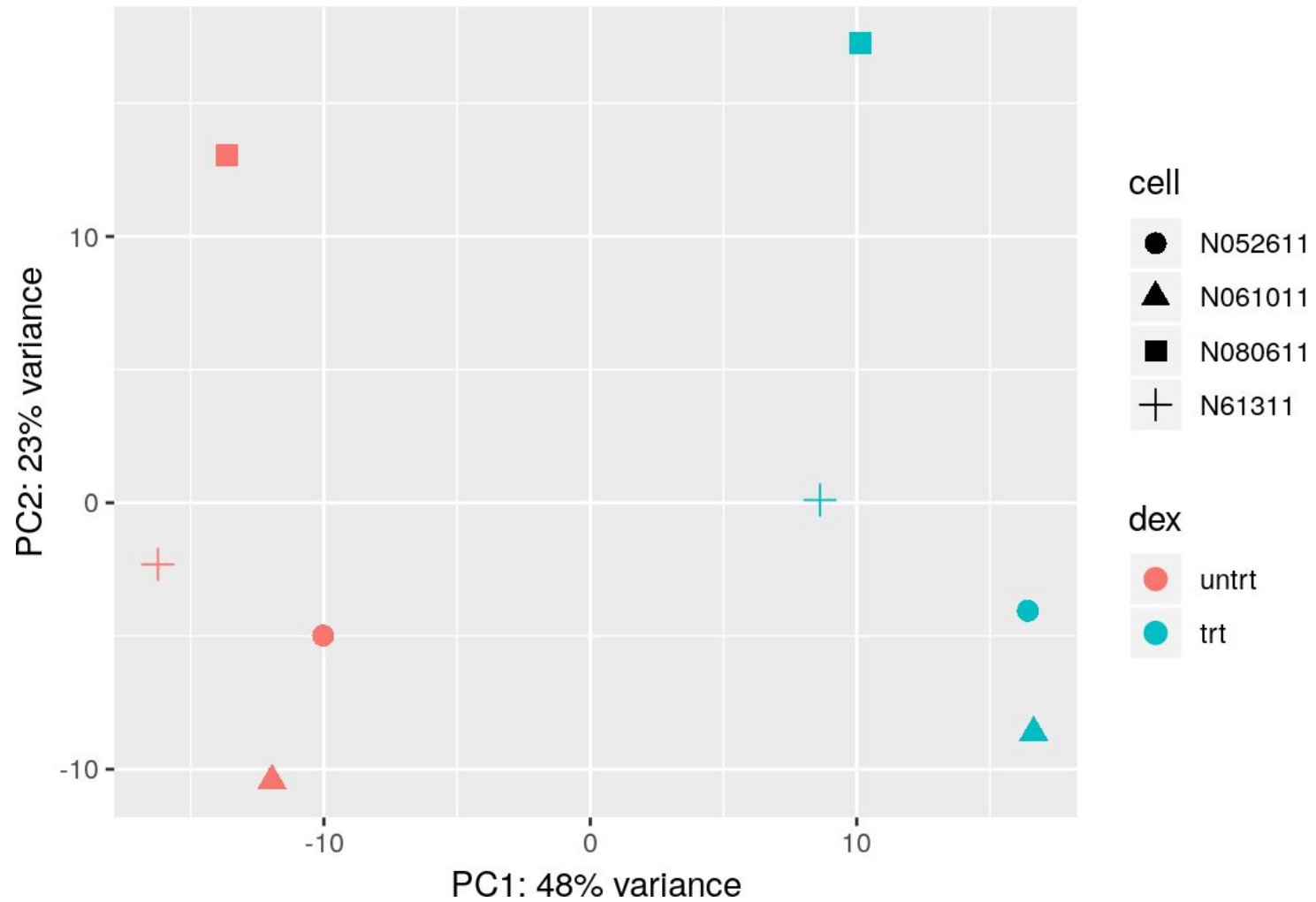
# Hierarchical Clustering

---



# PCA

---



# Filtering Counts Data

---

It is useful to remove genes with very few reads from the analysis

- Slow down the analysis
- Reduce detection power for other genes

We won't be able to detect DE anyway

We can choose a count cutoff

Or we can remove the  $X^{\text{th}}$  percentile

In the Himes et. al data:

~64k transcripts → Require  $\geq 10$  reads → ~20k transcripts

# Differential Expression Analysis

---

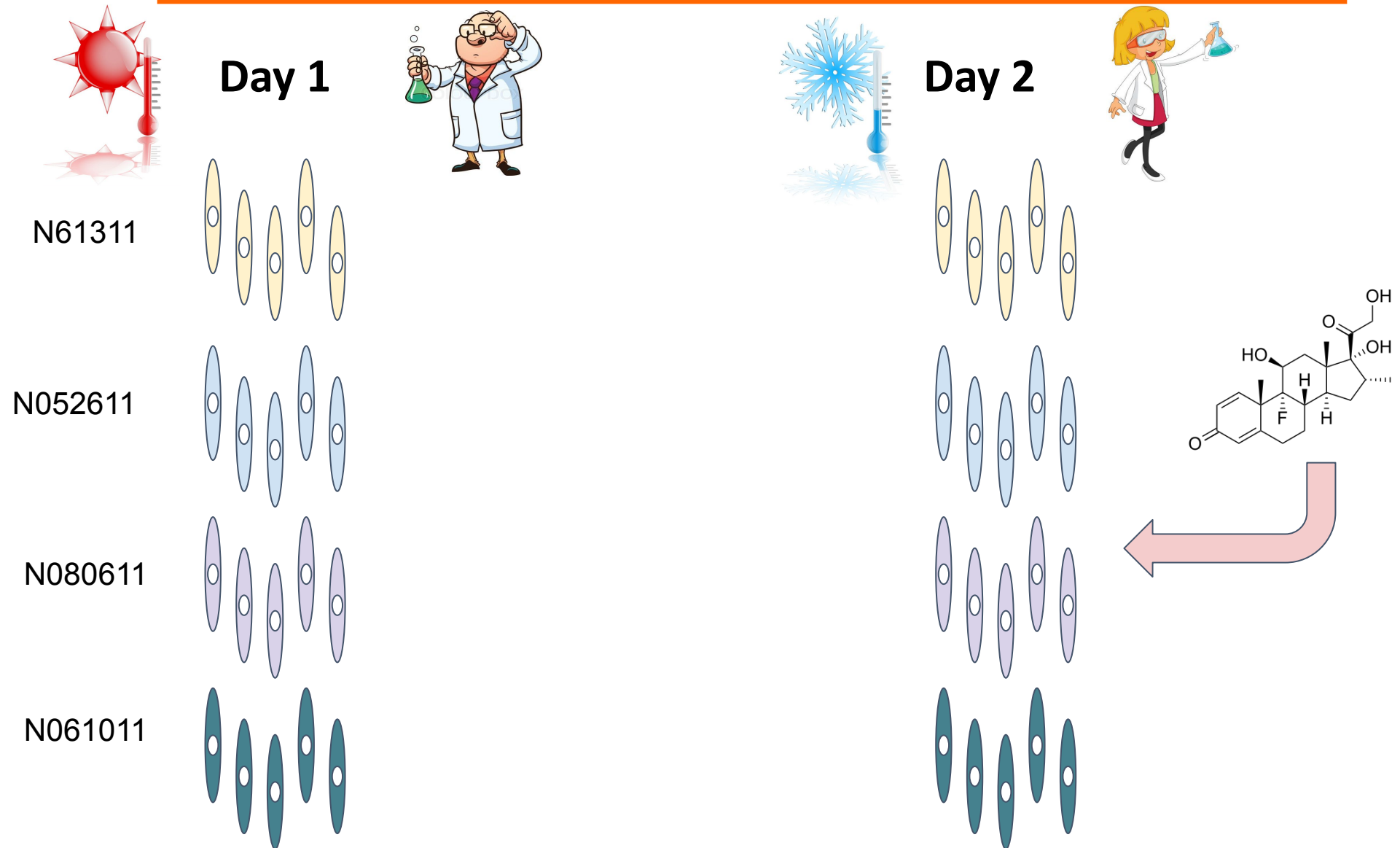
Goal: detect genes that significantly differ in their expression levels between samples

Input:

- Normalized, filtered expression quantification matrix
- Description of the experimental design

Output: per gene - estimated difference between samples and **significance level**

# Batch Effects



# Batch Effects

---

Introduced during sample handling and preparation

- Technical factors
- External factors

Minimize by:

- Use the same protocol for all samples
- Prepare all samples together

Not always possible

We must test for batch effects when performing DE statistical tests

# Batch Effects

---

| Sample     | Cell line | Dex       | Batch |
|------------|-----------|-----------|-------|
| SRR1039508 | N61311    | Untreated | 1     |
| SRR1039509 | N61311    | Treated   | 1     |
| SRR1039512 | N052611   | Untreated | 1     |
| SRR1039513 | N052611   | Treated   | 1     |
| SRR1039516 | N080611   | Untreated | 2     |
| SRR1039517 | N080611   | Treated   | 2     |
| SRR1039520 | N061011   | Untreated | 2     |
| SRR1039521 | N061011   | Treated   | 2     |



# Fold Change

---

The main measure used in DGE analysis is **fold change** - a.k.a ratio

Ratios are highly non-symmetric  $R = \frac{Count_{sample1}}{Count_{sample2}}$

Therefore we use log scaling - **log2 fold change (L2FC)**

$$L2FC = \log_2\left(\frac{Count_{sample1}}{Count_{sample2}}\right) = \log_2 Count_{sample1} - \log_2 Count_{sample2}$$

# Fold Change

---

|               | N61311<br>Dex | N61311<br>Dex | N05261<br>1 Dex | N08061<br>1 Dex | N61311<br>Unt | N61311<br>Unt | N05261<br>1 Unt | N08061<br>1 Unt | Mean<br>Dex | Mean<br>Unt | FC   | L2FC  |
|---------------|---------------|---------------|-----------------|-----------------|---------------|---------------|-----------------|-----------------|-------------|-------------|------|-------|
| <i>Gene 1</i> | 34            | 512           | 66              | 121             | 25            | 344           | 297             | 76              | 183.25      | 185.50      | 0.99 | -0.02 |
| <i>Gene 2</i> | 1112          | 985           | 1003            | 898             | 214           | 128           | 188             | 203             | 999.50      | 183.25      | 5.45 | 2.45  |
| <i>Gene 3</i> | 6             | 9             | 4               | 6               | 12            | 9             | 15              | 16              | 6.25        | 13.00       | 0.48 | -1.06 |

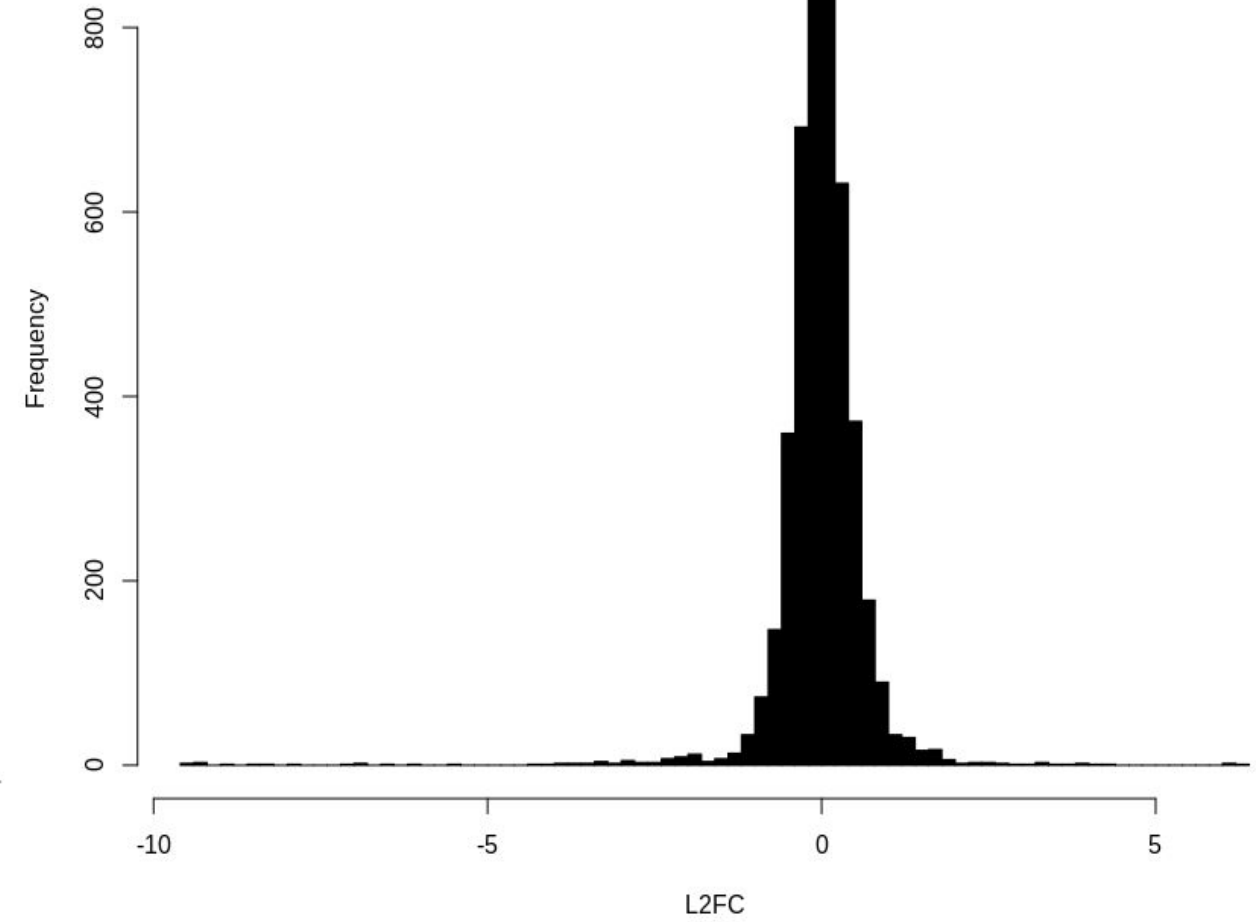
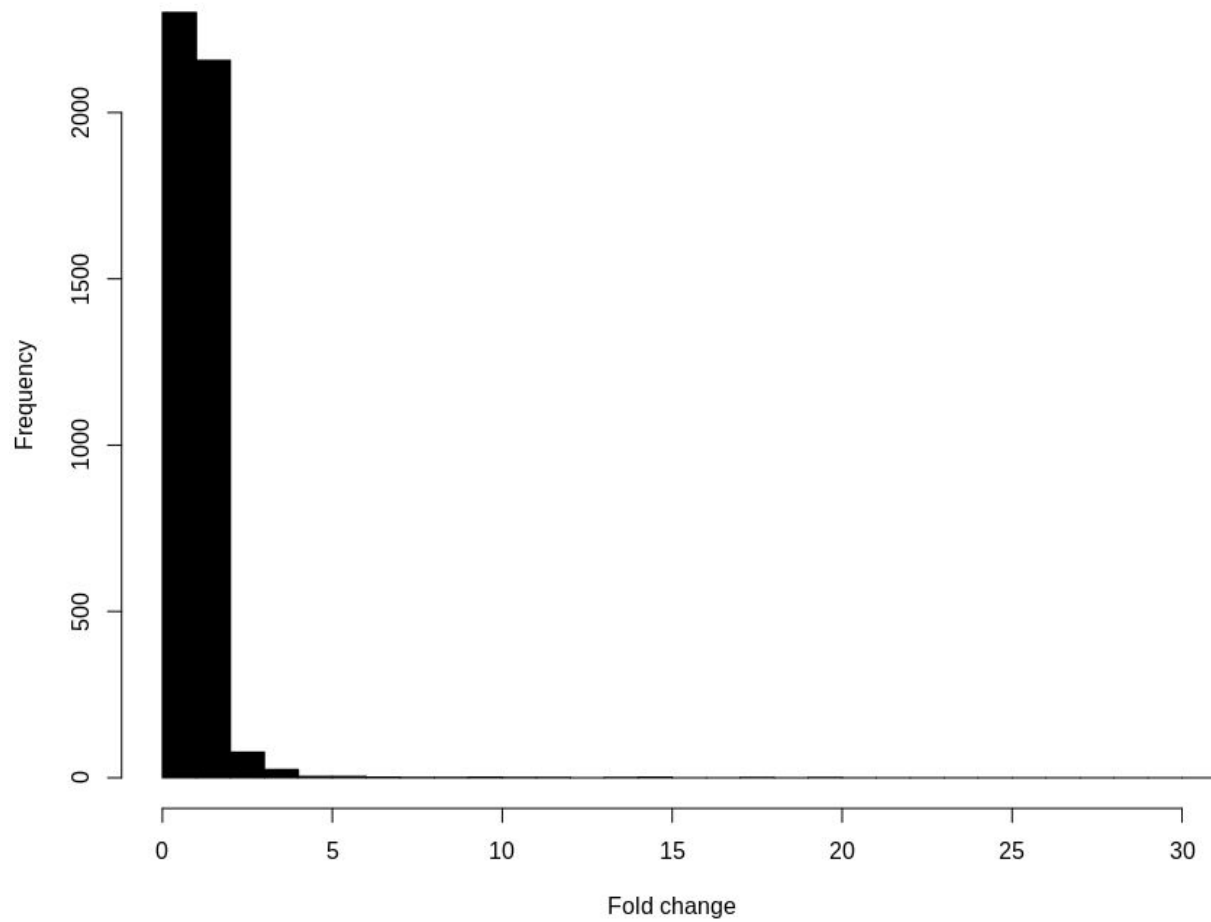
L2FC = 0 : no difference

L2FC > 0 : sample1 expression > sample 2  
expression

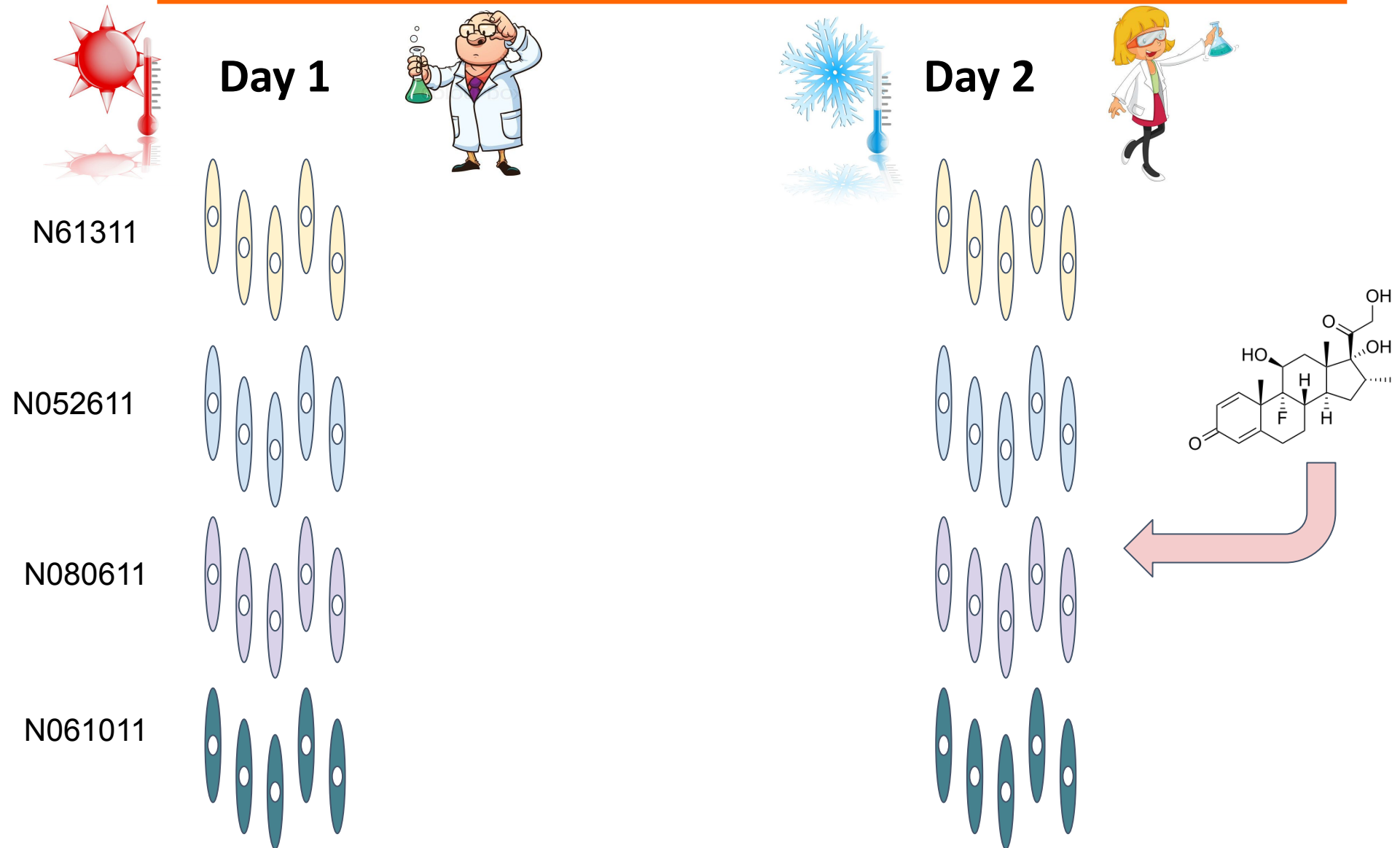
L2FC < 0 : sample1 expression < sample 2  
expression

# Fold Change

---



# Experiment



# Log2 Fold Changes

---

Can we tell just by looking at L2FC values?

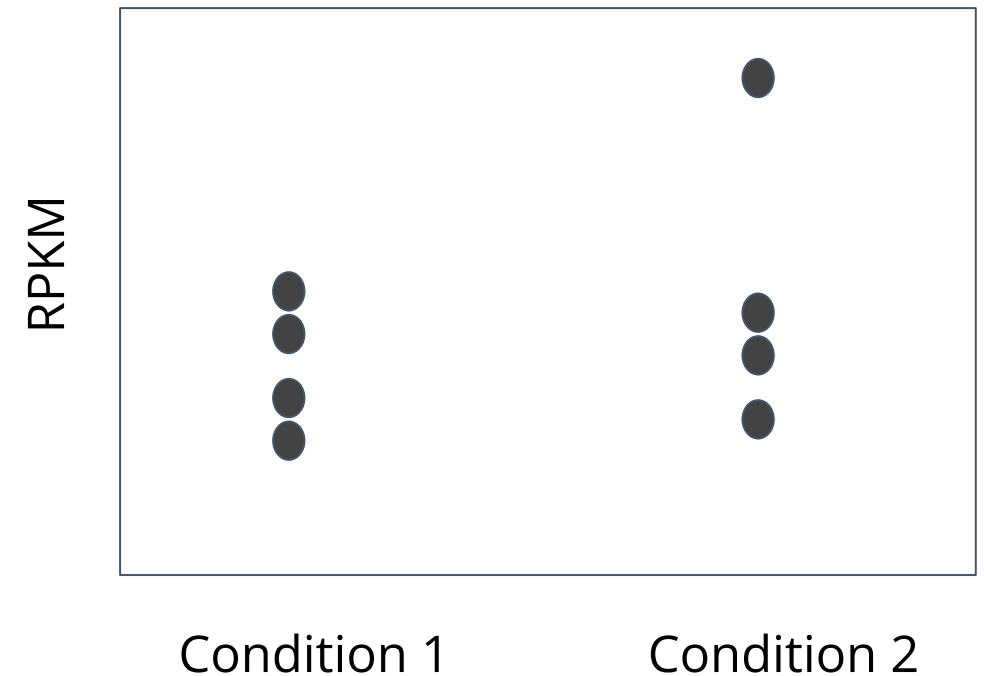
Maybe it's just random noise?

Replicates can help

**Gene X** - L2FC = 0.5



**Gene Y** - L2FC = 0.4



# Hypothesis Testing

---

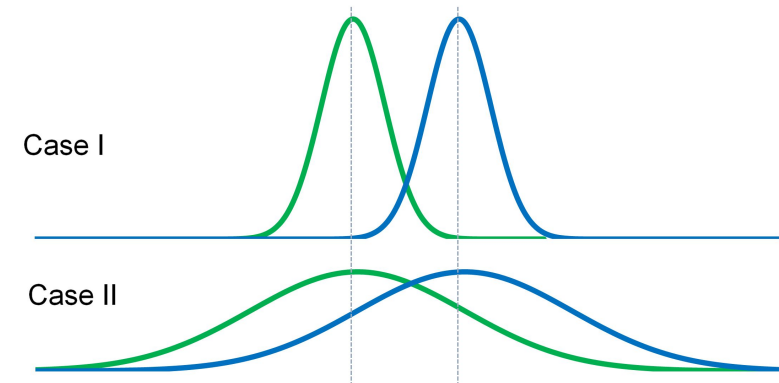
$H_0$ : there is no difference in expression levels between samples

$H_1$ : expression levels differ between samples

We try and reject  $H_0$  with an appropriate statistical test, e.g.:

- Parametric tests:  $t$ -test, ANOVA
- Non-parametric tests: Mann-Whitney U test
- Other modeling methods: linear models, GLM

The result is a significance score - **per gene p-value**



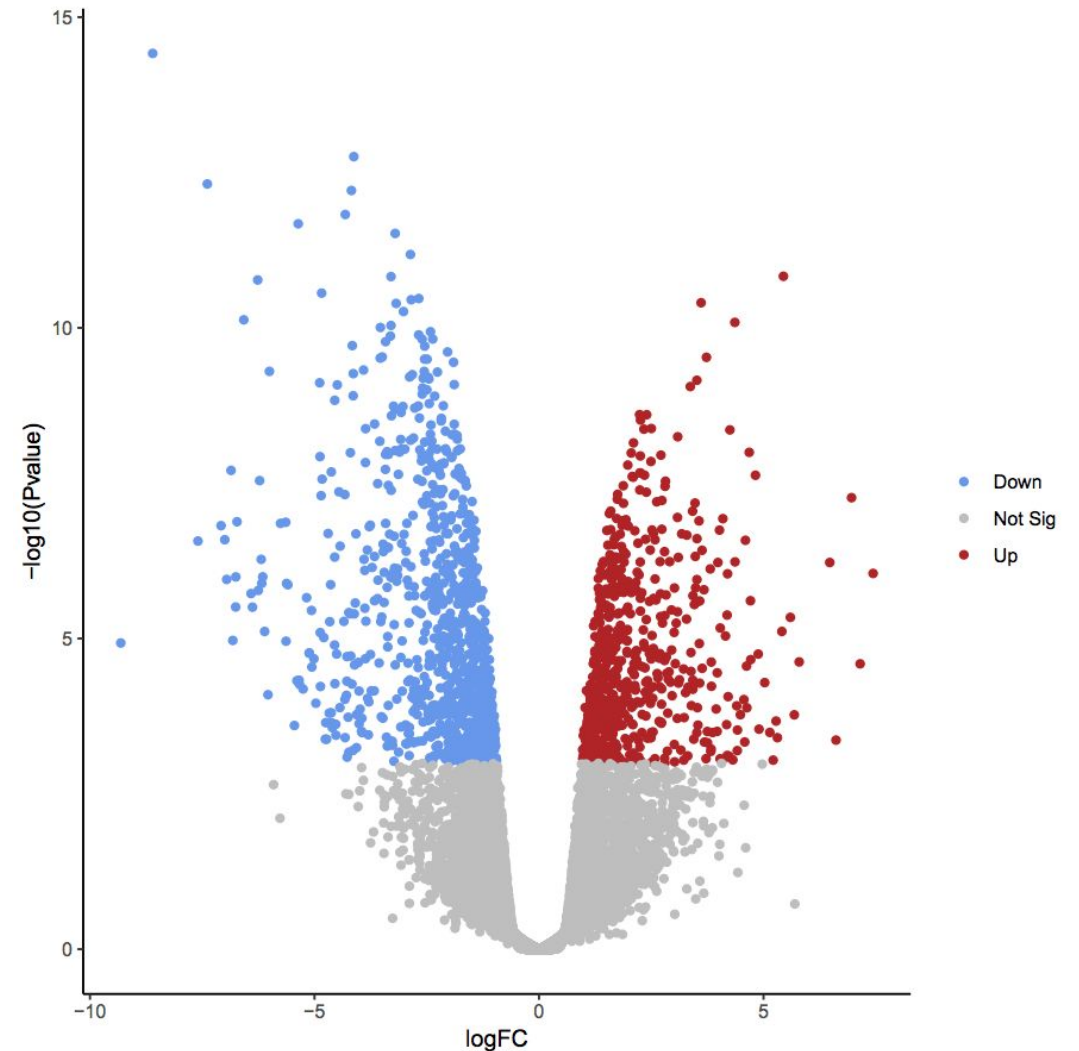
# Volcano Plots

---

For each gene, we must consider both L2FC and p-value

To get a global view - use a **volcano plot**

We can choose a p-value cutoff, e.g. 0.05 or 0.01



# Cutoff

---

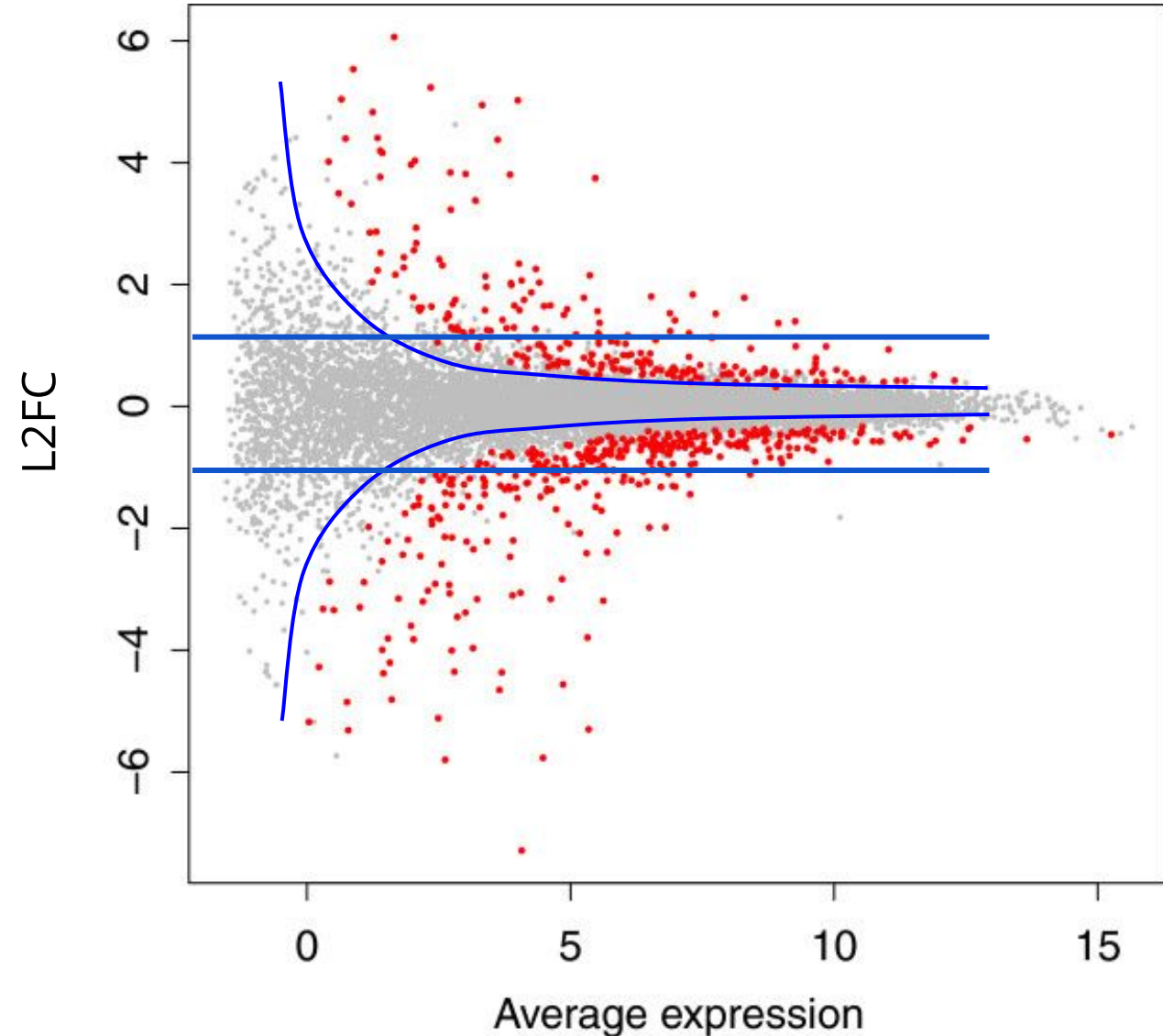
We can choose an arbitrary cutoff,  
e.g. 1

Lowly-expressed genes usually  
display higher variability in  
expression

This can be seen in a **MA-plot**

Can be used as a sanity-check

Or to choose dynamic L2FC cutoffs





# Correcting for Multiple Testing

---

Recall the meaning of a p-value...

Since we are performing multiple tests, we must correct (adjust) p-values

The simple and stringent way - Bonferroni correction

$$p_{adj} = p \times [\# \text{ of genes}]$$

The common way - False Discovery Rate (FDR - BH procedure):

1. Order p-values from smallest to largest

$$p_1, p_2, \dots, p_k, \dots, p_m$$

1.

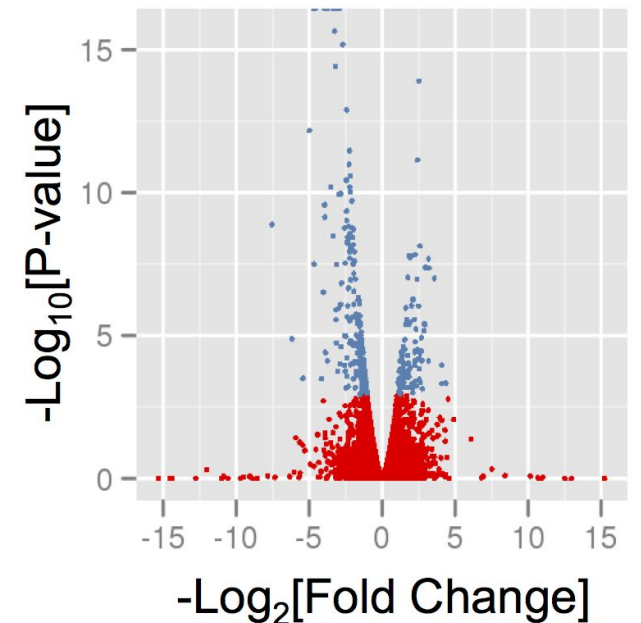
$$p_{adj}^k = \frac{p^k \times [\# \text{ of genes}]}{k}$$

# Himes et al. - DGE Analysis Results

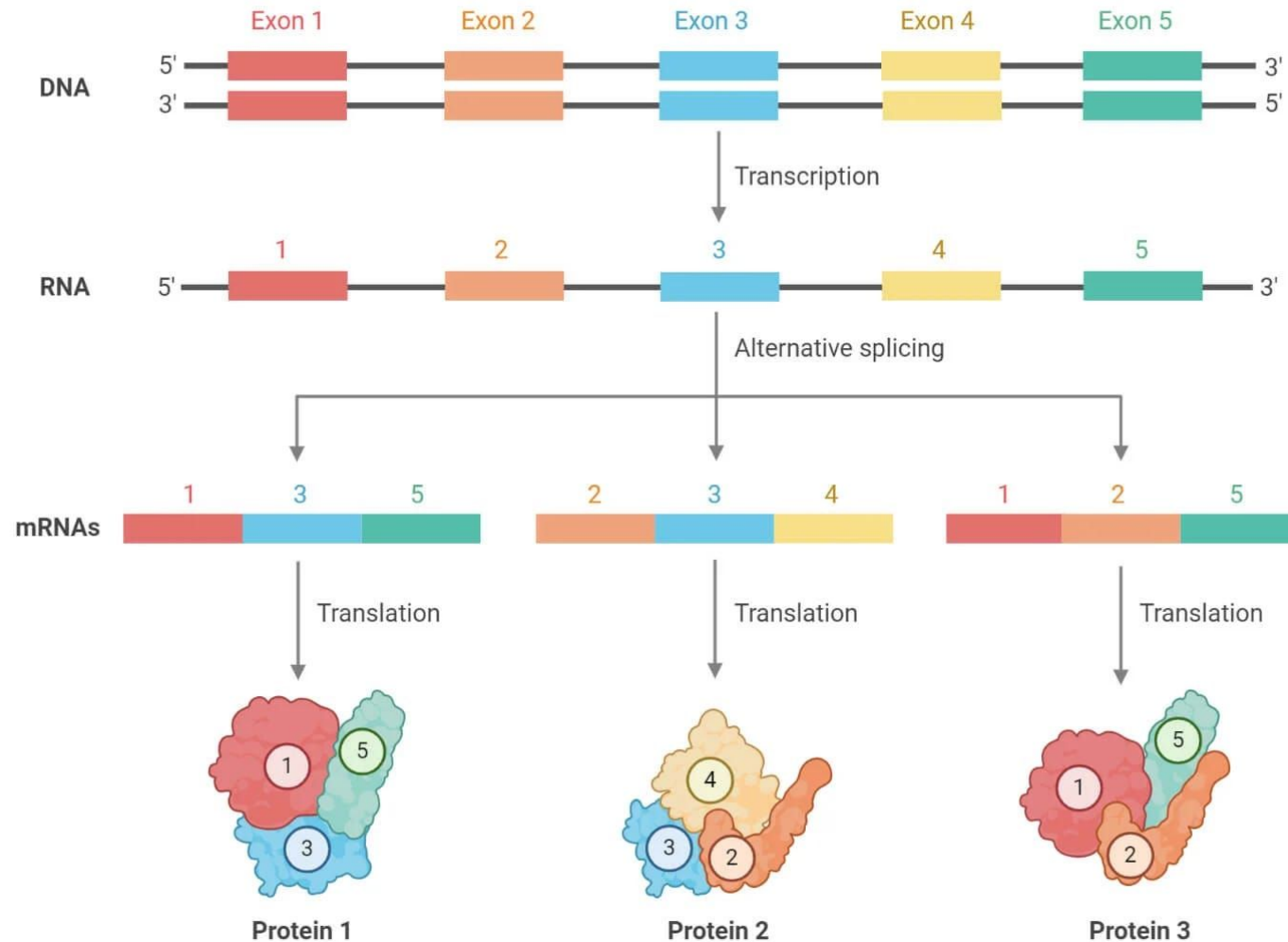
A total of 316 DE genes between treated and untreated samples

Top 5:

| Gene   | Dex RPKM | Untreated RPKM | Ln[Fold Change] | Test Statistic | Adj. P-Value |
|--------|----------|----------------|-----------------|----------------|--------------|
| C7     | 38.41    | 3.76           | -3.35           | 8.74           | 0            |
| CCDC69 | 47.39    | 6.24           | -2.92           | 8.61           | 0            |
| DUSP1  | 144.96   | 18.26          | -2.99           | 8.99           | 0            |
| FKBP5  | 53.05    | 3.43           | -3.95           | 10.52          | 0            |
| GPX3   | 613.37   | 45.18          | -3.76           | 9.19           | 0            |

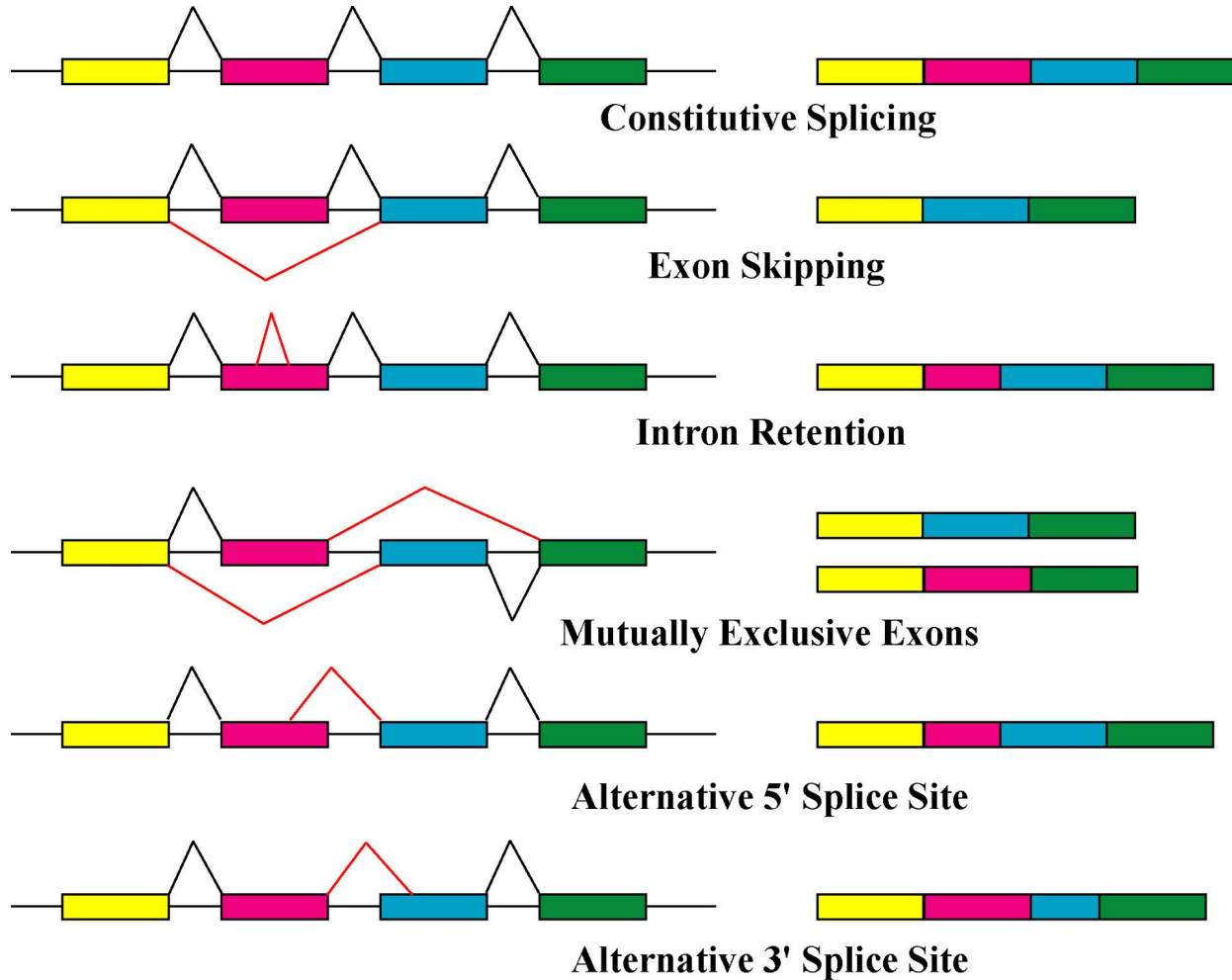


# RNA-Seq and Long Reads



# RNA-Seq and Long Reads

---



# RNA-Seq and Long Reads

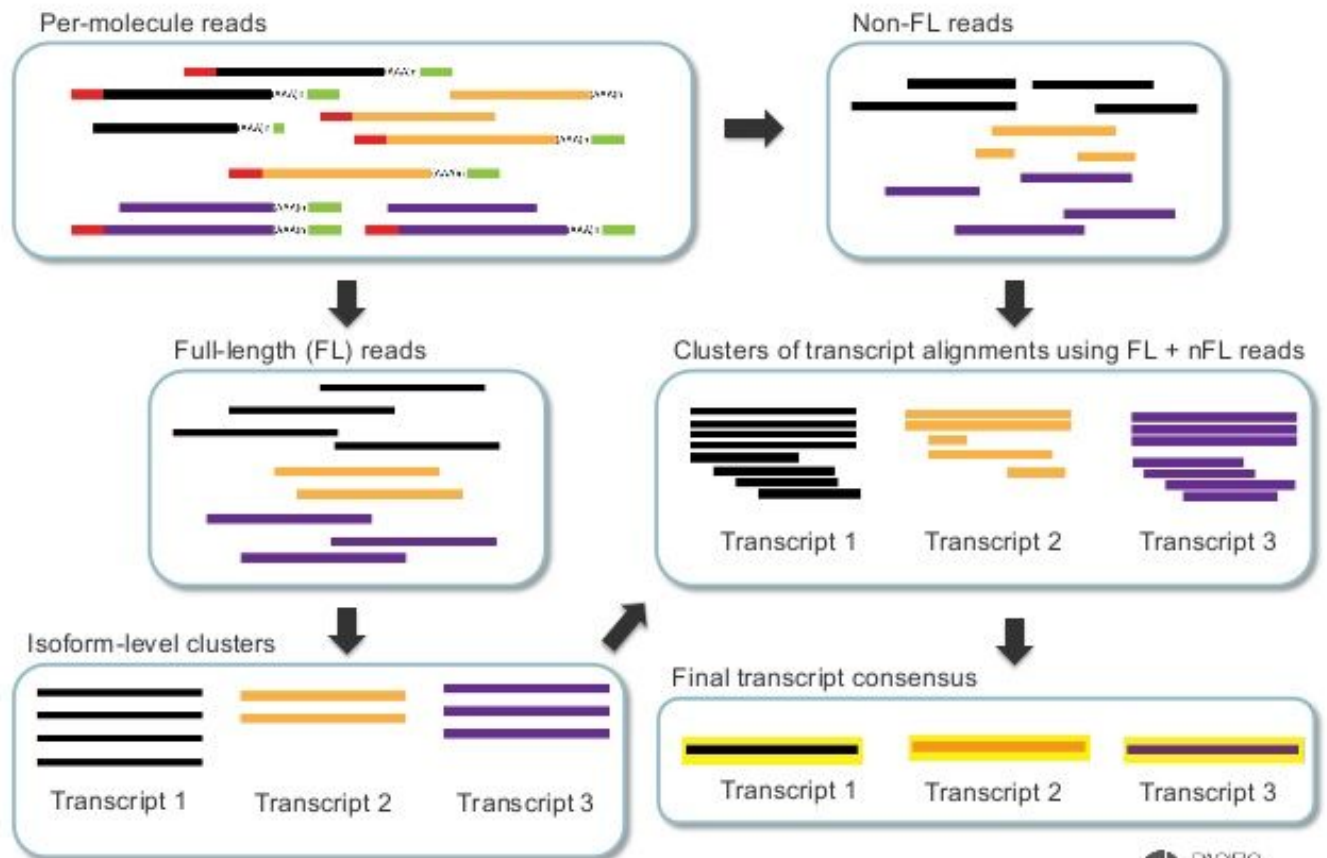
Read length is usually  
larger than mRNA size

Full-length transcripts

No transcript assembly is  
needed

Easier to detect and  
quantify isoforms

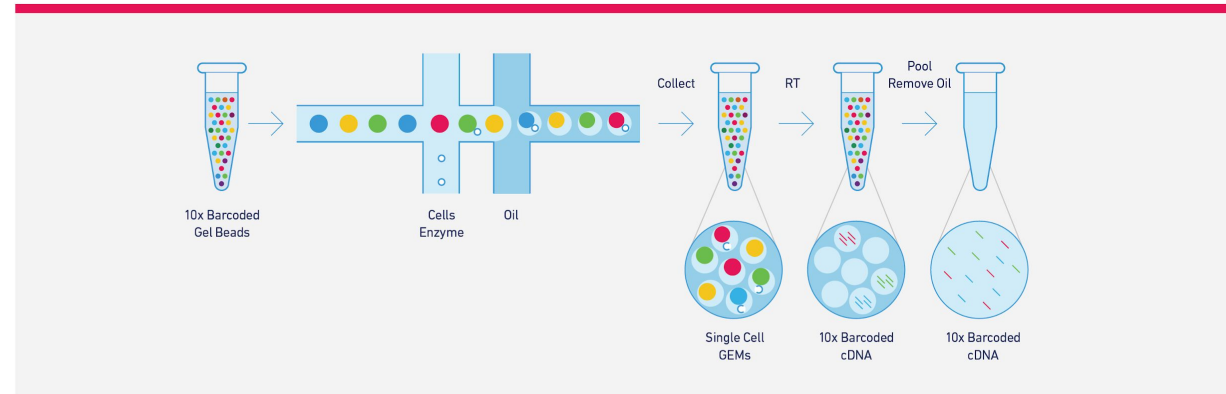
## Iso-Seq Informatics Pipeline



# 10X for Single Cell RNA-Seq

## GemCode™ Technology for Single Cell Partitioning

Utilize an efficient droplet-based system to encapsulate up to 100-80,000+ cells in a single 10-minute run.



## Single Cell Digital Gene Expression

Enable digital quantification of transcripts in every cell, for single cell digital gene expression analysis.

